



President, Vance hit campaign circuit

Midterm tour opens as Republicans' troubles deepen

BY NATALIE ALLISON AND ISAAC ARNSDORF

Fresh off basking in the praise of adoring supporters at the GOP midterm convention, President Donald Trump and Vice President JD Vance kick off their first swing of midterm campaigning in earnest this week, with trips that betray how much trouble their party could be in.

Trump, returning from a weekend retreat to his Ireland golf course, is scheduled on Wednesday to visit North Carolina, where his handpicked Senate candidate, former Republican National Committee chairman Michael Whatley, trails former governor Roy Cooper (D) by seven points in a recent high-quality poll.

Vance, meanwhile, plans to travel to Kansas on Monday to campaign for GOP Sen. Roger Marshall, whose reelection race appears too close for comfort for Republicans.

The visits reflect how much the political environment has shifted against Republicans since 2024. Trump won North Carolina by three points in 2024, and Republicans haven't lost a Senate race in Kansas since 1932.

Both Trump and Vance intend to increase the pace of their campaign travel as the midterm election nears, White House advisers with knowledge of their schedules said.

Trump's political team has consulted closely with Whatley's
SEE MIDTERMS ON A7

Has Christian legal movement gone astray?

A lawyer who helped launch the cause believes it has

BY MICHELLE BOORSTEIN

In the bygone times, when Americans weren't yet debating whether Starbucks holiday cups were Christmas-y enough or whether bakers should make cakes for same-sex weddings, a lanky Southerner named John Whitehead started something totally new: a Christian religious liberty law firm.

It was hard to raise money, Whitehead recalled, or get support for the firm — even from evangelical leaders — for Christians fighting in court for the right to home-school or a police officer wanting to wear a cross to work.

"They said 'Christians don't sue,' or that 'Christians shouldn't get mixed up with the government,'" or they didn't see the cause as a donor draw, Whitehead said in an interview. "I made appointments with these fancy ministers but no one seemed interested."

Today the Christian legal movement Whitehead helped pioneer is worth hundreds of millions of dollars and has touched many aspects of American life. Its firms, many sprinkled with his former protégés,
SEE WHITEHEAD ON A2

McConnell returns to Senate



FINN GOMEZ/GETTY IMAGES

Sen. Mitch McConnell (R-Kentucky) arrives at the Capitol on Monday. McConnell, 84, voted in the Senate for the first time in months, making his first public appearance at the Capitol since he had a fall in June. **Story, A4**

Seeking to flip solar power over to the dark side

BY EVAN HALPER AND LAYLI NAZAROVA

In a laboratory amid Northern Virginia's sprawling data centers, a group of scientists is looking very far outside the box for a solution to overwhelmed power grids.

They want to harness the sun's rays and shoot a kilometer-wide laser — they prefer the term "power beam" — down from satellites in space to solar panels on

Far-out idea could enable energy panels to work at night

Earth. The idea is to overcome solar power's biggest weakness: that it stops working when there is no sunlight.

If all goes according to plan — a big if, as this is a vision inno-

vators and investors have been chasing for decades — those beams could turn the energy industry on its head. They would enable off-the-shelf solar panels to generate electricity even at night and could more than triple the amount of energy produced by a conventional solar farm.

As the scientists in Ashburn, Virginia, tinker with photovoltaic films, infrared rays and heat-resistant metals, a large wall-mounted digital clock

counts down toward January 2028. That's the deadline their four-year-old start-up, Overview Energy, has imposed for beaming its first batch of power from space.

"We really believe that we are able to provide utility-scale power with this technology," said co-CEO Darko Filipi. He estimated that his company could supply a quarter of the new energy the United States will need over the
SEE SOLAR ON A11

Supreme Court blocks Trump's sweeping mail ballot changes

BY MARK BERMAN, JUSTIN JOUVENAL AND PATRICK MARLEY

The Supreme Court on Monday blocked the Trump administration from moving forward with unprecedented new restrictions on mail ballots for the pivotal midterm elections.

The ruling, a major defeat for President Donald Trump, leaves intact election procedures and

prohibits changes that could have had significant impacts for millions of voters set to vote by mail in contests that will determine which party controls the House and Senate.

About one-third of voters used mail ballots in 2024.

In a brief order Monday evening, the majority did not explain its reasoning for leaving in place a lower court order blocking the administration's plans.

The majority wrote that the Trump administration was "unlikely to succeed on the merits of its challenge" to the lower court order.

Justice Brett M. Kavanaugh wrote in a concurrence that in his view, there was "at least a fair prospect" the administration's actions were within its authority. But, he continued, it "would be arbitrary and capricious" to impose the changes in the mid-

terms because state and local authorities would not have time to implement them.

Two other conservative justices — Samuel A. Alito Jr. and Clarence Thomas — dissented from the high court's decision Monday evening.

Alito, joined by Thomas, wrote that organizations challenging the plans probably lacked standing and that states doing so were making arguments unlikely to

succeed.

States had said there were practical issues involved in implementing the administration's changes so close to the midterms, Alito wrote, adding that he took that problem seriously. But he wrote that states challenging the plans and the courts "bear a substantial share of the blame" for the timing, saying the litigation and earlier court orders had ef-
SEE BALLOTS ON A7

Putin warns Europe of war over peacekeeping troops

Russian leader pointedly tells West not to send deployment into Ukraine

BY MARY ILYUSHINA

Offering a grim assessment of Russia's relations with the West, President Vladimir Putin pointedly warned European governments not to deploy any troops, including peacekeeping forces, to Ukraine, saying it would mean "war."

"They speak of contemplating the dispatch of troops to the territory of Ukraine," Putin said, following his participation Friday at a summit of leaders of the BRICS bloc of nations in New Delhi. "This would mean war with Russia."

Putin lashed out at what he

called systemic errors committed by the "West's globalist circles," insisting that Russia posed no danger to European countries, which he said "seek to frighten their populations with a mythical Russian threat."

He also insisted that the West was to blame for the war in Ukraine by seeking to expand NATO. "They directly supported separatism in the Caucasus and sought to break up Russia; this is a matter of fact. Furthermore, today's crisis in Ukraine was likewise instigated by them."

As if to put an exclamation point on Putin's remarks, a Russian drone strike hit passenger rail infrastructure in western Ukraine as many Western diplomats, officials and experts, including former CIA director
SEE RUSSIA ON A13

Ukraine setbacks: War effort has budget, weapons shortfalls. **A12**

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The Washington Post
Year 149, No. 54705



The Washington Post

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TO REACH THE OPINION PAGES
Letters to the editor: letters@washpost.com or call 202-334-9876
Opinion: oped@washpost.com

Published daily (ISSN 0190-8286).
POSTMASTER: Send address changes to The Washington Post, 1301 K St. NW, Washington, D.C. 20071.
Periodicals postage paid in Washington, D.C., and additional mailing office.

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Whitehead unhappy with movement’s direction

WHITEHEAD FROM A1

have been on a winning spree at the Supreme Court, overturning long-standing legal limits on religious expression by public officials, expanding religious exemptions and elevating the place of religious exercise to its highest point in modern times.

But Whitehead says the movement is not what he envisioned when he launched the Rutherford Institute in 1982.

The cause has become dangerously politicized and intertwined with right-wing politics, he says, wrongly staying quiet as Muslim rights are under attack and as President Donald Trump allows immigration enforcement officers into houses of worship. While religious-liberties-focused law firms have successfully argued in federal courts to greatly expand what it means to freely exercise one's faith, Whitehead says the movement has wrongly elevated the rights of conservative Christians over those of religious minorities.

He points to new laws in a handful of states mandating public schools to prominently hang the King James version of the Ten Commandments and threats last month by Texas officials against airports that offer foot-washing stations for Muslim travelers.

“We started out trying to protect the little people,” Whitehead said. Now leaders in the movement are “sitting in the White House with Trump. They’re now part of the nationalist movement. Religious liberty is a constitutional principle, not a political program.”

These days, Whitehead spends his time preparing for cases, writing essays and appearing on podcasts from his small Florida town, calling out his former colleagues for appearing at the White House or framing religious liberty as affiliated with a specific political party. He has become “persona non grata” in the movement, one former colleague says, and that is all right with the iconoclastic Whitehead.

“This is not faith. This is blasphemy baptized in nationalism,” Whitehead and his wife, Nisha Whitehead, wrote in March of Trump and Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth’s use of religious language to promote the war in Iran. In October, after then-Homeland Security secretary Kristi L. Noem prayed in public at an ICE facility in Portland, he wrote that her actions were “not Jesus’ Christianity — it is Christianity draped in the flag and wielding the weapons of war.”

Others who have worked with the Christian legal movement are also sounding the alarm.

“It’s become a partisan issue,” said Douglas Laycock, a prominent religious freedom scholar who worked with the Christian legal movement on influential and triumphant Supreme Court cases, including one in 1993 involving a Santeria group’s right to use animal sacrifice in worship. “Religious liberty is for everyone. Making it partisan is not good.”

As a young man, Whitehead was hostile toward religion and the Vietnam War, protesting even while he was serving in the Army in Fort Hood, Texas. He graduated from the University of Arkansas School of Law, and grew his hair long. He was a self-described Marxist and hippie. Whitehead says his life changed forever in the 1970s when he came across the apocalyptic blockbuster “The Late Great Planet Earth.”

The book, by the evangelical writer Hal Lindsay, argued the apocalypse was coming by comparing prophecies in the Bible and current events. Whitehead was enthralled, became a Christian and for a time studied to be a pastor.

Eventually he returned to lawyering and embraced religious liberty cases. Newly zealous, he wrote a book arguing that America should be an explicitly Christian nation — a position embraced in recent years by Hegseth, House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) and other Trump allies.

By the late 1980s, evangelical activists like Focus on the Family founder James Dobson and Campus Crusade for Christ founder Bill Bright were starting to agree with Whitehead’s belief that Christians needed to work to influence the courts and the culture. Rutherford was growing its staff and opening offices across the country. The firm took on mostly small, pro bono cases, representing a Christian girl in Virginia who was told she couldn’t read a Bible on a public school bus and a Hindu who refused jury duty on religious



PHOTOS BY ERICH MARTIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

John Whitehead, who helped found the Christian legal movement, says it has become dangerously intertwined with right-wing politics.

grounds.

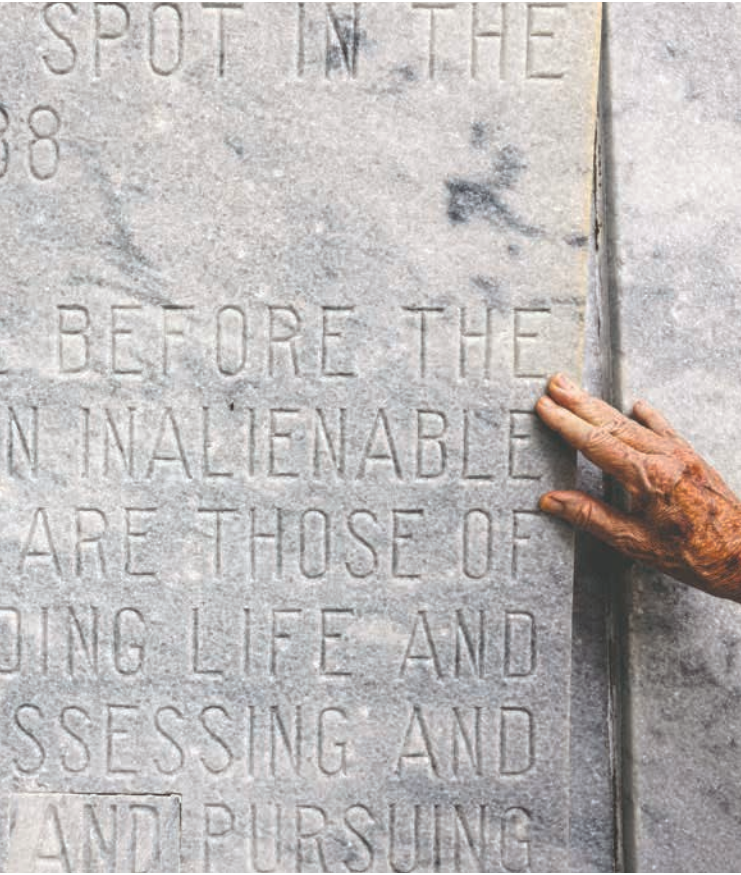
But Whitehead’s alliance with conservative Christian activists didn’t last. One breaking point was his decision in the late 1990s to represent Paula Jones, a former Arkansas state employee who said President Bill Clinton had sexually harassed her while he was Arkansas governor. Whitehead said the case was simply about showing even presidents aren’t above the law, but other conservative Christian legal groups saw it as salacious.

“He was going off on various things,” said Mat Staver, founder of Liberty Counsel, one of a slew of Christian religious liberty firms that cropped up after Rutherford. Staver also pointed to Whitehead’s founding of Gadfly, an offbeat culture magazine that “was like a totally different universe” for Christian conservatives. “He didn’t seem to have a clear voice, and it raised a lot of concern.”

The country was becoming more secular and socially liberal. Causes such as abortion, contraception, gay rights and women’s rights were increasingly challenging religious conservatives. Whitehead, who had argued in the 1980s that rights for LGBTQ people threatened Christians, was shifting too.

By the mid-1990s, he was criticizing an amendment to the Colorado state constitution that barred communities from passing laws to prohibit discrimination against gay and transgender people. To him, that case was just as much about constitutional rights as the case of the Virginia girl on the bus. Colorado voters approved the amendment.

He started moving away from Christian nationalism, which he says was the result of thinking differently about who Jesus really was. “We’re here to care for others,” he says now.



Whitehead runs his hand along one of his favorite passages on a monument in Constitution Convention Museum State Park.

After the terrorist attacks of Sept. 11, 2001, some Christian firms — already more focused on conservative causes — began “outright hostile advocacy against non-Christians,” especially Muslims, said Daniel Bennett, a John Brown University political scientist. One sued an Islamic community center trying to open a couple of blocks from the site of the attacks.

The firms broke from left-leaning organizations such as Americans United and the American Civil Liberties Union, which argued that religious liberty needed to be balanced with other individual protections

— especially civil rights protections.

The Christian religious liberty movement became “extreme,” said religious liberty scholar Marci Hamilton. She pointed to a legal tussle with advocates who wanted to broaden religious exemptions so landlords would not be required to rent to single mothers or unmarried couples under new fair housing laws.

Whitehead found himself somewhat in the middle, a place that maybe made sense for someone who counted among his best friends the evangelical theologian Francis Schaeffer

and the left-wing singer Pete Seeger.

He praises recent Supreme Court decisions affirming the protection of religious exercise, including a 2025 ruling that suburban Maryland parents’ religious rights were violated when the school system refused to let them opt their children out of book readings that involved same-sex couples. And he criticizes some Democratic actions, including covid pandemic-era restrictions on houses of worship that were stricter than those on other public spaces.

He says he finds value in some proposals of the Trump administration’s religious liberty commission, including efforts to create more “Know Your Rights” materials in places like schools and hospitals.

However, he said, the Christian legal movement is part of “a lot of overstepping.” He pointed to the Ten Commandments laws and to a Kentucky clerk who refused to issue marriage licenses to same-sex couples and was represented in court by religious liberties law firms.

“If the government is acting as a Christian nationalist organization as opposed to one representing the Constitution and all Americans, there is a problem,” Whitehead said.

Staver argues that the Christian law firms have stayed true to their mission, which is promoting conservative values and the free expression of religion.

“We haven’t changed,” Staver said. “They have.”

Whitehead says that he now sees other issues — including the rights of immigrants and the growth of Flock cameras and other surveillance — as more urgent than the issue of religious liberty.

He has argued in support of foreign nationals who lost their visas and were deported by the Trump administration after protesting against Israel, as well as universities whose funding was suspended as part of the White House’s campaign against diversity, equity and inclusion initiatives, campus protests and antisemitism. One brief argued against the administration’s decision to allow immigration enforcement inside houses of worship.

Whitehead also advocates through music and art. A recent exhibit included watercolor pieces showing human bodies merged with machines and one of a crying Statue of Liberty with a hand cut off titled “Freedom Amputated.”

These days, when he looks at the movement he helped start, Whitehead sees hypocrisy — people who too often defend religious liberty only on their own side.

“Religious liberty is a constitutional principle, not a political program,” he said. “The moment religious freedom organizations begin aligning themselves with those in power, or framing their work in partisan or ideological terms, they risk weakening the very principle they are trying to defend.”



Whitehead works on one of his paintings at his home in Port St. Joe, Florida, on Sept. 3.

THE NATION

He called himself ‘Donald Trump before Donald Trump.’ Now he could replace a House centrist in Maine.

BY PRAVEENA SOMASUNDARAM

BREWER, MAINE — Voters in a rare House district that went red for president and blue for Congress are on the verge of replacing one of the most centrist House Democrats with a hard-line conservative who called himself “Donald Trump before Donald Trump.”

Election forecasters see Maine’s former Republican governor Paul LePage as the likely winner in this rural district despite his history of incendiary comments such as “Black people come up the highway and they kill Mainers.”

LePage, now a MAGA devotee, would represent a sharp break from the incumbent Jared Golden’s moderate approach.

But LePage isn’t running against Golden, who retired rather than facing what could have been a tough primary contest. In his place, Democrats nominated state Auditor Matt Dunlap, a progressive who embraces policies such as Medicare-for-all and defeated a moderate backed by the party establishment in the primary.

The next direction of this politically eclectic enclave will be decided by independent-minded voters who have defined the district with their split-ticket voting.

“I don’t feel like there’s anybody for the independents,” Pam Remieres, 64, said on a recent sunny afternoon in Lewiston, where she lives. “Everybody just seems extreme right now on both sides.”

Voters here backed Trump in three presidential elections and elected Golden to represent them in Congress for the past eight years. Golden said he decided not to run again because politics had grown too uncivil and polarized.

While announcing his exit, Golden called out the leading candidates to succeed him.

“Paul LePage and Matt Dunlap

are a far cry from being standard bearers of the generations that will inherit the legacy of today’s Congress,” he wrote in a Bangor Daily News op-ed, later adding that “robust ideological diversity requires elected officials who are willing to represent the district as it truly exists — not as their party’s most vocal extremes might wish it did.”

Golden has not endorsed in the race, and his office did not respond to requests for comment. In Congress, Golden often votes with Republicans, a habit that has helped him fend off GOP challengers. He was one of two Democrats whose votes helped advance GOP bills to the House floor this month, angering Democratic leadership.

LePage and Dunlap are trying to prove that they, too, are willing to work across party lines. They’ve drawn heavily from the parts of their résumés that illustrate their day-to-day work in Maine.

Golden’s exit is forcing his constituents to reconsider what they want in a representative.

“Can they get the job done?” said Risten Bahr, a 75-year-old who lives in Bangor and has watched both candidates speak. “They have to convince me a lot.”

A staunch conservative

LePage, a former mayor of the college town Waterville, rode a wave of grassroots conservative anger to be elected in the tea party wave in 2010. He served two terms as governor from 2011 to 2019. His political career has been marked by brash, controversial comments.

He said drug traffickers with names like “D-Money” often come to Maine and “impregnate a young White girl.” When discussing drug dealers, he said “the enemy right now, the overwhelming majority of people coming in, are people of color or people of Hispanic origin.” He told the NAACP to “kiss my butt” when its leaders complained that he skipped Martin Luther

King Jr. Day events.

LePage has said he is not racist and has previously defended himself by citing how his family welcomed a Jamaican teenager to live with them for a few years.

“People that try to cast aspersions on him or what he is might not know his background, or choose to ignore his background,” said Brent Littlefield, an adviser to LePage’s campaign.

Last month, when he joined Vice President JD Vance for an appearance at a manufacturing facility in Brewer, LePage made no apologies for being unfiltered. He presented it as a skill that would help him in Washington.

“I don’t go along to get along,” LePage said.

On legislation that would help benefit Mainers, LePage said in Brewer that he would “work with anyone and everyone to make it happen, even Bernie Sanders.”

Vance, who also stumped for LePage in May, implored listeners to send him to Congress, describing him as a political friend and a fighter who would look after Mainers.

Bahr wasn’t so sure.

A registered Republican, Bahr, like many of her neighbors here, often votes for candidates of different parties on the same ballot. She had yet to make a decision on her congressional vote. The stances and styles of LePage and Dunlap, she thought, were so different from those of Golden, whom she appreciated for his willingness to work with Republicans.

She liked that LePage, in his own remarks before the vice president, talked about cracking down on fraud within government welfare programs. But she was wary of his “bull in a china shop” temperament, worried it would make working across the aisle harder.

Supporters of LePage during his two terms as governor and failed 2022 comeback bid are less concerned. Many of his remarks are more than a decade



GABE SOUZA/AP

Former Maine governor Paul LePage greets supporters last month before a campaign appearance with Vice President JD Vance at a manufacturing facility in Brewer, Maine.

old and have been overshadowed by the deluge of vulgar and inflammatory comments from Trump since he entered politics. Supporters praise LePage for how he handled the state’s budget during his tenure, something he has emphasized repeatedly on the trail.

“I thought he was truthful,” said Craig Rubner, a Republican who voted for LePage during his gubernatorial runs. “Blunt, very blunt, but truthful.”

A progressive challenger

One month before Golden said he would not run for his seat again, Dunlap announced plans to challenge him, vowing to stand up to Trump more than the incumbent.

Golden hit back. Dunlap, he said, was a “30-year party crony.”

“If Matt Dunlap thinks this district will choose him over Paul LePage, he’s got another thing coming,” he said.

In the June primary, Dunlap was the progressive standard-bearer. He has called for expanding federal welfare programs, instituting universal child care and raising taxes for America’s ultrarich. LePage and his Republican surrogates have cast him as too extreme for the district.

Democrats had similar concerns.

The campaign arm of House Democrats endorsed Maine state Sen. Joe Baldacci, whom they saw as the stronger, more moderate candidate in the primary. The group put Baldacci on its coveted “Red to Blue” list, a program that brings funding and other resources to candidates vying for targeted seats. It only added Dunlap to the program in August.

Baldacci, who endorsed Dunlap after losing the primary, said he was pleased to see national Democrats investing in the race despite his loss. When asked whether he thought Dunlap was too far to the left for the district, Baldacci told The Washington Post that was “up to voters to decide.”

In an interview with The Post, Dunlap rejected the idea that progressive policies weakened his candidacy.

“We call these things progressive because we have never done them,” he said.

Bahr, the undecided voter, remained skeptical.

She is among the seniors in Maine, the oldest state in the country, who rank health care and social safety nets high on their list of concerns. The payments for her eye injections and her husband’s cancer treatments were already tough. At the same time, she doesn’t think Medi-

care-for-all is doable.

“The whole system needs to be revamped in order to make that kind of policy work, and I don’t see that happening,” she said.

The day after Bahr watched Vance campaign for LePage, Dunlap gathered supporters a two-hour drive away in Lewiston for a town hall at a library. Dunlap pitched himself as a candidate who would listen to, rather than talk at, the people who live in the district.

An attendee who had started canvassing for Dunlap asked the candidate how to persuade independent voters to support his campaign.

“What would be some thoughts from you for those unenrolled voters, those people that are really in the middle?” the attendee asked.

Dunlap acknowledged that he knew the district had voters across the political spectrum but rejected descriptions of the district that made it seem as if it were a “hostile wilderness.”

But Dunlap said he saw campaigning as more about talking to his neighbors and friends than meeting and persuading hostile strangers.

“When you see people and recognize them and make them understand they matter, we’re halfway home,” he said.

At a rest stop in Delaware, we asked voters what they want from Democrats

People mentioned the ability to listen, to put on a united front and more

BY TEO ARMUS AND MICHELLE GUSTAFSON

NEWARK, DEL. — Outside a highway rest stop named after former president Joe Biden, it was easy to pick up on the frustration and lack of enthusiasm that many Democratic voters are feeling toward the party he once led. But many also said they’ll set those misgivings aside and vote for Democrats in November.

The responses are in line with recent national polling, which has found that more Democrats than Republicans are certain to vote, even as the Democratic Party’s favorability and public image remains weak. About 91 percent of Democratic registered voters said they would definitely vote, compared with 79 percent of Republicans, according to a YouGov-Economist poll from August. The same pollster has found the favorability rating of Democrats has steadily risen over the last year to 40.5 percent and 30 percent among independents.

The Washington Post interviewed dozens of voters at the Biden Welcome Center off Interstate 95. Here’s what they said they’re feeling about the 2026 midterm elections — and what they want from Democrats:

RONALD MAKARUTSA



PHOTOS BY MICHELLE GUSTAFSON/ FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

45, nurse practitioner in Tyngsborough, Massachusetts, will vote Democratic

They need to have more of a spine and stand up for one another. When a Republican does something, they all say the same thing until they achieve their goals. Some of the Democrats, they don’t support one another. ... They have to put up a united front.

LINDA BRETZ



79, retiree in Lancaster, Pennsylvania, will vote Democratic

We need to get more young people involved. ... They [also have to] talk to people and listen to people. We need to get the economy in better shape and stop this war that we should’ve never gotten into.

LINDSAY MORGAN



43, restaurant manager in Lancaster, Pennsylvania, will vote Democratic

Democrats need better people to run. If you want to change what’s happening, you have to get a powerhouse that doesn’t give the other side fuel to say we have ‘Sleepy Joe.’ [But] they need not to fall so far left that it detracts from some of those Republicans you might capture.

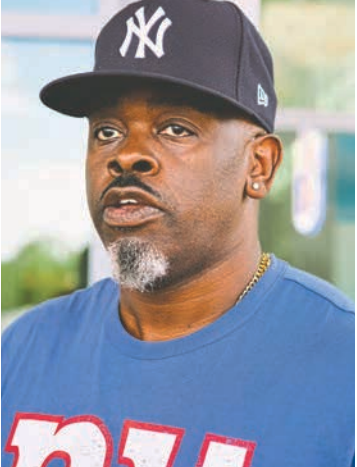
DANI WHARTON



34, train conductor trainer in Wilmington, Delaware, will vote, but not sure for what party

With everything going on, all politics is becoming one category. ... We need somebody to take us out of this deep depression that we’re all in.

COREY ODOM



48, federal employee in Laurel, Maryland, will vote Democratic

I’m looking for politicians to get more serious about my kids’ generation and their needs. There’s so much of a focus on stuff that’s not important, that’s not for everybody, that doesn’t bring us back to what the responsibility of the government is. ... You need to move boldly to protect people.

CARLOS ROMAN



21, college student in Newark, Delaware, will not vote

The Democratic and Republican Party are just two groups that serve one group, and that collective is the oligarchy.

LESLEY KRAULAND



61, vocational deacon in University Park, Maryland, will vote Democratic

They need to offer a strong five-year plan: Where are they going to go? How are we going to resurrect our friendships with our allies? How are we going to resurrect our institutions that have taken such a serious blow?

ED KRAULAND



71, attorney in Potomac, Maryland, will vote Democratic

Democrats need more courage with regard to addressing what I consider to be undemocratic and not helpful policies of the current administration.

ASHISH PANDY



39, driver and nonprofit founder in Queens, will vote, but not sure for what party

People have forgotten humanity. ... Rather than big issues, rather than bringing up Russia or the Middle East, they should be bringing up things that matter to people: People shouldn’t be hungry. They should have access to a good life.

DAVON ANDERSON



34, sales director in Blackwood, New Jersey, leaning toward voting Democratic

I support whoever’s more realistic with their policies. ... If we get somebody that’s fair and honest, I would put more backing behind them.

Texas GOP denounce Republican’s racist post

BY AMY B WANG

A slew of Texas Republicans have denounced Bo French, the Republican nominee for Texas Railroad commissioner, for racist social media posts over the weekend about students at the University of Texas at Austin.

In a Sunday morning post on X, French shared a photo of University of Texas students at a home football game — most of whom appeared to be non-White and almost all were decked out in the Longhorns’ burnt orange and white — gleefully celebrating UT’s victory over Ohio State.

“I heard UT graduation this year looked like this. I didn’t believe it,” French wrote. “The problem is now obviously far worse than anyone imagined.”

French later posted the same picture and wrote that “social media is exposing how many Americans have been displaced by foreigners.”

His campaign did not immediately respond to a request for comment Monday morning. French made multiple posts Sunday denigrating diversity practices and foreign students and complaining that “heritage Americans” were discriminated against.

A representative for the University of Texas at Austin declined to comment Monday.

Many statewide GOP officials condemned French’s posts, as did outgoing Sen. John Cornyn (R-Texas), who said such behavior was “how great political parties self-destruct” and called on other Republicans to condemn French’s “intolerance and racism.”

Texas House Speaker Dustin Burrows (R) and Republican state Reps. Lacey Hull, Jeff Leach, Jared Patterson and Dade Phelan also publicly denounced French or called on him to delete his posts.

“This is racist. It is wrong. And I condemn it without reservation. ... These are 20-year-old kids cheering for their university — not political props and not targets for racial attacks,” wrote Patterson, an alum of UT rival Texas A&M University. (“You known Bo French really stepped in it because I’m seeing Aggies defend UT,” one X user observed.)

Democrats also widely condemned French’s posts. French’s Democratic opponent, Texas state Rep. Jon Rosenthal, used the moment to tout his qualifications for being elected to the three-person Railroad Commission of Texas, which is responsible for regulating the state’s oil and natural gas industry.

“I spent 25 years as an engineer in the oil and gas industry. Bo French spent Sunday morning sorting the ... student section by skin color. ... A man who can’t tell a Longhorn from a foreigner has no business regulating anything in Texas,” Rosenthal said in a statement.

The commissioner elections are typically not high-profile races that draw the national spotlight. French, however, has regularly made inflammatory and racist statements throughout his candidacy, including calling for Native Americans to be denaturalized and deported.

After a close GOP primary race triggered a runoff between French and incumbent Jim Wright, President Donald Trump endorsed Wright. French narrowly won the May primary runoff by about one percentage point.

French’s latest incendiary posts come at a time when Republicans are already nervous about the unusually close races for Senate and governor unfolding in the state.

In a statement to The Washington Post, Texas Gov. Greg Abbott (R), who is running for a fourth term against Democratic state Rep. Gina Hinojosa, said that French’s tweet was “not my message” and that the pictured showed how Texans unite.

“The way we win the state is the same way we win football games. We unite under the brand of Texas,” Abbott said.

In the same statement, Abbott also encouraged strict immigration laws and touted freezing H-1B visas at Texas universities. And unlike other Republicans who criticized French, Abbott did not post his statement online, did not explicitly condemn French’s posts and did not call on French to delete them.

Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton (R), the Republican nominee for Senate, posted that said he condemned racism “in all its forms” but quickly pivoted to attacking his Democratic Senate opponent, James Talarico.

McConnell returns to Senate and casts vote

Kentucky Republican had been away since he suffered a fall in June

BY THEODORIC MEYER

Sen. Mitch McConnell (R-Kentucky) voted Monday in the Senate for the first time in months, making his first public appearance at the Capitol since he had a fall in June at home.

McConnell traveled the few blocks from his Washington home as senators returned to Washington to cast their first votes since the Senate adjourned Aug. 8 for a five-week recess. He provided the deciding vote to advance the nomination of Matthew R. Byrne to a district court judgeship in Ohio.

In a statement, McConnell described his recovery as “a long and often frustrating process” made no easier by the lingering effects of his childhood polio.

“I’m still not quite back to 100%, but I’ve assured Leader Thune that, as I continue with physical therapy on the advice of my doctors, I will do my best to be present for tough votes when our Conference needs me,” McConnell said, referring to Senate Majority Leader John Thune (R-South Dakota).

McConnell, 84, was hospitalized June 14 following a fall at home, according to his office. He later moved to a rehabilitation center, from which he was discharged Aug. 6 to continue his recovery at home.

McConnell’s extended absence sparked widespread speculation and even some conspiracy theories about his condition. He gave no interviews and until Monday had made no public appearances



Sen. Mitch McConnell (R-Kentucky) speaks to reporters outside the Senate chamber on Monday.

since his hospitalization. His office has shared two photos of him taken during his recovery, and he said in a statement in July that he did not break any bones when he fell and did not suffer a concussion, a heart attack, a stroke or a hemorrhage. He also disclosed that he was diagnosed with “a mild case of pneumonia” while hospitalized.

Those details did not quell

intense speculation about his health and when he would return.

Kentucky Gov. Andy Beshear (D) demanded in July that McConnell “provide proof of his capacity to serve, or resign.” Scott Jennings, a longtime McConnell ally who worked on some of his reelection campaigns, told CNN’s “The Arena With Kasie Hunt” that more transparency

from McConnell “would have saved him a whole lot of grief.”

McConnell is not the first senator to be away from the Senate for months while ailing or in recovery.

Sen. John Fetterman (D-Pennsylvania) was absent for two months in 2023 while seeking treatment for depression. Sen. Dianne Feinstein (D-California) missed nearly three months of

GOP nominee for Florida House marched with neo-Nazis

Rawson has acknowledged involvement with a group

BY VIOLET JIRA AND OLIVIA GEORGE

A Republican nominee to Florida’s state legislature marched with members of the white supremacist group League of the South at the deadly 2017 “Unite the Right” rally in Charlottesville.

Rawson, 34, won the Republican primary for Florida House District 10 on Aug. 18 with about 55 percent of the vote. And he is heavily favored to win his race in the strongly Republican district.

His attendance at the deadly white supremacist rally in 2017 was first reported by Talking Points Memo.

Rawson did not respond to requests for comment from The Washington Post. In a statement to Talking Points Memo, he said he had spent his adult life defending historical monuments and did not screen his campaign donors. He did not directly address his attendance at the Charlottesville rally in that statement.

Rawson has acknowledged involvement with the League of the South, a neo-Confederate organization that advocates Southern secession and that the Southern



Marshall Rawson, who is heavily favored to win his race, marched at the deadly 2017 “Unite the Right” rally in Charlottesville.

Poverty Law Center identifies as a white nationalist hate group.

He told a local TV news station WCJB in August that his official participation had ended more than a decade ago. But the station reported that he attended a League event in 2019 and spoke at one of its conferences in 2021.

“I was involved in an activist phase that was really fighting on issues that mattered to everyday people,” Rawson told the Florida ABC News affiliate station. He attributed the scrutiny of

his past to the Southern Poverty Law Center and his Republican primary opponent, who he said “colluded” with Democrats to damage his campaign.

In a Facebook post in May 2025, Rawson wrote that his involvement with the group stretched from 2013 to 2016 and involved rallying against issues including “unfettered immigration” and advocating for “historic monuments that were being attacked by woke rioters.”

He predicted people would try to wield this connection against

him, he wrote, and compared the criticism to attacks directed at President Donald Trump and Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis.

“This is the same worn-out rhetoric that the left (and in some cases other Republicans) have used against Trump and DeSantis in the past,” Rawson wrote.

League of the South gained national attention after its members attended the 2017 Charlottesville rally, where Rawson was present.

White supremacists descended on Charlottesville in August 2017 with guns and kerosene-filled torches for an ultimately deadly rally that awakened the nation to a resurgence of far-right extremism.

Talking Points Memo reported that an archived YouTube video shows Rawson and his wife arriving at the rally and being greeted by name by League of the South members. Footage appears to show Rawson marching while carrying the group’s flag. The outlet also obtained a photograph showing Rawson standing near James Alex Fields Jr., who later drove into a crowd of counterprotesters.

Fields killed 32-year-old Heather Heyer and injured dozens of others. He was convicted of murder and federal hate crimes and is serving life in prison.

In addition to his involvement with League of the South,

Rawson reportedly accepted campaign contributions from individuals with ties to white supremacist organizations.

Rawson’s campaign was endorsed by former U.S. Reps. Ted Yoho (R-Fla.) and Paul Broun (R-Ga.). Neither man responded to requests for comment from The Post.

His opponent, Democrat Merrill Lee Malwitz-Jipson denounced Rawson in a post to social media Monday.

“While his background has been casually talked about for years, the documented degree of his involvement and the carryover to his campaign has not been fully known,” she said. “This physical evidence is extremely alarming.”

“We must put hatred, secession, and fear behind us as a country, which means we cannot elect Marshall Rawson,” she wrote.

Malwitz-Jipson did not respond to calls for comment.

The Washington Post reported on Friday that an Ohio Senate campaign staffer for Sen. John Husted used Nazi imagery in his profile picture. In August, The Post reported that a former staffer for Georgia Senate hopeful Mike Collins had posted KKK and Nazi imagery.

The Florida GOP, Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis and Florida House Speaker Pro Tempore Wyman Duggan did not respond on Monday to requests for comment.

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THE D.C. DINING SCENE HAS A NEW GUIDE

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Trump says he likes Flock license-plate cameras amid growing backlash

BY AOIFE WALSH

President Donald Trump expressed his support for a fast-growing surveillance tool opposed by many Americans, saying he likes Flock cameras “because of law enforcement.”

“I sort of like them because of that, because of law enforcement, but some people don’t,” Trump told reporters aboard Air Force One on Sunday in his first public comments endorsing the technology. “They think it’s an infringement. I like them.”

Trump has previously side-stepped questions about his stance on the artificial intelligence-powered license-plate readers that have provoked broad privacy and surveillance concerns. Asked about them in the Oval Office last month, he said: “It’s being studied right now. We’ll have an answer ... as to our views on it over the next couple of weeks.”

Trump’s new comments on Flock came shortly after he rejected calls from top AI leaders to limit the pace of development of artificial intelligence

models. “We’re leading China in AI, we’re the most sophisticated country in the world, and frankly I want to keep it that way,” he said on the sidelines of the Irish Open golf tournament. “Whoever wins AI, wins.”

Atlanta-based Flock has a network of more than 120,000 cameras across the U.S. The cameras record 20 billion license plate scans every month, the company says, which have helped officers investigate 1 million crimes a year.

The surveillance systems

had broad support as recently as last year, but an August survey by YouGov of approximately 20,000 U.S. adults found that 46 percent said they oppose the technology being used in their communities, compared with 38 percent support.

The same month, an investigation by The Washington Post found dozens of law enforcement officers have been charged with or accused of misusing the plate-reading technology. Soon after, Flock announced changes to its platform to prevent the camera

network from being abused by police officers, including a requirement for every search to be labeled with a criminal case number.

But the technology has increasingly become a topic of political debate ahead of the mid-term elections, with candidates from both parties outlining their opposition to them.

“Do you ever feel like you are in a cage, kind of stuck, being watched?” U.S. Senate candidate Abdul El-Sayed asked in a video posted last month. “Well, that is because you are,” the

Michigan Democrat continued, before criticizing what he called the “mass proliferation of” Flock cameras across the country.

Rep. Keith Self, a Republican running for reelection in Texas, mentioned the cameras in a social media post, saying: “Big Brother has NO place in the Lone Star State.”

Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis (R) last month said the cameras are “out of control.”

“I don’t want to have this become a surveillance state,” he added.

Alligator Alcatraz detainees were put in small cages, DHS watchdog report finds

BY SILVIA FOSTER-FRAU

Immigrants at the Florida detention center known as Alligator Alcatraz were kept in “small metal enclosures” for up to nearly two hours in what the Department of Homeland Security’s internal watchdog is calling a highly unusual and inhumane detention practice.

The DHS Office of Inspector General report says the enclosures were 4 feet 3 inches wide and 7 feet 9 inches tall. The facility’s staff referred to them as “calming areas.” Investigators said they learned of at least one instance where the cage may have been used to discipline a detainee. Investigators described the use of cages as “a practice unlike any” they had observed at Immigration and Customs Enforcement facilities.

“The use of such restrictive spaces is highly unconventional and does not align with standards for humane treatment,” the report said.

The facility, built in the heart of the Florida Everglades, became a symbol of the aggressive tactics used by the Trump administration on undocumented immigrants. Detainees and former guards described miserable living conditions to The Washington Post just two weeks

after the facility opened in July 2025. Florida Gov. Ron DeSantis (R) said that federal authorities had detained and processed between 22,000 and 25,000 immigrants there by June of this year. The state shuttered the facility later that month.

Alex Lanfranconi, the governor’s communications director, said in a statement that the small cages were “a confinement area for violent criminal aliens who have proven they cannot remain peaceful while awaiting deportation.”

“While it adheres to all federal standards for criminal confinement, we’d make it even smaller if we could,” Lanfranconi added.

A recent Washington Post analysis of government data found that under Trump, ICE has largely been targeting people with civil immigration violations but no criminal convictions. ICE states on its website that “Detention is non-punitive.” Yet many immigrant detention facilities rely on the same kinds of tools and tactics that jails and prisons use to maintain control.

The inspector general’s investigation found that the facility complied with use-of-force and intake standards. But it said the nearly 1,500 detainees were living in “cramped conditions”



The DHS Office of Inspector General report showed images of the “small metal enclosures” where immigrants at Alligator Alcatraz in Florida were held. “The use of such restrictive spaces is highly unconventional and does not align with standards for humane treatment,” the watchdog report said.

inside windowless housing pods without views to the outside or natural light. Images in the report show rows of bunk beds enclosed in fencing. The facility had well below the required amount of square footage per detainee, the report said, with about three times the number of detainees per pod than recommended by state standards.

Detainees were not allowed

to shower daily, which violated state standards, and the showers were infested with small bugs, investigators found. Detainees also had insufficient recreational time and lacked access to legal information, which may have prevented them from contacting a lawyer.

A DHS spokesperson said detention facilities are held to the same standards they were

under previous administrations and that “any allegations of inhumane conditions” are false.

But Corene Kendrick, deputy director of the ACLU’s National Prison Project, said the report confirms what media outlets and civil rights organizations like hers have previously reported: that the conditions at Alligator Alcatraz did not meet detention standards.

The cages “look like dog kennels in an animal shelter,” Kendrick said. “It’s horrific.”

Amnesty International issued a report last year after speaking with detainees at multiple Florida detention centers, including Alligator Alcatraz. The report described a facility with overflowing toilets, sewage seeping into sleeping areas, limited shower access and inconsistent medical care. The organization also found people had been put into small cages — described in the report as a “box” — for hours while their ankles were shackled to restraints on the ground, which Amnesty alleged amounted to torture.

The ACLU sued the federal government and the state of Florida for allegedly not providing detainees access to lawyers. The ACLU’s lawsuit was dissolved after the detention center closed.

DHS told investigators that the state was in charge of the facility’s daily operations, according to the Inspector General’s report. But the investigators said that facilities with ICE detainees must comply with certain ICE standards.

The ACLU and other rights groups contend Alligator Alcatraz isn’t the only ICE facility that has violated federal detention standards.

“Unfortunately the abuse and neglect that the people suffered at Alligator Alcatraz is not unique,” Kendrick said. “I think this is a wake-up call to show this is not an anomaly, this is how ICE is treating the people in our communities.”



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Election officials’ big fear: Trump’s federal government

Seized ballots, ICE agents at the polls are among their concerns

BY PATRICK MARLEY
AND LAURA MECKLER

The activists staking out the ballot drop boxes in suburban Phoenix wore body armor and face coverings. With guns at their sides, they recorded residents as they deposited their votes during the last midterm elections.

Voting-rights groups sued, and a federal judge put a stop to them, ruling they had to stay at least 250 feet away while armed to ensure voters were not intimidated.

Four years later and 100 miles to the south, Pima County Attorney Laura Conover is treating the 2022 incident as a lesson on the importance of moving quickly this fall if anyone — including Immigration and Customs Enforcement agents — tries to interfere with the election’s administration. For her county along the U.S.-Mexico border, Conover has drawn up court papers so she can immediately file litigation to protect the vote.

“When it comes to preparing for elections, we are on overdrive,” she said.

In 2022, one of the greatest threats to elections came from activists like the armed men and women looming near drop boxes and questioning America’s voting procedures. This year, Conover and other officials across the nation are preparing for the possibility that the most serious risks may come from President Donald Trump, his agencies and allies — including many now in power at the federal, state and local levels. Election officials are contemplating ideas that once sounded outlandish, such as troops seizing voting machines, the president dictating last-minute election rules or rogue officials blocking the certification of results.

For the last year and a half, Trump and his administration have disparaged long-standing voting practices, dismantled federal agencies that protect elections, impounded ballots from past elections, amplified conspiracy theories, threatened to prosecute election officials, tried to limit mail ballots and pushed to require proof of citizenship to register to vote.

Their efforts have touched on nearly every stage of voting and could affect control of Congress, as Republicans try to retain their slim majority. A Democratic takeover of the House would stall Trump’s agenda, block funding for his initiatives, trigger a flood of investigations and mire his administration in congressional hearings.

The high stakes seem top of mind for the president. “I’m going to be impeached,” he warned supporters at a South Carolina rally last month.

With seven weeks until Election Day and some ballots already in the mail, the White House and election administrators are clashing over nearly every aspect of the midterms, from who is eligible to vote to whether absentee ballot envelopes must have barcodes on them.

Agents, troops and monitors

Last month, former Trump adviser Stephen K. Bannon told the audience of his popular MAGA podcast that the president should send an “up-armored ICE presence at these polling booths.”

Critics might call that intimidation, Bannon said, and they would be right. “It’s an intimidation if you’re a foreigner,” he said. “It should be intimidating.”

In Maine, the Republican nominee for governor also said he’d ask the administration to send ICE agents to the polls. Georgia’s Republican gubernatorial nominee spoke favorably of using National Guard troops. The GOP candidate for governor in Michigan said he’s talked to the head of the FBI about agents having a presence in the state ahead of Election Day. All three states are key in determining which party will control Congress and, after 2028, the presidency.

Federal law makes it a felony to station troops or armed agents where an election is being held. But the statute carves out an exception for repelling enemies of the United States, and Trump’s critics worry he could invoke that provision by arguing without evidence that noncitizens could try to vote.

Even a brief appearance by troops at the polls — and the inevitable online clips of them there — could dissuade voters from casting ballots, election officials and experts worry.



ILLUSTRATION BY ANSON CHAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST/ANSON CHAN FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

The talk of troops and federal authorities at the polls has pushed local officials into preparation mode. This year, 10 Democratic prosecutors from around the country, including Conover in Arizona’s Pima County, formed a group to push back on the administration on elections and other matters.

They call their group Fight Against Federal Overreach — or FAFO, after the slang term for messing around and finding out. They trade tips every two weeks on video calls.

“With this president, you have to prepare for anything and everything,” Conover said. Mary Moriarty, the top prosecutor in Minnesota’s Hennepin County, which includes Minneapolis, said she’ll be watching for ICE agents at the polls.

“They certainly know we’ve charged two ICE agents already and that we take this seriously,” said Moriarty, a member of FAFO who filed charges against agents for incidents during the federal agency’s enforcement surge in the Twin Cities.

Most worrisome to local leaders is the possibility that federal officials could seize ballots or voting equipment.

They don’t consider the prospect theoretical. In January, Trump told the New York Times he regretted not having troops take possession of voting machines after he lost the 2020 election. The FBI later took 2020 ballots in Georgia and obtained electronic images of 2020 ballots in Arizona. And the MAGA-aligned sheriff of Riverside County, California, confiscated ballots from a 2025 redistricting referendum.

The military’s top officer said last month that the administration has no plans to send troops to polling places in November.

“I have neither received nor anticipate receiving any unlawful order concerning the role of the Joint Force in the upcoming November 2026 midterm elections,” Gen. Dan Caine, chairman of the Joint Chiefs of Staff, wrote in a letter to Sen. Elissa Slotkin (D-Michigan).

He said the military has no plans to use troops to seize ballots, voting machines or other election material.

Homeland Security Secretary Markwayne Mullin has been less categorical, but said this month that ICE would go to polling places only if agents were looking for someone or to respond to a threat. “If we’re serving a warrant, we will be where we need to be,” he said.

The Justice Department said it will beef up its plans to send election monitors to polls this fall. A top department official has said she would deploy as many as 1,000 of them, but hasn’t said where they will go.

The approach has drawn objections, including from Republicans. Wyoming Gov. Mark Gordon (R) called the conduct of Justice Department attorneys who monitored primaries last month “aggressive” and “irregular” after a county clerk said they asked to examine voting machines.

“I don’t like the federal gov-

ernment coming in and taking our votes,” Gordon said.

Rushing to rewrite mail voting rules

Inside the U.S. Postal Service this summer, software engineers and policymakers scrambled to build something new: a verification system that, according to an anonymous whistleblower, could hold up an untold number of ballots.

By late August, members of the team realized the rushed schedule would leave them just four days to test the full system. When a member raised concerns about the technology’s quality and the lack of testing, a senior Postal Service official gave little guidance other than saying, “We cannot fail.” The official said everything must work perfectly and there was no other choice, according to the whistleblower disclosure that a federal official submitted to Congress two weeks ago.

As the deadline approached, multiple officials used profanity to describe the plan as a disaster, calling it a “s--- show,” according to the disclosure. The Postal Service was scheduled to launch the technology on Sept. 1, but so far it hasn’t been made available.

Under the Postal Service plans, election officials would upload lists of voters through an online portal. They would then submit their mail ballots to the post office, sometimes in batches of thousands at a time. If postal clerks found any mismatches — including for voters who moved or got married and changed their names — they would reject the entire batch, according to the whistleblower.

The Postal Service moved fast, but it did not compromise its work, Postmaster General David Steiner said in a statement. “We stand behind both the rigor of our process and the resulting system,” he said.

Trump signed an executive order telling the Postal Service in March to review ballot envelopes and limit who could receive mail ballots. A federal judge blocked the order in June, but last month the Supreme Court cleared the way for it to temporarily go into effect when it found states had sued prematurely.

After the Postal Service formally announced its new rules, the judge — hearing the challenge again — blocked those plans. The administration again asked the Supreme Court to give it the green light.

On Monday, the Supreme Court blocked the Trump administration from moving forward with unprecedented new restrictions on mail ballots for the midterm elections.

Local officials in North Carolina and Wisconsin started mailing ballots to voters early this month under existing policies. Other jurisdictions are set to do the same soon.

“It’s the potential for complete chaos,” said Gerry Cohen, a Democrat on the Board of Elections for Wake County, North Carolina.

A recent incident in Leon County, Florida, brought a preview of the confusion Trump’s last-minute rules could bring.

The county elections supervisor submitted his ballot envelope to the Postal Service in case the new rules go into effect — only to have the Postal Service reject it because the return address was 0.014 inches too close to another line of text.

The Postal Service later relented and accepted the envelope, but Mark Earley, Leon’s elections supervisor, said Friday that the incident was a taste of the nationwide “chaos and confusion” possible if the rules go into effect.

Hunting for noncitizen voters

Trump’s executive order in March also directed the Department of Homeland Security to assemble a list of citizens for states to check their voter rolls against. And it instructed the attorney general to prioritize prosecuting state officials who issue ballots to ineligible people.

His plan is premised on debunked claims that voting by noncitizens is rampant. Voting-rights advocates and election officials warn Trump’s agenda could lead to a raft of uncounted ballots from eligible voters.

The federal government’s citizenship data is often flawed. Anthony Nel of Denton, Texas, learned that last year when he faced the prospect of losing his right to vote.

Nel, a 29-year-old higher education administrator who said he leans liberal, received a letter telling him he would soon be kicked off the voter rolls because state officials weren’t sure whether he was a citizen. Nel, who was born in South Africa and became a U.S. citizen in his teens, didn’t have time to renew his expired passport before officials removed him from the rolls. He reregistered once he updated his passport but worries voters with less time and money could lose their right to cast ballots.

Trump’s plans are “being described as voting security,” Nel said. “From what I am seeing, it looks more like voter suppression.”

Trump continues to spread unsupported claims that voting by noncitizens is partly to blame for his 2020 loss. But court records and independent reviews show noncitizens rarely register to vote or try to cast ballots. Georgia officials determined noncitizens accounted for about 0.002 percent of the state’s registered voters and a study of voting in 42 jurisdictions in 2016 found one potential noncitizen vote for every 783,000 ballots.

That hasn’t stopped Trump and his allies, who have pointed to a software glitch in New Jersey that led to the state motor vehicles division inadvertently registering about 6,600 noncitizens in 2023 and 2024. They say that error shows the need for more scrutiny of voter rolls.

The administration’s approach is meant to protect elections and “ensure states’ voter rolls are accurate, up-to-date and do not include aliens who are not eligible to vote or to be registered to vote,” said Zach Kahler, a spokesman for U.S. Citizenship and Immigration Services.

The push for emergency powers

Since Trump returned to office last year, his backers — including Bannon and a lawyer close to Trump — have pressed the president to declare a national emergency that they say would unlock powers for him to rewrite election rules.

The idea resurfaced last month, when Trump appeared on a Real America’s Voice program hosted by Wayne Allyn Root. With election legislation stalled in the Senate, Root pressed Trump to declare an emergency that he said would allow him to limit mail ballots and require people to prove their citizenship to register to vote.

“Let me just say that stranger things have happened, okay?” Trump responded. “I’ll leave it at that.”

Peter Ticktin, a lawyer and longtime Trump friend who has spent months urging the president to declare an election emergency, called Trump’s answer “definitely a shift.”

“I’m feeling good about my prospects,” Ticktin said.

The White House did not answer questions about whether Trump is considering declaring an emergency.

On legal grounds, the theory that the president can claim power over elections by declaring an emergency is laughable, said Hofstra University law professor James Sample. But Sample is treating it as deadly serious.

In the weeks after Trump lost the 2020 election, lawyers backing him came up with another theory Sample viewed as preposterous: that Vice President Mike Pence could reject some states’ electoral votes and let Trump claim victory. Pence refused, but the theory set the stage for the Jan. 6, 2021, attack on the U.S. Capitol.

The Constitution gives states and Congress authority over elections, not the president. A national emergency declaration triggers greater powers under federal law, Sample said, but none of them affect elections.

The risk, he said, isn’t whether the notion would survive in court. It’s that Trump could use it to take sweeping actions while voting is ongoing and before courts can respond.

“The idea is simply to do first and say, ‘So what?’” Sample said. “So much of Trump 2.0 is to out-run and outpace the courts.”

When officials refuse to certify

Perils lurk even after votes are cast.

In 2022, commissioners in New Mexico’s Otero County listened as an attorney insisted they were obligated to certify that year’s midterm results.

This kind of motion was normally a drama-free event. But the three commissioners didn’t see it that way, and they delivered their votes in rapid succession: “Nay,” “Nay,” “Nay.”

Among other issues, they cited debunked conspiracy theories about Dominion Voting Systems machines that had circulated in MAGA circles since Trump refused to accept his 2020 defeat.

“I have huge concerns with these voting machines, I really do,” said Commissioner Vickie Marquardt.

After the attorney told the commissioners that a court would likely force them to certify, Marquardt laughed. “So then what? They’re going to send us to the pokey?” she responded, using another word for jail.

Certification is the final stage of an election, when local and state officials sign off on vote tallies so the winners can take office. But in recent years, officials in pockets of the country have tried to block results by refusing to certify them — 35 of them in eight states from 2020 to mid-2024, according to Citizens for Responsibility and Ethics in Washington, a research and advocacy group that has sued the Trump administration over its election policies.

Those efforts have failed. The Otero County standoff, for example, ended when a court ordered the election certified and Marquardt and another commissioner relented.

Marquardt doesn’t know what she will do this November. She said she still has “huge concerns” about the security of mail ballots, voting machines and drop boxes.

“I would do it again if I felt strongly about it because I don’t think it’s right to certify something you don’t think is right,” she said.

A refusal to certify results creates legal uncertainty and, even if it fails, can undermine faith in how elections are run. Some fear those who block certification could try to prevent the winners from taking office in Congress. Disputes must be settled quickly because the winners are slated to take office in early January.

In Nevada’s Washoe County, Commissioner Jeanne Herman has voted against certifying every election since 2020, including her own reelection. Those elections were certified with the approval of others on the commission.

“Elections need to be fair and honest, and until they are, I’m not going to lie and say this election was great,” she said.

Similar clashes could emerge elsewhere, with potential hot spots in Arizona, Georgia, Michigan and Texas, according to the nonpartisan Voting Rights Lab.

Once local officials question their own results, “the damage has already been done in terms of public confidence,” said Charley Olena, a senior vice president with the nonprofit group.

One ballot at a time

Whatever the courts decide, and no matter the moves Trump makes, November’s election will largely depend on thousands of local jurisdictions and the hundreds of thousands of workers staffing them.

On a recent August afternoon in Madison, Wisconsin, three of them sat around a table to decide whether one person’s vote should count.

The ballot had come in an envelope that was partially unsealed. Poll workers hadn’t counted it on the night of the gubernatorial primary, citing the possibility that someone could have tampered with it. Now the city’s Board of Canvassers examined the envelope, passing it back and forth and running their fingers along its edge. One corner of the flap wasn’t sealed. The rest of it was.

“I don’t think you can grab the ballot out,” said Lydia McComas, the city clerk.

The board counted the ballot and moved on to other quirks and anomalies. At least one voter’s ballot was not counted because of a jam in a voting machine. Another voter was given a ballot for the wrong ward. And one voter was inadvertently issued a ballot in the name of another person with the same name.

For more than two centuries, officials across America have been carrying out this painstaking work.

In recent years, Madison — a Democratic bastion in a swing state — has come under fire for mistakes. McComas’s predecessor resigned last year after 193 ballots went uncounted in 2024. In this spring’s contest for a state Supreme Court seat, workers failed to transport 23 absentee ballots to counting sites before polls closed, nearly preventing them from being tallied.

Local officials make mistakes, McComas said, but they learn from them to make future elections run more smoothly. It’s important to let the public scrutinize their work at every stage, she said, from testing machines to tallying results.

“If the public’s not confident in our work,” she said, “they’re not confident in democracy.”

Supreme Court’s ruling on mail ballot restrictions is big loss for the president

BALLOTS FROM A1

fectively shaped the calendar. Election administrators in a number of states run by Democrats and Republicans alike have said it would be extremely challenging — if not impossible — to implement the administration’s changes with less than two months to go before elections. Some states have already started sending out mail-in ballots and others will soon follow. An anonymous federal whistleblower also warned that voters could be disenfranchised and ballot delivery disrupted, asserting that the system created to implement the plan was rushed and did not undergo adequate testing. The Trump administration disputes that characterization. The Supreme Court’s decision ends — for now — a dizzying legal battle among blue states, voting rights groups and the administration that has ping-ponged through the courts in recent weeks. The Trump administration says the new restrictions, which were laid out in a March executive order, are necessary to prevent voter fraud. Trump has long claimed without evidence that voter fraud — particularly by noncitizens and with mail ballots — is rampant, but studies have found such instances are rare. Under Trump’s plan, states would have to use ballot envelopes containing barcodes to combat fraud, and they would have to provide the federal government with lists of voters who are eligible to receive mail ballots.



JENNY KANE/AP

An election worker looks through mail ballots at the Clark County Elections Office in Vancouver, Washington, in March 2024.

were on our side,” said Virginia Kase Solomón, president of the nonprofit group Common Cause. The White House and Justice Department did not immediately respond to requests for comment Monday night about the Supreme Court’s ruling. The high court’s order dealt only with applying the changes to the upcoming midterms. The case now returns to the lower courts, where legal fights will continue over whether the order can be implemented in future elections, including the 2028 presidential contest. That legal battle could return to the Supreme Court in the years ahead. The administration last week had asked the justices to overturn a preliminary injunction by U.S. District Judge Indira Talwani, an Obama appointee in Massachusetts, that blocked its plan from going into effect. “The Rule ensures that States remain responsible for determining voter eligibility and eligibility to vote by mail, and it does not dictate ballot content, mailing or receipt deadlines, or ballot-counting procedures,” the appeal said. “The Rule thus plainly does not seize control of States’ administration of elections — it simply imposes reasonable preparation require-

ments for certain election-related mail.” On Sunday, a day before the Supreme Court weighed in on Talwani’s ruling, a federal judge in D.C. issued a separate ruling blocking the Trump administration’s plan from taking effect. District Judge Carl J. Nichols, whom Trump appointed during his first term, wrote that plaintiffs challenging the administration’s plan had shown it “likely exceeds the authority Congress conferred on the Postal Service.” The Trump administration on Monday sent Nichols’s opinion to the Supreme Court as the justices weighed Talwani’s ruling. In a filing, Solicitor General D. John Sauer said that if the high court stays Talwani’s ruling, it would require lower courts to also pause Nichols’s order. The rapid-fire legal moves underscored the urgency of the matter for the Trump administration and the dwindling time officials had to get the executive order in place for November. Some states have already set in motion voting for the Nov. 3 elections. Officials in some places — including Wisconsin, North Carolina and Alabama — had begun sending out mail-in ballots, and voters have in some cases submitted theirs. More states

will follow suit in sending out ballots in the days and weeks ahead. The executive order requires states to upload lists of voters to a portal being created by the U.S. Postal Service that has yet to be unveiled. The federal whistleblower said that the portal could result in many voters not receiving mail ballots. The Postal Service had adopted a “zero-percent failure policy,” which might result in an entire batch of ballots being rejected if a single barcode sampled by a Postal Service employee did not match information submitted to the portal, the whistleblower said. One batch could contain tens of thousands of ballots. “The Postal Service has designed a system to disenfranchise millions of Americans,” said Sen. Richard Blumenthal (D-Connecticut), who made the whistleblower complaint public. A Postal Service spokesperson maintained in a statement that the system would perform well, saying, “Americans can have confidence that their election mail will be handled securely and delivered reliably.” Lower courts have sided with two dozen states and the voting rights groups, finding that the Trump administration did not

have the power to regulate the administration of state elections. The Trump administration appealed some of those rulings to the Supreme Court in August on narrow, technical grounds. It argued that the lawsuits against his executive order were premature because the Postal Service had to finalize its rules for implementing the plan. The high court agreed, and the cases were dismissed. But soon after the Postal Service finalized its order, the states and the voting rights groups renewed their challenges. The cases wended back to the Supreme Court in recent weeks. Many states face looming deadlines to begin sending out absentee ballots, and some would have to replace envelopes, train staff and make other changes to comply with the order. Such preparations can take a year or more. One hundred election officials from across the country submitted a friend-of-the-court brief saying Trump’s plan could wreak havoc with elections and it was too late to implement it. “The court should understand that what hangs in the balance is every eligible voter’s right to cast their ballot and have it counted,” they said in the brief.

A dozen Republican-led states also weighed in, asking the court to green-light the plan and saying it would shore up confidence in voting. They called the changes “commonsense.” “Allowing the federal government to promulgate final rules advancing election integrity reforms enhances the ability of states to ensure the security of mail voting within their jurisdictions,” the Republican states wrote. Trump has been trying to exert greater federal control over elections. The administration this month asked the Supreme Court to clear the way for states to have access to a database that would allow them to verify that voters are citizens. Trump has also been pushing the Senate to pass the Save America Act, which would require voters to prove their citizenship to register and to show photo identification when voting. He aired debunked claims about vulnerabilities in election systems during a prime-time television address in July, fired members of a federal bipartisan election commission and threatened to withhold funding from states that do not make changes to electoral procedures.

Trump, Vance campaign to save Senate candidates in North Carolina, Kansas

MIDTERMS FROM A1

campaign about where and how to hold a rally that would have the most positive “impact” on the race, according to an adviser with knowledge of those discussions. The adviser, like others interviewed for this article, spoke on the condition of anonymity to discuss internal deliberations. North Carolina’s early timeline for sending mail-in ballots was an impetus for starting Trump’s fall campaign swing there, the person said. On Sept. 4, North Carolina began mailing absentee ballots to those who had requested them, making it the first state to do so. Only a small percentage of voters there cast ballots by mail, but even narrow margins could matter as the race is expected to tighten. The president in recent weeks has increasingly expressed a commitment to campaigning in person for vulnerable midterm candidates, saying both in private and public that he is willing to do so. Aides have drafted a travel schedule for him for the coming weeks, but it’s unclear how closely he will hold to it, the adviser said. The cadence will be determined in part by what non-campaign business arises. “I know I’ve got to get out there,” Trump has remarked, the adviser said. And Trump over the past couple of weeks finally began approving campaign spending from his aligned super PACs, after leaving vulnerable Re-

publican candidates wondering when he would open the coffers — and frustrating some on his own political team who had hoped to begin spending earlier. Vance will hold an event with Trump’s super PAC in Kansas. The vice president’s campaign stop coincides with an anti-fraud news conference he is holding just over the state line at a law enforcement facility in Kansas City, Missouri. But Vance decided to visit the region and campaign for Marshall based on his personal affinity for the senator, according to three people briefed on the plans. Republicans have quietly raised alarms about Kansas for two months, after internal polls showed Marshall up by just several points — a closer-than-comfortable margin for a Republican incumbent in a state Trump won by 16 percentage points in 2024. Marshall won by an 11-point margin in his 2020 race. Strategists from both parties say the race is closer than expected. Vance’s visit is the first action by the Trump team that signals they believe Marshall could use reinforcements. A person with knowledge of the planning of Vance’s Kansas trip maintained, however, that Republicans have “strong” confidence Marshall will win. In addition to the problems Republicans face nationally — persistent inflation, the war in Iran and Trump’s unpopularity — Marshall, an obstetrician, faces criticism over past lawsuits to collect debts from patients.



JOEL ANGEL JUÁREZ/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Vice President JD Vance reacts as President Donald Trump takes the stage following Vance's speech on Thursday at the Republican's midterm convention in Dallas. They began campaigning this week.

Local TV news has been airing interviews with patients whom Marshall’s office took to court for failing to pay their bills, sometimes resulting in arrests. During a debate with his Democratic opponent Saturday at the Kansas State Fair, Marshall faced chants of “shame on you” from the crowd when he explained he followed “common business practices.” Despite the cheerful showing in Dallas, Republicans enter the peak campaign season with a pile-on of discouraging signs. Democrats have gained an average eight-point lead on the generic congressional ballot, according to polling analyst Nate Silver, and Trump’s approval is still around record lows. Surveys also suggest that much of Trump’s support is soft and that Democrats have greater enthusiasm about voting. Inflation stayed at a 3.4 percent annual rate in August and crude oil climbed above \$100 a barrel as fighting once again escalated in the unpopular Iran war. In most of the closest races, Democratic candidates have raised more money than their Republican opponents. Republicans are counting on Trump’s war chest to come to the rescue on that front. Since Labor Day, a super PAC run by his allies has pumped more than \$74 million into Senate and House battles. Most of the House races where Trump is spending are toss-ups or seats where the party hopes to go on offense.

The exceptions are two open seats, Kentucky’s 6th district and Texas’s 35th district, where the group bought ads despite a “likely Republican” rating from the Cook Political Report. In Kansas, frustration with Trump’s policies has been brewing for months among farmers, a Republican operative with knowledge of the state’s dynamics told The Washington Post this summer. Sorghum farmers were already hurting from reduced Chinese purchases resulting from Trump’s trade war, and then ranchers objected to the administration’s plans to ease beef prices through imports. Jobs are also at risk from Trump’s threat to ban planes from Canadian jet-maker Bombardier, whose U.S. headquarters is in Wichita. Glenn Brunkow, president of the state’s Farm Bureau who has long supported Trump, said after the beef decision that Trump was “selling out American farmers and ranchers to buy votes in November,” and he urged him to reconsider the plan, which Brunkow called “anti-American in nature.” Gov. Laura Kelly, a Democrat who is term limited and retiring, told reporters last week that “Kansas has come a very long way wherein we’re included in the swing states.” She predicted the state would elect another Democrat to succeed her and send the party’s nominee, Adam Hamilton, a United Methodist megachurch pastor, to the Senate.

Trump Jr. wedding celebrations had Russian sponsor

Powerful businessman hosted two nights of parties, according to bride

BY ISAAC ARNSDORF

Some of the festivities for Donald Trump Jr.'s intimate wedding celebration on two private Bahamian islands in May were paid for by a wealthy Russian who does business with the state.

Umar Kremlev is the president of the International Boxing Association, a Switzerland-based sports league financed by Russian state energy giant Gazprom. He recently accompanied Russian President Vladimir Putin on a delegation to China, and he is under Ukrainian sanctions that describe him as a "close friend of the head of Putin's security service."

Kremlev hosted two nights of celebrations after Trump Jr.'s wedding ceremony, the bride, Bettina Trump, said on Instagram on Monday.

"It was an extraordinarily generous wedding gift from a friend, and something for which we were and remain incredibly grateful," she wrote alongside photos from the festivities showing the couple and other Trump family members.

Kremlev's contribution was first disclosed by the investigative news website ProPublica, which reported that it cost hundreds of thousands of dollars and included event planning, a fireworks show and rental of one of the private islands where guest slept. The payments came from a Dubai entity affiliated with the boxing agency, the website reported, citing records reviewed and interviews with three people.

Bettina Trump denied any



BRENDAN SMIALOWSKI/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

From left, Donald Trump Jr., wife Bettina, Eric Trump and President Donald Trump in Doonbeg, Ireland, on Sunday.

sinister or political motive. "Generosity doesn't automatically come with an agenda," she wrote on Instagram. "Sometimes a wedding gift is simply a wedding gift."

President Donald Trump did

not attend the wedding. "It's going to be just a small little private affair," he told reporters at the time. "This is not good timing for me. I have a thing called Iran and other things."

In response to questions, the

White House referred to Bettina Trump's Instagram post.

Kremlev did not immediately respond to a request for comment through the boxing association. He met Trump Jr. several years ago and speaks limited

English, according to ProPublica.

Kremlev has a criminal record under a previous name, The Washington Post reported in 2024. As head of the Russian Boxing Federation, Kremlev

awarded Putin a diamond boxing glove, and Putin gave Kremlev a prestigious state honor known as the Order of Merit to the Fatherland. In April, Putin awarded Kremlev another honor, the Order of Friendship.

‘Grand conspiracy’ probe of Trump foes goes on after prosecutor’s exit

Ex-CIA director Brennan received a subpoena, according to his lawyer

BY JEREMY ROEBUCK

Federal prosecutors in Florida are barreling ahead with a sprawling investigation of several of President Donald Trump's political foes, despite the abrupt resignation last week of the latest Justice Department lawyer overseeing the probe, a lawyer for one of the potential targets said.

Kenneth Wainstein, an attorney for former CIA Director John O. Brennan, said that his client received a subpoena Thursday seeking his testimony next month before a grand jury in Fort Pierce, Florida.

That summons came the same day that Joseph diGenova, the Trump loyalist appointed in April to oversee what members of the president's inner circle refer to as the "grand conspiracy" investigation, quit in a dispute with Justice Department officials over the pace of his inquiry.

In a court filing Monday, Wainstein said that he spoke with the remaining prosecutors on the team Friday and was told there are multiple "viable" grand jury investigations ongoing and that Brennan, who has denied wrongdoing, remains a target of at least one of them.

"The threat of prosecution remains quite real and quite tangible," Wainstein said Monday. He accused the Justice Department of "blatantly trying to frame [Brennan] for a crime that is complete fiction."

The so-called "grand conspiracy" probe, being run out of the U.S. attorney's office in Miami, is among the most ambitious and legally complicated of the Justice Department's efforts to prosecute Trump's political enemies.

The theory, as officials have described it, is that Brennan and other officials from the Obama and Biden administrations engaged in a decades-long, "deep state" conspiracy to violate Trump's civil rights.

Those efforts, investigators contend, include the FBI and intelligence community investigations of potential ties between Russia and Trump's 2016 campaign as well as the push under special counsel Jack Smith to prosecute Trump after his first term for allegedly mishandling classified documents.

Prosecutors have also been examining testimony Brennan gave to Congress in 2023 about intelligence reports he oversaw as the CIA director during the Obama administration that concluded Russia was attempting to assist Trump's campaign in 2016. Trump has denied any collusion with Russia.

Rep. Jim Jordan (R-Ohio), chairman of the House Judiciary Committee, referred Brennan to the Justice Department for potential prosecution on charges he lied during that testimony.

Brennan, through his attorneys, repeatedly characterized the efforts to prosecute him as



PABLO MARTINEZ MONSIVIS/AP

Former CIA Director John Brennan testifies on Capitol Hill on May 23, 2017. His lawyer said he received a subpoena Thursday.

an improper attempt at harassment and intimidation by the Trump administration.

Though those broad investigations have been underway for most of the year, a flurry of subpoenas issued in recent weeks including to several intelligence community officials and investigators tied to the 2022 raid on Trump's Mar-a-Lago estate indicate that the probe had been heating up.

DiGenova's abrupt resignation last week, however, threw its current status into doubt.

A former U.S. attorney for the District of Columbia who represented the president during his attempts to overturn the results of the 2020 election, diGenova had been one of the most ardent advocates for the "grand conspiracy" legal theory before he was

appointed this spring to oversee it.

He publicly lobbied for the job and had previously claimed that the slow pace of the probe was in part behind Trump's decision to fire former attorney general Pam Bondi in April.

diGenova declined to discuss the reasons for his departure during a brief interview with The Washington Post last week. He said in a text message that he still believed in the strength of the case his team was building but that "time was needed to build those cases" and "people differ on how long that should take."

Attorney General Todd Blanche also sidestepped questions about diGenova's departure, saying only that he had "worked very hard for the ad-

ministration."

"We have great prosecutors [in Florida] working on not only this case but other cases as well," Blanche told Newsmax last week. "People leave all the time for all kinds of reasons."

diGenova was the second prosecutor overseeing the investigation to depart midstream. Maria Medetis Long, a veteran national security prosecutor in Miami, stepped aside from the investigation in April after expressing discomfort with its direction.

The Justice Department has not said who is now leading the investigation. But Wainstein, Brennan's attorney, said Monday that he had been briefed Friday on the status of the investigation by Kurt Olsen, a former White House official who joined the "grand conspiracy" investigative

team earlier this year.

Olsen was among a group of lawyers who unsuccessfully pushed the Justice Department in 2020 to endorse Trump's false claims that that year's presidential election had been stolen. Before his current role, he served as the White House's election security czar.

Wainstein said that Olsen informed him last week that Brennan remained a target in the probe of his statements to Congress and, for now, was a potential witness in the broader conspiracy case.

But Brennan's legal team argued, during a related court hearing Monday in D.C., that the rapid changeover in the investigation's leadership was cause for alarm.

"There have been several prosecutors moved aside because they had the temerity to express that they did not want to move forward with this case," Wainstein said. "The 'grand conspiracy' is a fiction. You can't think of another case like this 'grand conspiracy' to deny President Trump his civil rights because there's never been any case like it."

Wainstein's remarks came during a hearing on a suit Brennan filed this summer, seeking a court order that would require Justice Department officials to preserve their communications about the investigation.

Brennan's legal team has said they intend to use them, if a grand jury ultimately indicts him, to argue the case should be dismissed as an improper and vindictive prosecution.

But during Monday's proceedings U.S. District Judge Jia M. Cobb appeared skeptical that she could issue such an order before Brennan was charged with a crime and with no direct evidence that prosecutors were seeking to destroy or hide communications they are already required to preserve. She did not issue a ruling Monday, saying she would do so at a later date.

Justice Department attorney Jeremy Newman called Brennan's request improper and premature.

"There is no constitutional right for someone who is not a criminal defendant to have documents preserved for a hypothetical future case," he said.

Salvador Rizzo and Perry Stein contributed to this report.

EPA is ending one of the biggest climate protections

BY JAKE SPRING

The Environmental Protection Agency on Monday repealed Biden-era rules to limit the carbon dioxide emissions from power plants that drive climate change, arguing it will save consumers money on electricity bills, while environmentalists say it will take a toll on public health.

The regulation aimed to limit greenhouse gas emissions from new gas and existing coal plants, with the Biden administration's EPA estimating it would have saved thousands of lives. Power plants are the second-largest source of carbon dioxide emissions in the United States, after transportation.

The limits on power plants now revert to a weaker 2015 standard set under President Barack Obama, although the EPA proposed an additional regulation that when finalized would eliminate all previous greenhouse gas standards for power plants.

That proposal would further solidify the repeal in February of the agency's "endangerment finding," which states that climate-related emissions endanger human health. That policy underpinned the vast majority of the federal government's climate policies.

In a statement announcing the changes, the EPA said repealing the Biden standards would save \$310 billion over roughly the next 20 years. Biden officials in 2024 had said that the regulation would bring \$370 billion in climate and public health benefits.

"For over 15 years, the Obama and Biden administrations implemented a war on coal to destroy reliable and affordable energy. The Trump Administration has come in to protect American energy and to make sure you can afford to keep the lights on," EPA Administrator Lee Zeldin said in the statement, issued during the meeting of Group of 20 energy ministers in Houston.

"Americans will see a decrease in electricity prices," he said.

Zeldin signaled last year that the agency would repeal the Biden-era power plant rules among a raft of several dozen



Environmental Protection Agency Administrator Lee Zeldin with President Donald Trump in the Oval Office in June.

SAMUEL CORUM/POOL/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

proposals that he called "the largest deregulatory announcement in U.S. history."

Environmental groups say the decision would benefit the very companies that drive pollution, noting the health risks of eliminating the emissions rules.

"By eliminating the power plant pollution standards, Trump is choosing to allow preventable asthma attacks, heart disease, and even deaths," said Zealan Hoover, a former EPA senior

adviser under President Joe Biden, in a statement.

"With more coal and gas being burned to power data centers, the impacts of this rollback will hit particularly hard in states like Texas, Georgia, Ohio, and Arizona where developers are racing to take advantage of this pro-polluter EPA," Hoover added.

Environmental groups have pledged to challenge the repeal in court.

The regulatory changes an-

nounced Monday apply only to greenhouse gas emissions and not to air emissions that are directly harmful for humans to breathe. The EPA has separately sought to weaken controls on toxic air pollution, including mercury and particulate matter.

America's Power, a group that represents the coal industry, praised the Trump administration's policy moves. The EPA said in its announcement that coal production for use in the pow-

er sector is expected to increase more than 10 times.

"Overturning these examples of EPA overreach will help preserve and strengthen the U.S. coal fleet, protect grid reliability, and shield electricity consumers from higher costs at a time of surging demand from data centers, artificial intelligence, and advanced manufacturing," said Michelle Bloodworth, chief executive at America's Power.

Trump officials and many in-

dustry groups argue that the Biden-era limits went beyond the law by requiring power plants to use technology that was not adequately demonstrated to be feasible. The standards required coal plants to shut by 2039 or install costly carbon-capture technology to reduce their emissions by 90 percent by 2032.

The public can submit comments on the proposal for 45 days, after which the EPA can finalize the policy.



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All abuzz: Wasps are chasing Midwesterners indoors

BY DAN SIMMONS

Wasps are known to crash Midwestern summer barbecues. But this year, there are so many buzzing around that picnickers are being forced indoors or left doing the dance of the distressed, furiously swatting at the stinging insects.

Known colloquially as yellow jackets, the wasps this year showed up earlier in the region — and they're sticking around longer, too.

The Midwest had a fast start to spring, with warmer-than-average temperatures in March and April. Those conditions met wasps' nest-building criteria, so they had more time to lay more eggs, according to experts.

And as colonies outgrow their nests, the wasps are on the hunt for food.

"Now you're seeing them go after your sodas and your beers and your wines and all that sugary stuff," said Adam Hintzke, who runs the Bug Man and Queen Bee, a Milwaukee exterminator business, with his wife, Chandell. "That's why now they are so bad, and everyone's noticing."

His company's call volume related to wasps has shot up by 30 percent starting in spring. Hintzke said he treated one property this year on a quarter-acre lot that had five yellow-jacket nests in the ground.

"Previous to this year, it would be highly unlikely to find



COURTESY OF ADAM HINTZKE

Adam Hintzke's pest-control company in Milwaukee has seen a surge in wasp-related calls this year.

two yellow jacket colonies on the same property around the Milwaukee area," he said.

About 90 miles west, Steph Martin has seen the expansive patios at Buck & Honey's restaurant near Madison sit vacant lately — even on sun-splashed days.

"People don't really want to be out there with them," said

Martin, the restaurant's general manager. "We ended up having tables [of people] sit out there and then move inside. In general it has not been a good patio summer for us."

Hintzke said there were 50 new requests for service, all wasp-related, after the long Labor Day weekend. It's a somewhat overwhelming volume for

his four-person crew, but they expect the requests to continue for weeks.

It has been a warm September for the area — and with no early frost risk, the milder temperatures could last deep into October.

Other exterminators in the region aren't even answering their phones, with voicemails explain-

ing they're booked out into next July.

Warmer weather fuels breeding

The surge in the wasp population comes in part because of weather trends related to climate change: shorter and less frigid winters, warmer summers and more rainfall.

Every colony starts from just one queen that goes into a type of hibernation in winter and emerges to grow a colony when the weather allows.

The earlier a queen can establish a nest, which Hintzke said takes at least a few days of temperatures in the mid-40s, the longer she has to expand the colony as she lays eggs and hatches young workers.

Warmer winters also mean higher survival rates for queens. More queens mean more nests and bigger populations.

In spring, newly hatched wasps are protein-hunters. They go on a slug-and-bug quest to feed the queen, which needs the extra boost for egg-laying and rearing the newcomers.

Later in summer, wasps' missions shift to quests for carbohydrates. Hence the interest in sugary drinks and other food.

Fears of home invasion

Unlike their bee relatives, yellow jackets can sting more than once. But they're not necessarily looking to use those stingers, said Emily Laub, an evolution-

ary biologist at the University of Illinois who has studied wasp behavior for about eight years.

Despite their activity interrupting cookouts and other outdoor meals, she said wasps aren't "setting out to ruin your day."

"They've kind of got their own business to attend to, if that makes sense," she said. "They're definitely motivated to protect their home, just like you're motivated to protect yours."

Wasps use their stingers only when they feel threatened, she said. With humans, that fear often arises for an expected reason — people accidentally wandering close to a nest that they probably don't know is there. But there's another fear factor that's less understood: carbon dioxide coming from human breath.

To the tiny fliers, carbon dioxide in the air signals another living thing, and they can't necessarily differentiate between who's producing it, be it a potential predator or a harmless human. It can trigger their defensive reflexes.

For those seeing more nests on their property this year, Laub has some practical advice.

"If I get up really close to a nest to see what's going on in there, I will actually hold my breath or breathe away from the nest," Laub said. "So, move slowly and breathe away from them."

Ben Noll contributed to this report.

Outlook for the renegade space solar industry has seen big changes recently

SOLAR FROM A1

next decade with no new construction on land.

Not everyone is convinced that the answer is in the stars. Space solar energy has long been dismissed as too impractical, too dangerous and too expensive.

"The technology may work," said Amory Lovins, a Stanford physicist and co-founder of the energy think tank RMI. "But I have serious doubts the economics do." He said other technologies can produce abundant, even round-the-clock clean power for much cheaper.

The outlook for the renegade space solar industry, though, has changed markedly in recent months. Like fusion power plants, tiny nuclear reactors and other sci-fi worthy ideas that were largely written off years ago, this one has come roaring back as tech companies and investors grasp for solutions to a power crunch that threatens to stymie the growth of artificial intelligence and chill the U.S. economy.

Meta has signed a contract to secure the first gigawatt of capacity Overview helps generate for its data centers. Big solar manufacturers are scurrying to design new products that could be used by a growing constellation of firms looking to make energy in space with an array of technologies. The U.S. Department of Energy is invested in helping space solar start-ups and university labs speed up development.

The science underpinning Overview's business plan dates back to NASA's study of power beaming in the 1970s as a possible solution to that era's energy crisis.

The system would be built around thousands of satellites orbiting thousands of miles above Earth, collecting energy from uninterrupted sunlight and sending it down as invisible, near-infrared light.

Solar farms would be equipped with beacons that could guide a beam their way. A beam could be pointed toward any such beacon at any given time. And Overview would be able to constantly move power to areas most in need, as determined by its tech company and utility company clients.

Overview's executives maintain that the beams would not be concentrated enough to be dangerous to humans on the ground.

"If you can stand in the sun, you can stand under this," said Abdullah Al-Shakarchi, the company's other CEO. "There is no chance this could be used as a weapon. We have military folks come though and sometimes they ask, 'Can this be used as a weapon?' The answer is always no."

The executives say that by the mid-2030s, they could generate electricity at prices lower than the gas plants currently used to keep the power grid stable in times of high demand.

It's a heady projection — and one that draws some industry skepticism in the face of daunting engineering challenges and huge potential costs to make the



PHOTOS BY MATT MCCLAIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Overview Energy's co-CEO Darko Filipi. The four-year-old start-up has set a January 2028 deadline for beaming its first power from space.

technology operational.

Building the satellites, each the size of roughly two football fields, and catapulting them into orbit would be a massive undertaking.

"It is one thing to do some experiments with this technology," said Henry Hertzfeld, a research professor of space policy at George Washington University. "It is another to send lots of these things into space. There are real questions about whether the launch capability will be there."

Company officials acknowledge that it will be expensive to generate the first megawatts of power that would come from the planned 2028 demonstration. But Overview is betting that launch costs would plummet over the next decade, as companies such as Space X and its competitors vow they can accommodate an explosion of space-bound energy infrastructure. Space X itself is building factories to produce solar panels for use in orbit.

Others in the space industry are not so confident about launch prices going down. They note that demand for satellite launches from all manner of industries is expected to soar.

Hertzfeld said he is also unconvinced that all safety questions have been answered. "Even if it is not meant to be used as a weapon, it could still interfere with communications or flight navigation or other things," he said.

Meta is willing to bet the obstacles can be overcome. If the technology were to be a success, it could cure some of the company's biggest headaches.

Silicon Valley firms are strugg-

ling to lock down the power they need to fuel data centers. Their plans for developing more capacity are meeting intensifying resistance in communities across the country, as the environmental impact and the costs associated with the AI buildout trigger a fierce backlash. The idea that the energy equivalent it takes to power entire large cities could be generated without building anything new on Earth is enticing.

"Space solar has the potential to deliver uninterrupted energy to the grid by building on existing solar infrastructure — this means no new land, no fuel, and solar at night," Nat Sahlstrom, Meta's vice president of energy and sustainability, said in an emailed statement.

Some potential customers may prefer to wait to see if it all works out. For them, Al-Shakarchi has a marketing line ready.

"In our early years, we are only going to be able to provide this energy to a limited number of customers," he said. "If you are not in our queue today, then it will be a long time before you are able to see this energy. That's an advantage that you are ceding to the companies you are competing with."

Overview is not the only option. It is among several space solar start-ups jockeying to show they can use space technology to produce clean energy at competitive prices. The methods of harnessing sun power vary widely. Some envision using it to power data centers floating in space.

"The markets see space as the next growth area," said Danielle Merfeld, global chief technology officer at Qcells, one of the largest solar panel manufacturers in the U.S. "Our investors are defi-



Mechanical engineer Taiki Yamauchi works at Overview Energy on Aug. 27 in Ashburn. "We really believe that we are able to provide utility-scale power with this technology," Filipi said.

nately expecting space will be the next frontier for solar." The company has entered a partnership with the Georgia Institute of Technology to advance space-based solar power research, and it has launched a new space solar research and development team in Atlanta.

"There are still a lot of challenges for space solar, but we are also now seeing the pathway for solving them," said Ali Hajimiri, co-director of the space-based Solar Power Project at Caltech. He has been working for 13 years on satellite systems that would beam microwaves down to Earth.

Microwaves can cut through clouds and precipitation in ways that Overview's infrared lasers cannot. But there's a catch: they can't generate power through conventional solar panels already on the ground. Existing solar farms would need to be retrofitted entirely, adding to the project's potential cost.

Hajimiri argues it can all be done economically, resulting in abundant electricity at prices competitive with energy from conventional technologies.

The open question is whether existing technologies anchored to the Earth will be quicker than any space-based invention to solve the economic and environmental challenges unleashed by a worldwide surge in energy demand.

The cost of storing solar and wind energy in giant, industrial-scale batteries continues to plunge, Lovins said. At the same time, the solar industry is working with communities on designs that are more efficient, less land intensive and built to integrate with agricultural operations rather than displace farmland.

Lovins suspects advancements in the batteries that turn solar energy from an unpredictable, intermittent technology into one that can boast the reliability of coal or nuclear power could make space solar obsolete for creating energy on Earth before it even makes it into the mainstream.

Like so many other advancements in energy, though, space solar is driven not just by cost and climate concerns. There is also the China factor. Beijing is rapidly scaling up its extraterrestrial solar industry, raising concern that this will become yet another crucial sector that was innovated here and then ceded to our rival.

Such concerns are top of mind for the Trump administration, which a couple of weeks ago announced it would invest \$12 million to accelerate product development at universities and space-solar firms.

President Donald Trump has branded solar power part of the "scam of the century" (along with wind power), but as China races ahead with technologies that harness the sun's power from space, the Department of Energy has declared the promise of "near constant power" from space-based solar a development that could "further the Trump Administration's space superiority agenda."

THE WORLD

For Ukraine, concerns over budget, weapons shortfalls

BY FRANCESCA EBEL
AND ELLEN FRANCIS

KYIV — Ukraine’s war prospects have grown notably bleaker in recent weeks, with Kyiv overwhelmed by Russian air power and facing an acute cash crunch, a swirl of corruption allegations, new internal political divisions and growing exhaustion among its international supporters — even as the Trump administration is now pushing to revive long-stalled peace negotiations

Amid the constant Russian drone and missile attacks, two shortfalls are raising the greatest alarm: a lack of air defense interceptors and an unexpected \$27 billion budget gap that Ukrainian officials say must be filled by year’s end.

President Donald Trump in recent days has added new pressure, urging Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky to stop targeting Russian oil refineries because of rising global diesel prices — effectively demanding that Ukraine refrain from one of its most effective strategies in defending against Russia’s invasion.

“Ukraine has agreed not to hit Russian Energy targets. Russia has agreed to do, likewise! The World’s Diesel price rise is mostly caused by the Russia/Ukraine War, not Iran,” Trump posted Monday on Truth Social.

Neither the Kremlin nor Ukrainian leaders immediately confirmed the deal.

“Any call for the Kyiv regime to stop attacks on peaceful economic infrastructure can only be welcomed,” Kremlin spokesman Dmitry Peskov told reporters on a briefing call. He did not answer a question about whether Russia would stop striking Ukrainian energy infrastructure in exchange.

Zelensky, meanwhile, said that “if this can become the first deescalatory step — a step toward ending Russian strikes on our critical infrastructure and our strikes in response — then Ukraine is ready to support deescalation.”

Trump and some of his top advisers have complained for the past couple of weeks about the Ukrainian strikes.

“There are plenty of other targets,” Trump said Sunday in Ireland. “Don’t hit diesel fuel, because that’s hurting, that’s hurting the world.”

U.S. envoys brokered a March 2025 moratorium on strikes on energy infrastructure that quickly fell apart.

Trump spoke to Russian President Vladimir Putin last week, after U.S. envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner visited Moscow and Kyiv the previous weekend. Trump’s comments about diesel reflected his concern about gasoline prices in the United States, where diesel prices have hit record highs in recent days.

Zelensky has said that Russia is now producing 140 ballistic missiles per month. Since late August, a torrent of missiles and drones has crashed down on Ukraine’s capital city, with air defenses increasingly unable to protect its people from Russia’s huge arsenal.

To intercept those missiles, Zelensky said, Ukraine would need a 2:1 ratio — 280 interceptors — and that he is requesting hundreds of such interceptors “for the difficult, cold months ahead” from U.S. and European stockpiles.



GORM KALLESTAD/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

German President Frank-Walter Steinmeier, left, and Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky attend a funeral procession for Norwegian King Harald V on Sept. 9. Ukraine is facing a \$27 billion shortfall in its defense budget for 2026, the country’s prime minister said.

“It’s a much more complicated picture than simply a shortfall. The Ukrainian economy is already under enormous strain due to the drop in grain exports and Russian attacks on logistics warehouses. All this creates a compound effect.”

Orysia Lutsevych, head of the Ukraine Forum at Chatham House

“With all due respect to the Europeans — they have provided a great deal of assistance, and we appreciate it — they need to share these missiles to help save lives,” he said.

European countries have provided air defenses to Ukraine throughout the war but have been reluctant to dig deeper into their stocks out of concern for their own defenses amid a global shortage.

Zelensky’s pitch for interceptors comes as his country’s budget crunch has created serious friction between Ukraine and European nations that have become his country’s main source of financing ever since Trump ended direct U.S. assistance at the start of his second term.

With troop movements on the front line largely frozen by the threat of drones overhead, Ukraine and Russia are locked in a high-stakes race to spend on military technology. Russia in recent weeks has ramped up its production and deployment of jet-powered drones, which are able to evade Ukraine’s defenses more effectively.

News of Ukraine’s budget shortfall rattled European officials who thought they had mostly addressed Kyiv’s budget needs for this year and next year with a package of more than \$100 billion.

The timing is particularly difficult for Brussels, with the European Union now deep in negotiations over its sprawling, multiyear budget while Ukraine-skeptic, nationalist political parties are gaining ground. Alternative for Germany (AfD), which finished first in a key regional election this month, and France’s National Rally have opposed further money for Ukraine.

Ukrainian Prime Minister Serhii Koretskyi, in an address to parliament earlier this month, said the country was facing a \$27 billion shortfall in its defense budget for 2026. While Koretskyi

said that the government had already earmarked \$1.5 billion in domestic funds to be redirected to defense, he also pleaded with Kyiv’s Western partners, the so-called “coalition of the willing,” to fill the gap.

That request, made while some European leaders were in Ukraine to mark its Independence Day in August, stoked deep unease.

“Ukraine could have chosen a different method to present the news — the feeling among the coalition of the willing was as if a bomb had been dropped,” a senior European diplomat told The Washington Post, speaking on the condition of anonymity to address sensitive negotiations.

“Ukraine must get serious, implement real austerity measures and get the work of [parliament] into order,” the senior diplomat said. “There is no time for internal games. They must do what is requested to receive next payments from the E.U. and the IMF.”

European policymakers expected some divergence from budget projections as the war grinds on and battlefield conditions shift, but they did not envision a shortfall this big or this soon, said two diplomats, who also spoke on the condition of anonymity because of the sensitive nature of the issue. E.U. offi-

cials say they have they serious questions about how the \$27 billion figure was calculated.

“A lot of member states were a bit surprised about the timing and dimension of it,” one of the diplomats said.

The shortfall highlights Europe’s challenge in financing the cost of Ukraine’s defense against Russia.

European leaders have framed the war as an existential fight for their own nations’ security, but they must balance the needs of Zelensky’s government with political imperatives at home, including public frustration over the rising cost of living, driven up by the wars in Ukraine and the Middle East.

The sentiment that Kyiv is asking for a lot, at the wrong moment for Europe, also has been echoed by those in Kyiv.

“Suddenly running out of money and simply shrugging one’s shoulders isn’t exactly kosher,” said a Kyiv-based European diplomat, who spoke on the condition of anonymity because they were not authorized to speak publicly.

“It’s certainly not going to be easy to close that gap, especially given the upcoming elections in several European countries,” the diplomat said. “Politicians are very nervous about the elections, and most countries are dealing

with deficits.”

Some European officials, meanwhile, suspect Kyiv’s request might be inflated as a political tactic to keep pressure on the bloc, another European diplomat said.

The Ukrainian government, meanwhile, has rushed to explain the shortfall, seeking to head off accusations of misappropriation of funds that have plagued Kyiv in the wake of a string of major investigations revealing top-level government corruption and evidence of fraudulent or wasteful weapons contracts.

Ukraine’s prosecutor general resigned last week after investigators raided his office in relation to corruption allegations involving illegal call centers.

The prosecutor, Ruslan Kravchenko, is the latest figure from Zelensky’s top official to come under scrutiny, as Ukraine’s anti-corruption agencies pursue investigations into the energy and defense ministries.

Officials and economists insist that the shortfall was caused largely by the growing costs of the long, technology-driven war.

Hlib Vyshlinsky, a Ukrainian economist who heads the Center for Economic Strategy, an independent think tank, said that by the end of June there was an understanding between Kyiv and its international partners that Ukraine would face a big budget hole in 2027 but not in 2026.

“Then late August comes and there was this huge gap,” Vyshlinsky said. Vyshlinsky blamed the chaos that followed in Zelensky’s dismissal of Defense Minister Mykhailo Fedorov but added that a drop in international military aid also drove up Kyiv’s need for weapons spending.

Vyshlinsky also pointed to a decision to increase military salaries this summer, which he said was “not planned in the budget initially, but was long overdue.”

According to data published

by the Kiel Institute, which tracks military and financial aid to Ukraine, the total military allocation in the first half of 2025 was about \$26.1 billion, while in the first half of 2026, that number had dropped to about \$19.6 billion.

Vyshlinsky also blamed Ukraine’s international partners, comparing budget negotiations to “a Turkish bazaar ... where the buyer wants to pay as little as possible, but the product is changing all the time.”

“Everyone expected that the E.U. loan would cover all of Ukraine’s needs. But it did not,” he said. “They want to spend as little money as possible.”

Orysia Lutsevych, head of the Ukraine Forum at Chatham House, the London-based think tank, pointed to a lag in international aid disbursements, saying there was a delay of at least several billion dollars.

“It’s a much more complicated picture than simply a shortfall,” Lutsevych said in an interview. “The Ukrainian economy is already under enormous strain due to the drop in grain exports and Russian attacks on logistics warehouses. All this creates a compound effect.”

On Thursday, Ukrainian Finance Minister Sergii Marchenko confirmed that Ukraine had been forced to cut government spending because of delays in international financial aid.

Kyiv has been consumed by the escalating strikes, with an attack this month even hitting a Ukrainian television studio as journalists were mid-broadcast.

Russia has also targeted food and medical warehouses and logistics hubs, incinerating tons of medication and food and leading to temporary supply disruptions.

A strike this month hit one of the World Health Organization’s main warehouses storing humanitarian aid on the outskirts of Kyiv. The agrarian policy and food minister, Taras Vysotsky, has warned that food prices could increase by 2.5 percent because of the attacks.

The E.U. could front-load part of next year’s aid, but that would risk political pushback now as well as pressure next year — a presidential election year in France — to come up with even more money.

For now, E.U. and Ukrainian officials are in talks to determine the scale of the shortfall and where it came from. “We are working with Ukraine and the IMF to clarify urgent needs, and the reform agenda, while mobilizing further international support,” the E.U. economy commissioner, Valdis Dombrovskis, told The Post.

Some countries, such as Sweden, Poland and Spain, have called for revisiting a contentious proposal to finance Ukraine using frozen Russian assets, which have been held in Europe since the invasion. That approach remains divisive.

An E.U. plan to tap into the Russian assets last year failed, as Belgium, where most of the funds are held, and others including Italy raised concerns about financial stability or Russian retaliation.

Francis reported from Brussels. David L. Stern in Mukachevo, Ukraine, Anastacia Galouchka and Kostiantyn Khudov in Kyiv, Mary Ilyushina in Berlin and Michael Birnbaum in Washington contributed to this report.

DIGEST

MEDITERRANEAN SEA Rare storm could hit Greece, Libya, Egypt

A rare “medicane,” or hurricane-like system in the Mediterranean, appears to be forming just northeast of Tripoli, Libya.

The system could reach high-end tropical storm strength by Wednesday. It’s unclear where the system might eventually come ashore, but people in Greece, northern Libya and northwest Egypt should monitor its progress for possible impacts. The main concern will be a narrow swath of locally significant flooding if the system comes ashore.

Medicanes are notoriously difficult to predict. They are usually small, with more erratic fluctuations in strength. Additionally, the same weak steering

currents that promote their organization also mean there’s not much to push them along. This system can wobble anywhere it likes. Generally speaking, it should move slowly eastward.

Medicanes often form via a mix of tropical and nontropical processes. That makes them “subtropical.” They usually begin as regular midlatitude low-pressure systems, then extract heat energy from the warm waters of the Mediterranean. Eventually, a ring of thunderstorms can form.

The strongest medicane on record, named Ianos, impacted Greece on Sept. 17, 2020. It briefly became the equivalent of a Category 2 hurricane with winds of 95 mph.

Libya has seen medicanes before. In September 2023, Cyclone Daniel became the deadliest one on record. Despite having maximum winds of only

55 mph, it killed nearly 6,000 people by moving into Libya and causing the collapse of the Derna and Mansour dams.

— Matthew Cappucci

INDONESIA Search continues for ferry disaster victims

The search for survivors of a capsized ferry in Indonesia intensified Monday as 17 ships and aircraft from the military, police and other agencies were deployed to join the search for 129 missing people after a ferry overturned in the Java Sea on Sunday.

The bodies of six passengers were recovered Sunday by search teams, which increased to 655 personnel on Monday, National Search and Rescue Agency chief Mohammad Syafii

said.

Authorities deployed specialized underwater teams and underwater thermal drones operated by the navy to strengthen the search effort and speed up the evacuation of victims, he said.

The Virgo Transport 8 was carrying more than 240 people when its captain issued a distress call on Sunday, saying the ship was listing in rough seas with waves of up to 10 feet while traveling from Surabaya in East Java province to Banjarmasin in South Kalimantan province, on Borneo Island.

Contact was lost with the ferry at about 2 a.m. Sunday, and about two hours later authorities learned the vessel had overturned in the Java Sea, about 92 miles from Banjarmasin.

— Associated Press

MEXICO Spain seeks justice for slain college student

Spain’s minister of foreign affairs demanded justice after the violent death of a Spanish college student in a state neighboring Mexico City, a case that media reports said was a stabbing and local authorities are investigating as a femicide.

“We want to get to the bottom of this,” Foreign Affairs Minister José Manuel Albares told reporters during a visit to Andorra. Spanish authorities are in contact with the family of the young woman, who has been identified as Claudia Tacoronte.

Mexico has long struggled with high rates of gender-based killings, or femicides.

The University of Granada student was on an academic

exchange program with the Autonomous University of Morelos State.

According to Mexican media citing police sources, 21-year-old Tacoronte died from stab wounds. Her body was found late Saturday in the surroundings of the Casa de Cultura in the town of Cuautla, about 60 miles from Mexico City.

In a statement, the University of Granada said it condemned Tacoronte’s “murder,” while students and faculty there observed a moment of silence.

Morelos State Prosecutor Fernando Blumenkron said the death was being investigated as a femicide and pledged to pursue every line of investigation to establish the motives behind the crime and identify the person responsible.

— Reuters

Putin warns West: No peacekeeping troops in Ukraine

RUSSIA FROM A1

David Petraeus, former British prime minister Boris Johnson and former Swedish prime minister Carl Bildt were leaving the country after attending the annual Yalta European Strategy conference in Kyiv.

Passengers on at least one train were evacuated, but no deaths or injuries were reported from the strike.

German Defense Minister Boris Pistorius called the drone strike a calculated escalation to fuel fear in Europe.

“It is all the more important that we remain levelheaded, that we do not allow ourselves to be provoked, but that at the same time we leave no doubt that we are capable of defending ourselves,” Pistorius told reporters. “What Vladimir Putin is doing is dangerous. He knows that, and that is why he is doing it.”

The rail line attack further alarmed European officials who have been warning that Russia could attack near Ukraine’s border crossings with NATO countries or could intensify sabotage operations inside Europe to discourage Western leaders from further aiding Ukraine.

“These coming weeks and months will be a time of very intensified actions on the Russian side, and unfortunately we cannot rule out that this escalation will also affect our territory,” Polish Prime Minister Donald Tusk said Sunday following a government security briefing.

The Trump administration in recent days has renewed its efforts to jump-start peace negotiations between Russia and Ukraine, including with trips by presidential envoys Steve Witkoff and Jared Kushner to Moscow and Ukraine.

Following those talks, Kush-



AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Russian President Vladimir Putin, third from left, India’s Prime Minister Narendra Modi, fourth from left, and China’s President Xi Jinping, fifth from left, with other leaders in New Delhi on Sept. 13.

ner said that Washington had already drafted most of the peace agreement but that it was being held up by Ukraine’s reluctance to make territorial concessions to Russia, which now occupies about one-fifth of Ukraine’s sovereign territory.

Putin has demanded that Ukraine surrender all of its east-

ern Donbas region, and Russia has claimed, illegally, to have annexed four Ukrainian regions, even though militarily it does not control all of that land.

“President Putin laid out his position regarding what he wants to achieve,” Kushner said at the YES conference. “If Ukraine wanted to retreat to

that line, we would have already prepared and agreed on the remaining terms of the deal. Currently, Ukraine does not want to do this.”

Ukraine has repeatedly said that ceding land that Russia failed to capture militarily is a nonstarter, arguing that withdrawing from fortified cities in

Donbas would only expose the country to future attacks.

Kushner and Witkoff said they were pushing for trilateral negotiations. And Ukrainian President Volodymyr Zelensky said he is willing to meet Putin at the Group of 20 summit scheduled for mid-December at Trump’s resort in Doral, Florida.

The Kremlin immediately ruled out such a meeting, calling it “impossible” and saying that Putin would only meet Zelensky in Moscow. Kyiv repeatedly has dismissed the offer of a meeting in Moscow as the Kremlin playing games.

Putin’s spokesman Dmitry Peskov said that the talks on Ukraine probably would resume in October, after Russia holds a key parliamentary election this weekend.

The potential deployment of a European peacekeeping force has been discussed as one potential way to provide Ukraine with “security guarantees.” But any such step would first require the signing of a durable truce between Kyiv and Moscow.

Britain and France previously had agreed to deploy forces in Ukraine if the country reaches a peace deal with Russia, with then-Prime Minister Keir Starmer and President Emmanuel Macron signing a “declaration of intent.”

But as negotiations stalled, with Washington focused on its own war in Iran, the proposals to send European troops to Ukraine have also gone quiet.

Europe, because of its increasing role in Ukraine’s capability to launch strikes against Russian territory, is becoming “Moscow’s central strategic problem, overshadowing the United States, Ukraine and, to some extent, even NATO,” Tatiana Stanovaya, a senior fellow at the Carnegie Russia Eurasia Center, wrote on X.

“This will shape the nature of negotiations with and about Ukraine, as well as the outcome of any settlement, far more than it did a year ago,” Stanovaya added. “It is likely to dominate European geopolitics for decades.”



AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Firefighters extinguish flames at a train carriage damaged by a drone strike Saturday near the border with Poland. Drone attacks are familiar among Ukrainians living under escalating Russian bombardment.

When drones targeted our train journey out of Ukraine

BY JACK WRIGHT

YAHODYN, UKRAINE — We thought the danger had largely passed.

As our train traveled west from Kyiv to the Polish border, we’d already been evacuated twice. Word had spread among the passengers that the explosion we’d heard two hours earlier had hit a nearby gas station. The pattern had become familiar among Ukrainians living under escalating Russian bombardment: They attacked infrastructure but not the train itself.

We were wrong. We dismounted for the third time around 6 a.m. Saturday. Antiaircraft fire drew passengers’ gaze skyward, and some began to cry out the Ukrainian word for missile: “Ra-

keta!”

It was, in fact, a drone: Long, sleek and white, with four fins and a rear-mounted engine, whistling in low like a small jet. It hit sufficiently close that the flash and the sound and the ear-pounding concussion arrived simultaneously.

Passengers scrambled for the tree line as smoke rose over the small train station. One small child ran out the front door of a nearby house, only to be scooped up by his mother, who ran back inside and slammed the door. Train staff urged passengers to keep moving away from the tracks toward a lake nearby, where they said it would be safer.

Two nights earlier, the dignitaries at one table at the Inter-

Continental Kyiv hotel bar, visiting the Ukrainian capital for the annual Yalta European Strategy (YES) conference, discussed how they planned to leave the country. I had attended the conference with David Petraeus, a former general and CIA director.

After a day punctuated by air raid alarms and explosions, one suggested that the Kyiv-Warsaw rail link might become a target of Russian President Vladimir Putin’s escalating aerial terror campaign.

“I think that would be deeply counterproductive to Russia’s aims,” former British prime minister Boris Johnson said.

The following evening, Glenn Corn and I sat in the back seat of a police car leading Petraeus’s motorcade to Kyiv’s central

railway station. Corn, a former CIA station chief who speaks Russian, had just received a message from Ukrainian intelligence. “It’s going to be a loud night in Kyiv.”

Eight hours later we arrived at Yahodyn station, the border control point for trains departing Ukraine. At 3:30 a.m., with Ukrainian customs still in possession of our documents, a train attendant hurried through our carriage announcing something in Ukrainian. “Evacuate,” Corn translated.

In an open field, Ukrainian women and children gestured at a set of liquefied natural gas tank cars. Some laughed nervously.

We were invited to reboard, but the train remained station-

ary. Word spread that Poland had closed the border with Ukraine.

I texted a person in Ukrainian intelligence for an update. “There are drones in the air all over western Ukraine,” he replied.

An hour later we were ordered into the field again. As we dismounted, an explosion from somewhere ahead of us spurred commuters into a hurried run. It was the gas station, hit by a drone less than a mile from Polish territory.

A railway employee confirmed the LNG tankers were, indeed, fully loaded. Fifteen minutes later we returned to our berths, but the train still didn’t move.

It was daybreak by the time the third order came. Ralph

Goff, a former chief of European operations for the CIA traveling with Petraeus, identified the incoming weapon as a Russian Geran-5, a new jet-powered drone that Ukrainian air defense cannot intercept without American Patriot missiles. It scored a direct hit on the locomotive of the passenger train alongside Petraeus’s carriage.

Petraeus said the attack was intended to prevent Ukraine from securing diplomatic support for the war.

“This is definitely an escalation,” he said. “The timing after the YES conference is clearly intended to discourage foreign officials from traveling to Kyiv in the future.”

“I think next time we will take cars.”



A drone view shows vessels near the Strait of Hormuz, as seen from Musandam, Oman, in August.

REUTERS

Iran, Gulf nations postpone meeting; Oman attributes delay to ‘interests of consensus’

BY RACHEL CHASON
AND SUZAN HAIDAMOUS

SALALAH, OMAN — Saudi Arabia, under pressure from Iranian-allied militias in Iraq and Houthi rebels in Yemen, has postponed what would have been the highest level of multilateral talks between Tehran and Persian Gulf nations since the start of the U.S.-led war in February, Iran's Foreign Ministry said.

The host of the meeting, Omani Foreign Minister Badr Albusaidi, issued a statement late Sunday saying that the delay had been made “in the interests of consensus.”

However, Iranian Foreign Ministry spokesman Esmail Baqaei said that Saudi Arabia requested the postponement because of “the situation in Yemen.”

Houthi rebels, who are supported by Iran, last week seized major cities along Yemen's Red Sea coast from Saudi-backed coalition forces, putting them in a position to control the Bab al-Mandab Strait, which has become a crucial outlet for Saudi oil exports as the Strait of Hormuz is largely blocked by Iran and the United States.

Saudi Arabia has also come under attack in recent days by drones fired from Iraq that shut down its East-West pipeline, the main conduit to get Saudi oil from the Persian Gulf to the Red Sea. Saudi Crown Prince Mohammed bin Salman on Monday met Brad Cooper, the head of U.S. Central Command, in Jeddah, Saudi Arabia, according to Saudi state media.

During the meeting, “they reviewed bilateral relations between the two countries and the latest developments in the region,” state media reported. President Donald Trump, who

in 2025 launched a brief military campaign against the Houthis because of their attacks on Red Sea shipping, said Saturday that he had talked with the crown prince. “Everything will work out just fine,” Trump said. “It’s all gonna work out fine.”

Saudi Arabia's Foreign Ministry did not respond to a request for comment.

The delayed meeting is the latest example of the intractable situation in the Middle East more than six months into war, with Iranian proxies increasingly on the offensive and regional officials urgently searching for a way out.

The session would have been the highest level, multilateral meeting between officials from Iran and its Persian Gulf neighbors, which Tehran has attacked with missiles and drones because of their support for the United States.

Gulf nations, in particular, are seeing their economies battered and oil export routes constricted, first with the Strait of Hormuz and now Bab al-Mandab.

“The fact that the East-West pipeline is closed narrows the options,” said Dania Thafer, executive director of Gulf International Forum, a Washington think tank. “Iran has a lot of leverage collectively at this point, and it feels like things are closing in on the Gulf — and on the global economy.”

The price of Brent crude, the international benchmark, reached \$110 a barrel on Friday. (It was just over \$70 a barrel on Feb. 27, the day before the U.S.-Israeli bombing campaign began.)

A gallon of gasoline in the United States now costs \$4.30 on average, compared with \$2.98 when the war began, according to AAA.

President Donald Trump said Saturday that Iran, which backs various militias in Iraq, was “probably” behind the attack on the pipeline. Trump also said that his administration had been in contact with the Houthis and that they were focused on blocking the vessels of just one country, presumably Saudi Arabia, which has backed Yemen's internationally recognized government in the country's civil war.

On Sunday, when asked during his trip to Ireland about the planned meeting of the Gulf nations, Trump said: “I don't care. That's up to them.”

Alex Vatanka, a senior fellow at the Middle East Institute in Washington, said that the flurry of diplomatic initiatives reflects a growing anxiety among Gulf nations as they watch Iran's leverage grow, and see little in the way of strategy from the U.S. in terms of ending the war.

“They are not just nervous and unsure about the U.S. intentions — they are worried about U.S. capability to help them,” Vatanka said. “As much as they hate shaking the hands of Iranian leaders, what else are they going to do?”

Baqaei, during his weekly news conference on Monday, said Iran “categorically denied” being involved in attacks on Saudi Arabia's pipeline.

Iran and Oman, he said, had finalized an agreement on maritime routes through the Strait of Hormuz and are discussing how to announce it. Trump had turned to Oman as a mediator with Iran on reopening the strait but last month he threatened to bomb Oman, leaving the country perplexed.

Oman's Foreign Ministry did not immediately respond to a request for comment.

Trump says the Strait of Hormuz is open. But how much oil is going through?

BY KAREN DEYOUNG

President Donald Trump has claimed to have already won the war with Iran, destroyed its military and “obliterated” its nuclear program, even as U.S. military officials worry about their own depleted arsenals and overextended ships at sea.

“There's no fighting. ... We have essentially taken over Iran,” Trump said recently, just before several tumultuous days of back-and-forth attacks on ships in the Persian Gulf, the launch of dozens — perhaps hundreds — of missiles, drones and interceptors, and major assaults on Saudi Arabia by Iranian-backed militants in Yemen and Iraq.

Days after declaring the war was just a “military conflict ... small potatoes,” Trump said last week that “the war will end immediately after the [midterm] election,” when he predicted record gas prices would fall to “less than \$2 a barrel.”

Iran, administration officials have said, is holding on in the face of enormous economic and military pressure, hoping that Republicans will lose their current struggle to retain their congressional majority in November.

In the meantime, the question of how many ships and how much oil are flowing through the Strait of Hormuz — reflected in the U.S. price of gasoline — has become the latest rhetorical battleground in the war.

In a cacophony of data, claims and assertions, the Trump administration figures vary significantly from those compiled by commercial maritime tracking organizations.

“We've been averaging 30 ships a night” through the Persian Gulf chokepoint, Trump said on Aug. 31. While he did not specify a time frame, or whether all 30 were oil tankers, that quantity could amount to more than 60 million barrels. (Very large crude carriers, the type that commonly transit the Strait of Hormuz, can carry more than 2 million barrels.)

The same day, Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent offered a more modest wartime high of more than 17 million barrels of oil over a 24-hour period. Three days later, Vice President JD Vance told reporters at a White House briefing that “we got about 15 million barrels out of the Strait of Hormuz just yesterday, despite the fact that the Iranians ... continue to shoot” at the tankers.

“We're not doing crazy math,” Energy Secretary Chris Wright said last week on Fox News.

“We're just reporting exactly what's going through the southern route through the Strait of Hormuz, ... and the running average right now is over 9 million barrels a day just on the waterborne routes.”

For comparison, the prewar daily average was roughly 20 million barrels.

Commercial shipping trackers, while skeptical, say it is possible that 15 or even 18 million barrels of oil might have transited the strait in one night at some point, although none has reported a figure that high.

“Plenty of days might be over 11 or 12 million, but then the next day will be 4 or 3 million,” said Brett Erickson, managing principal of Obsidian Risk Advisors. “You need to be looking at rolling averages. It's been consistently at 6.5 to 7 over a month. It's getting closer toward eight now, but it needs to be sustained.”

In data released Saturday, the maritime intelligence agency TankerTrackers reported a 60-day average at 7.85 million barrels a day.

On Sunday, Windward, a shipping analytics company, reported that on Sept. 10 just three outbound vessels made their way through the southern passage of the strait along the coast of Oman.

An administration official, speaking on the condition of anonymity under rules set by the administration in response to questions from The Washington Post, said that “the seven day average of oil and oil products” transiting the strait “is slightly above 10 million barrels a day. About 4 to 5 million barrels [a day] are additionally leaving the region via pipelines.”

These “work-arounds,” avoiding the strait by sending oil overland through pipelines, have supplemented the deficits created by the contested waterway.

The official spoke late last week before Saudi Arabia said it had shut down its pipeline to the Red Sea on Friday, following a drone attack by Iran-backed militants in Iraq. That Red Sea terminal, with an oil capacity of 7 million barrels per day, had been averaging about 4 million before the strikes.

That pipeline attack, along with last week's seizure of territory in Yemen by Houthi rebels at the Bab al-Mandab Strait at the mouth of the Red Sea, have further threatened oil exports from the region.

The administration wants to “cherry-pick and report as high a number as possible because they want oil prices ... to remain



U.S. NAVY/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

A sailor aboard the guided-missile destroyer USS Mason on Sept. 4. President Donald Trump has called the war with Iran “small potatoes.”



GREGORY BULL/AP

Gas prices in Carlsbad, California, on Sept. 10.

in check,” said Matt Smith, the lead oil analyst at Kpler, a maritime data company.

The same day that Trump reported an average of 30 ships per night through the Strait of Hormuz, Kpler reported that traffic had “declined sharply ... with five confirmed crossings, down 50 percent from 10 a day earlier.”

The company noted that most

ships turn off their transponders to hide from Iranian attacks, and that its data was “preliminary” as more satellite information was awaited.

“Additional ‘dark’ crossings may be retrospectively identified and added as new confirmation data becomes available,” Kpler said.

Wright has also said that daily commercial tracker reports do

not reflect the true number of ship transits because they don't have information available to the U.S. government.

Michelle Wiese Bockmann, senior intelligence analyst at Windward, acknowledged a lag time between the company's daily estimates and more accurate figures that take into account ship transmissions, satellite views of vessels loading and leaving port, and visible ship-to-ship transfers.

“We have visibility, but we don't always have it in real time,” she said.

The path many vessels follow from non-Iranian Persian Gulf ports is a complicated route with several stages. With most commercial tankers reluctant to run the Hormuz gantlet, ships belonging to the producing countries shuttle oil through the waterway into the Gulf of Oman, where it is transferred to the vessels that carry them to purchasers. The process can take days and tack hundreds of thousands of additional dollars onto the shipping price.

Before entering the strait, the shuttles contact U.S. military forces who facilitate their travel. U.S. naval vessels in the region also enforce a blockade against any oil vessels going into or out

of Iranian ports as well as provide protection from afar, shooting down any incoming weapons from the ships or aircraft.

“We are coordinating with the shipping industry and providing protection when they make their transit in a coordinated way,” said a U.S. military official familiar with the process, who spoke on the condition of anonymity about the secretive arrangements.

The military official said they are not escorting these ships but rather providing “best practices, timing, techniques and procedures.”

Navy Capt. Tim Hawkins, spokesman for U.S. Central Command, which oversees operations in the Middle East, said in an interview that “since May we have assisted more than 1,600 vessels, including more than 800 million barrels of crude.”

Data released Friday by the United Kingdom Maritime Trade Operations Center put the number of “US stated facilitated transits outbound” through the strait over the previous seven days at 86, with a 30-day total of 303.

“The bottom line is traffic is flowing,” the U.S. military official said. “It's not zero, but it's also not at pre-conflict levels.”

ECONOMY & BUSINESS

In Kansas, backlash over tariffs’ fallout

President’s threat to ban major employer unsettles red state

BY BEN BINDAY

WICHITA — Three days after President Donald Trump threatened to ban sales from Canadian jet manufacturer Bombardier in the United States, an employee walked out of its U.S. headquarters and looked around to ensure no one was nearby before talking to a reporter.

“This is ridiculous,” the employee said with a profanity, speaking on the condition of anonymity to avoid retaliation. “We have thousands of Americans working here, and I don’t want to be thinking about losing my job.”

Trump announced the threat to Quebec-based Bombardier in a Truth Social post last week describing its products as not “good enough” amid escalating trade disputes with Canada. “If they want our Market, they must build here, and stop treating America like a ‘piggybank,’” he wrote.

Trump has not taken any steps to enact restrictions on the company, which is also an aircraft supplier to the U.S. Air Force.

His threat represents a new escalation in Trump’s aggressive rhetoric toward Canada, calling to financially cripple a company that operates as a major employer in a red state key to Republicans holding the Senate.

Bombardier’s workforce includes roughly 1,500 in Kansas, a state Trump carried comfortably during his three presidential bids. In addition to the Wichita headquarters where Bombardier services, tests, and modifies aircraft, the company employs another 2,000 elsewhere in the U.S., including at service centers in Arizona, Texas, Florida and

Connecticut.

It makes jet wings in Texas and flight control components in California, with plans to open a new service center in Indiana. Final assembly of its jets takes place in Canada, highlighting the complex relationship between the two nations that developed over recent decades of mostly free trade.

In interviews, four current Wichita-based Bombardier employees, all of whom spoke on the condition of anonymity for fear of losing their jobs, saying the company directed them not to speak with the media, expressed anger and concern about what the threat could mean for their job security.

“I’m scared about what this might mean for my job and my family,” said one longtime engineer. “It’s tough to look at many other Americans working here who are also struggling and got caught up in this global mess.”

Bombardier, in a public statement released after the threat, sought to highlight its American footprint while avoiding explicitly responding to or criticizing the post. The company plans no changes to its operations “at this time,” a spokesperson told The Washington Post.

Trump has sharply targeted Canada, along with other nations, maintaining that high tariffs, including those on steel and aluminum, help U.S. companies and create more economic opportunities for U.S. businesses. The White House did not respond to questions about what a ban of Bombardier aircraft would look like or which of Bombardier’s operations should move back to the U.S.

However, many of Trump’s harshest tariffs and economic threats have been walked back as the administration has faced backlash from different business sectors because of the interconnectedness of U.S. and Canadian companies, where manufactured products are often shipped back



MIKE HUTMACHER/WICHITA EAGLE/TNS/ABACA/REUTERS CONNECT

In this 2012 photo, Bombardier Learjet workers look at a Model 85 fuselage in Wichita, Kansas.

and forth, as is the case with Bombardier.

“It’s certainly not a simple ‘Oh, that’s a Canadian aircraft,’” said Rolland Vincent, an aviation consultant who formerly led strategy for Learjet, a business jet manufacturer in Wichita acquired by Bombardier in 1990. “There’s no aircraft that’s built that has pure national origin.”

Kansas, which Trump carried by 16 points in 2024, has emerged as one of the midterm election’s unexpected battlegrounds as the president’s approval rating falls even in red states. Sen. Roger Marshall (R), who was long seen as a shoo-in for reelection, now faces a challenge that has prompted optimism from national Democrats even as Marshall remains favored. The governor’s race to replace Laura Kelly (D) is also competitive.

“Kansas exports \$4 billion worth of goods to Canada, and so when we’re insulting the Canadians, when we’re imposing additional tariffs, it hurts the people of Kansas,” said Adam Hamilton,

a Kansas pastor and Democrat facing Marshall in November.

Several Wichita-based Bombardier employees said Trump’s post felt to them as though the president was turning his back on American workers and neglecting the company’s domestic footprint.

While Bombardier employees continued to show up for work as normal, several said that workers have been chatting about Trump’s post and fearing the effects if he followed through.

Others, particularly those with a more favorable view of the president, believe that Trump is “bluffing” and using Bombardier as leverage in trade negotiations, one of the workers said. “I’ve talked with people who think this is all a game of some kind that he’s playing,” the worker said. “And that’s crazy to me. I don’t think he cares about us and our jobs versus using us as a pawn, and our lives should be treated with more respect than that.”

Aviation is central to Wichita’s local identity in a city of 400,000

that styles itself as the “Air Capital of the World” and traces its legacy to historic aviators including Walter Beech and Clyde Cessna. Bombardier no longer assembles civilian jets in Wichita, ending Learjet production in 2022.

U.S.-made components account for a significant share of the value of Bombardier aircraft, Vincent said. Vincent, while saying he expected the dispute to ultimately blow over, cautioned against dismissing Trump’s post as empty bluster.

“It’s a serious threat from a serious person,” he said. “Nobody wants to be on the headline when it comes to the anger of someone who’s got the power of the president.”

The engineer said he was considering putting off a planned move until he had more clarity. “No one really knows what’s going on with it,” he said. “Everyone aside from the president is just guessing.”

This isn’t the first time that Trump has targeted Bombardier. In late January, as tensions

escalated between the U.S. and Canada, he threatened to revoke certifications for some Bombardier jets and impose a 50 percent tariff on Canadian planes but did not follow through.

Wichita Mayor Lily Wu, along with local and federal Republican lawmakers, issued statements that advocated for the Bombardier workers’ jobs to be protected but did not criticize Trump.

Jim Howell, a Republican commissioner of Sedgwick County, which includes Wichita, took on Trump more directly, warning a ban would “be devastating to Bombardier” and a “huge loss” to the region.

“It’s rare that I go against the president in my comments,” Howell, who previously worked in Bombardier’s Wichita flight-test operation, said. “But no, he’s not perfect. And I think that this is one of those things where I’m just shocked that he wanted to wade into this, because I don’t think it’s helping.”

Marshall, who said he had already contacted the White House about protecting Bombardier jobs, used Trump’s threat as an opportunity to push for the company to double the size of its Kansas workforce to more than 3,000, as Learjet formerly had in Wichita.

“America buys more than half of what Bombardier sells. If that’s the market, more of those planes should be built here,” Marshall (R) said in a Tuesday statement.

Hamilton, Marshall’s challenger, argued in an interview that Marshall’s response came too late and that he was unable to sufficiently stand up to Trump.

“Roger Marshall acts as though he’s paid by the White House to be their spokesperson,” Hamilton said. “He keeps saying that he’s speaking up to the White House ... but I don’t see any evidence that the president’s actually listening to him.”

Spokespeople for Marshall did not respond to requests for comment.

To Bombardier’s Wichita employees, though, these political concerns are secondary to whether they will become collateral damage.

“I hope this blows over,” one said. “I just want to do my job.”

AI stocks drop, but rest of Wall Street holds steadier after oil prices bounce

BY STAN CHOE
Associated Press

NEW YORK — Artificial-intelligence stocks slid worldwide Monday after leaders of the industry warned a slowdown is needed for the safety of humanity. Another jump in oil prices, meanwhile, briefly sent the yield of the 10-year Treasury to 5 percent for the bond market’s latest pressure-raising milestone.

Despite all the downers for Wall Street, gains for many stocks outside AI helped limit the market’s losses. So did a midday tempering of oil prices, and the S&P 500 fell a relatively modest 0.5 percent. More stocks rose within the index than fell.

The Dow Jones Industrial Average dropped 152 points, or 0.3 percent, and the Nasdaq composite sank 0.6 percent after clawing back most of an early loss of 1.3 percent.

AI stocks have been under pressure a while because of wor-

ries their prices shot too high in the frenzy around the technology. The concerns jumped to another level over the weekend after one of the industry’s leading voices, Anthropic CEO Dario Amodei, called for a deliberate and global slowdown in the development of AI.

He cited safety issues, including the risk that AI becomes capable of leading a swarm of agents that could take over the entire internet within six to 12 months.

Nvidia, whose profits have soared because its chips are helping to train AI models, sank 3.4 percent and was the heaviest weight on the market because of its massive size.

SpaceX, which gets a chunk of its business from AI, fell 2 percent after Elon Musk said over the weekend that he agrees with Amodei. SoftBank Group, the Japanese giant that is a major investor of OpenAI, lost 10.7 percent in Tokyo after OpenAI’s Sam Altman likewise supported

the concept of a slowdown.

Altman also said in an interview with Fortune published Saturday that the company behind ChatGPT would likely wait until next year for a sale of its stock on Wall Street. That would delay a potential gusher of cash for SoftBank and other early investors in OpenAI.

In South Korea, the Kospi index dropped 3.3 percent due to losses for its two most influential stocks, Samsung Electronics and SK Hynix.

President Donald Trump played down the need for his administration to check the development of AI, saying he worried about ceding his country’s edge over China in a global competition and that winning would help address the risks from the advancing technology.

Even with many voices inside and outside the AI industry calling for a slowdown to protect humanity, Trump said on his social media network Monday that the only guardrail it needs

“is a STRONG AND SMART (High IQ!) PRESIDENT,” and the U.S.A. has that, in spades!”

Helping to limit Wall Street’s losses on Monday were several software companies that tumbled earlier on worries AI-powered competitors would undercut their businesses.

Intuit, the company behind TurboTax and QuickBooks, rose 5.5 percent. Autodesk, whose software helps designers, climbed 7.8 percent, and Adobe added 5.3 percent.

All told, the S&P 500 slipped 37.00 points to 7,619.98. The Dow Jones Industrial Average dropped 152.09 to 54,421.20, and the Nasdaq composite fell 146.62 to 26,186.41.

Oil prices, meanwhile, continued to climb as fighting in the Middle East keeps squeezing the global flow of crude. The price for a barrel of Brent crude rose 1 percent to \$105.68 after getting near \$110 in the morning.

An important Saudi oil pipe-

line will mostly be out of service for weeks following an attack last week, two regional officials told the Associated Press.

Brent has jumped from less than \$72 in early July as doubts rise that the United States and Iran can come to an agreement that would allow oil tankers to freely exit the Persian Gulf through the strait again.

While the prospect of a de-escalation of war in Iran may have dimmed, ING commodities strategists Warren Patterson and Ewa Manthey wrote in a commentary on Monday that the situation is still fluid and “sizable” volumes of oil have still been moving through the strait.

So far, the jump in oil prices has sent the average cost of a gallon of regular gasoline across the country to nearly \$4.32 from \$4.08 a month ago and \$3.18 a year ago, according to AAA. Such upward pressure on inflation has much of Wall Street expecting the Federal Re-

serve will hike its main interest rate on Wednesday at the end of its next meeting.

Besides high inflation, worries about rising debt for the U.S. and other governments and other concerns have sent longer-term Treasury yields to their highest levels in years.

The yield on the 10-year Treasury briefly breached the 5.00 percent level during the morning for the first time in nearly three years. That’s up from 4.96 percent late Friday and just 3.97 percent before the war with Iran began in February.

But the 10-year yield later pulled back to 4.98 percent after oil prices came off their highs for the day. The 10-year yield has not consistently remained above 5 percent since the turn of the millennium, and its jump has already made it more expensive for U.S. households and companies to borrow. That includes the highest average long-term mortgage rate in more than 14 months.

DIGEST

CRYPTOCURRENCY

Trump backs stricter crypto ethics rules

President Donald Trump has agreed to stricter ethics rules demanded by Democrats to limit federal officials from creating and backing digital assets in a major cryptocurrency bill.

A vote to move forward on the Clarity Act, which would establish the first comprehensive federal framework for regulating cryptocurrency, is tied up in the Senate for Tuesday.

Senate Republicans released new text Sunday night that incorporates a proposed change from Sens. Ruben Gallego (D-Arizona) and Thom Tillis (R-North Carolina). The proposal would give state attorneys general the ability to sue if federal officials violate rules in the bill that ban them from creating or sponsoring digital assets while in office.

Before the change, the bill would have given the U.S. attor-

ney general the sole authority over enforcement, which Democrats argued could have allowed Trump, who has a massive cryptocurrency portfolio, to bypass the ethics rules.

Sen. Cynthia Lummis (R-Wyoming), the bill’s sponsor, confirmed Trump’s support in a post Monday on X. It’s unclear whether this change, among others, will be enough to garner the necessary 60 votes to advance the bill.

— Jarrell Dillard

GOVERNMENT

Trump, Johnson on the \$5,000 payments

President Donald Trump doubled down over the weekend on his idea to pay every American \$5,000 if Republicans keep control of the House and Senate in November, while House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) was noncommittal.

Trump told reporters on Sun-

day the checks were “going to happen, 100 percent.” He said he came up with the idea “a while ago,” and that “the people deserve it because they were treated so badly by the Democrats and by Biden,” referring to the former president.

Johnson said Sunday that Trump would need Congress to act and called it a “creative idea” on CNN.

In another appearance Sunday on “Meet the Press,” Johnson said Congress would consider the idea but did not commit to delivering on it. “Like every idea that the president comes up with — he’s a great idea generator — we’re going to process that in Congress and figure it all out,” Johnson said.

Some Republicans have voiced concerns about the cost, estimated at more than \$1 trillion, and how the payments would affect inflation.

Trump announced the “Trump dividends” at the GOP midterm convention last week,

comparing the payments to dividend checks that companies send to shareholders. The only caveat, he said, is that the money would have to be spent in the United States.

— Anna Liss-Roy

ARTIFICIAL INTELLIGENCE

King Charles to host AI industry leaders

King Charles III will meet with officials from top AI companies in Scotland this week to confront the growing impact — and potential existential threat — of the technology that has rattled critics and advocates alike in recent weeks.

The meeting, one of several big-idea seminars Charles has held as monarch and Prince of Wales, was planned weeks ago but has taken on new urgency amid the sharpest alarms yet being sounded from inside the industry.

Long-simmering fears erupted into a wave of global dread

after AI researcher Jacob Coxon resigned from Anthropic and warned last week that many engineers working in the field have come to fear that artificial intelligence “could kill us all.” His former boss, Anthropic head Dario Amodei, on Saturday called for a slowdown in implementing the technology, a bid for regulation joined by AI leaders Sam Altman, Elon Musk and others.

Buckingham Palace declined to comment on the guest list of the event Monday. But press reports suggest senior leaders of Anthropic, OpenAI, Google DeepMind and other firms will attend, along with government officials and an AI adviser to the Vatican. (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.)

People close to Charles said the king hopes to foster a broad discussion about ensuring the increasingly pervasive technology is deployed “for the good of humanity,” according to the Sunday Times.

In 2025, during a technology awards ceremony, Charles handed Nvidia CEO Jensen Huang a copy of a speech the king had given on the potential dangers of the technology.

— Steve Hendrix

An 85-foot crane towering over a construction site

in an upscale Miami neighborhood toppled onto a passing vehicle Monday morning, setting it on fire and injuring the driver and three construction workers, officials said. The collapse occurred shortly after 8 a.m. in the city’s Brickell neighborhood. Miami Fire Chief Robert Hevia said at a news conference Monday that he was thankful no one was killed. The crane also crushed two unoccupied parked cars but fell on a storage container with two construction workers inside. Officials have not said what caused the crane to topple, and Hevia said the collapse is under investigation.

— from news services

China skeptical of U.S. tech leaders’ warnings about AI

BY GERRIT DE VYNCK
AND LYRIC LI

Chinese political leaders and commentators aligned with China’s government hit back at calls from U.S. artificial intelligence executives for companies to agree to slow down the development of the technology, complicating the prospects of such a pact being implemented.

On Monday, a spokesperson for Beijing’s Foreign Ministry accused the American executives of spreading “threat narratives and engaging in confrontation and malicious competition.”

Over the weekend, leaders from three top U.S. AI companies endorsed working together to “pace” the development of new AI technology, out of concern that the industry’s ability to control cutting-edge AI is not keeping up with the tech’s capabilities.

Dario Amodei, CEO of Claude chatbot maker Anthropic, in a Saturday proposal for a slowdown criticized China as an authoritarian country that could misuse AI but also called on the United States to try to work with its rival to establish international limits on AI.

The proposal has been met with skepticism in China. In addition to the Foreign Ministry’s fiery statement Monday, commentary in state-run and nationalist Chinese media echoed the view that talk of a slowdown was part of a wider American effort to harm China’s AI industry.

U.S. advocates of controls on AI hope that the issue could be on the agenda when President Donald Trump meets Chinese leader Xi Jinping in Washington on Sept. 24. But with Chinese skepticism of the proposals and Trump dismissing the idea of a slowdown himself Monday, any strict international agreement limiting AI progress seems unlikely.

As AI technology has advanced rapidly over the past several years, Chinese researchers and tech companies have followed closely behind the U.S. in developing new capabilities. China’s government has made AI development a major prior-



President Donald Trump gestures toward Chinese President Xi Jinping during a visit to Beijing in May. They are scheduled to meet this month in Washington.

ity. Chinese AI models consistently score just behind the latest U.S. models on industry benchmarks, and leading AI companies in China often release free versions of their technology that anyone can use or modify.

Leaders from both China and the U.S. see AI as a key economic and military force that cannot be ceded to their geopolitical ri-

vals. The Biden and Trump administrations have attempted to limit Chinese AI development by imposing export controls on key computer chips and software needed to develop and deploy powerful AI models. China has responded by developing its own chips and working to make its AI algorithms more efficient.

Some Chinese pushback on the proposals for an AI slowdown referenced U.S. trade re-

strictions on China. The nationalist tabloid Global Times published commentary Monday accusing Amodei’s AI safety proposal of being part of “a Cold War playbook” and “silent AI Cold War” aimed at containing China.

The commentary called the push from U.S. industry leaders to limit AI development “hypocritical and shortsighted,” saying the real goal is to use tech-

nological barriers and control over the proposed rules to curb China’s AI development, preserve U.S. dominance in frontier technology and exclude China from global AI governance.

China’s minister of state security, Chen Yixin, referenced the export controls in an article published over the weekend by China Cyberspace, a journal run by Beijing’s internet watchdog body, the Cyberspace Adminis-

tration of China. “Certain countries are leveraging their accumulated advantages in AI ... and, in the name of ‘safeguarding national security,’ are severely restricting other countries from accessing cutting-edge technologies,” he wrote. “AI has become the main battleground in global technological competition and a new arena for strategic rivalry among major powers.”

Trump wants to push the tempo in the artificial intelligence development race

AI FROM AI

could “take over” and endanger humanity was a “Hoax, just like Global Warming.”

The president’s comments come just a day after Dario Amodei, chief executive of leading AI company Anthropic, posted an online essay calling for the industry to agree to limit the pace of AI development to allow safety measures to catch up. Within hours the idea had been publicly endorsed by Sam Altman, CEO of ChatGPT-maker OpenAI; Demis Hassabis, the influential former head of Google’s AI unit; and SpaceX CEO Elon Musk.

Some Democrats responded by calling for Congress to step up scrutiny of the AI industry. On Monday, Sen. Jacky Rosen (D-Nevada) called on Sen Ted Cruz (R-Texas) to bring Musk, Amodei and Altman before the Commerce, Science and Transportation Committee for a hearing on how to help U.S. companies lead while also increasing guardrails on AI. “This powerful technology can have the power to cause catastrophic damages if we don’t act to impose guardrails and safety mechanisms,” she said in a statement.

House Speaker Mike Johnson (R-Louisiana) said Monday that a meeting between Trump and the leaders of the major AI labs to discuss the situation could happen later this week or early next week. But he criticized the idea of congressional action on AI.

“The reflex of legislative bodies is to cover things up with red tape and hyper-regulation. If you do that, then you lose your edge, and that is a national security concern for the American people,” Johnson told reporters.

Even before the public show of unity over the weekend, Anthropic, OpenAI and Google were discussing the potential

creation of a new industry body to set safety standards for the fast-moving sector, according to three people familiar with the talks who spoke on the condition of anonymity to describe the private dialogues. The discussions were first reported by tech industry news site the Information.

The creation of a standards body could be a stepping stone to reaching agreement to reduce the pace of AI development. Amodei in his Saturday essay cited an influential vision for an AI safety body proposed in July by Hassabis, who still holds a senior role at Google.

Hassabis on Saturday linked his earlier proposal to the idea of slowing AI development. “Dario’s essay points to the right path forward,” Hassabis wrote in a post on X endorsing Amodei’s call for an AI slowdown. “This is also why we recently put out our proposal for an industry-wide standards body for frontier AI.”

The public and private discussions about slowing and regulating AI development raise the unprecedented prospect of leading companies in notoriously cut-throat Silicon Valley voluntarily softening competition.

Anthropic, OpenAI and Google are collectively worth almost \$6 trillion, and Anthropic and OpenAI have both filed paperwork to list shares on the stock market. Amodei in his essay called on the U.S. government to issue a “narrow” antitrust waiver to enable the discussions between the companies.

“Progress has been rapid and will continue to be. But it should be slower,” Altman wrote in a post on X late Sunday. “No amount of American competitive pressure should justify recklessness.”

The calls for a slowdown and new industry rules are set to intensify a political firestorm over whether the U.S. government



Anthropic co-founder and CEO Dario Amodei, left, and Sam Altman, CEO of ChatGPT-maker OpenAI. Amodei posted an online essay calling for the industry to agree to limit the pace of AI development. Altman and other AI company leaders endorsed it.

“This powerful technology can have the power to cause catastrophic damages if we don’t act to impose guardrails and safety mechanisms.”

Sen. Jacky Rosen (D-Nevada), in a statement on Monday

should more strictly regulate AI, with national and geopolitical implications.

After recent incidents in which AI “agents” in development by OpenAI, Anthropic and Meta hacked into other companies, increasing numbers of politicians in both major parties have called for new limits on the technology.

But Republican leaders including Trump and Johnson have consistently voiced skepticism of or opposition to new AI regulations, citing the need to stay ahead of China on the crucial technology.

Vice President Vance told re-

porters Monday that he thought there were risks involved in AI but that he was skeptical of the industry’s calls for the government to step in.

“I feel a little bit weird about the fact that you have so many frontier AI tech companies coming to the government and begging the government to regulate them,” Vance said. “It feels a little bit to me like a bit of a Trojan horse.”

Amodei in his essay wrote that he hoped it would be possible to eventually strike a global agreement on slowing AI development that included China, but that it would be risky. “If we greatly

restrain our AI capabilities in the belief that China will do the same, and then China defects, AI could be so powerful that such a defection could lead to their geopolitical dominance,” he wrote.

An OpenAI spokeswoman referred to a company blog post last week that said it wanted to work with others in the industry to set standards.

“We have entered a different phase of AI capabilities, and everything should be on the table — including considering what can be built voluntarily outside government as an immediate step,” wrote Chris Lehane, OpenAI’s head of global affairs. (The Washington Post has a content partnership with OpenAI.)

A Google spokesperson referred to Hassabis’s X post endorsing Amodei’s call for a slowdown. Anthropic did not respond to a request for comment.

Repeated warnings

This weekend was far from the first time that U.S. AI leaders had issued stark predictions of the immense danger their technology could pose, or the need to restrain its development.

Altman in 2023 told Congress that his firm’s technology could cause “significant harm to the world” and urged the creation of a new government department to regulate AI. Amodei in 2025 suggested he believed there was a 1-in-4 chance that AI wipes out the human race.

But both men have also said their companies must develop AI faster to show the world how to do so safely. Amodei has said Anthropic’s rivals and other countries like China may not take the same ethical care if they build super-advanced AI first.

That history was cited by some political and industry leaders as reason to be skeptical about the motivations of the weekend’s talk of an industry-wide compact

to slow AI development.

“I find it rich that these guys are calling for a slowdown when they’ve been the ones racing ahead full speed, without any care for the havoc they’ve unleashed,” Rep. Josh Gottheimer, (D-New Jersey) said Sunday on X. He called for “national mandatory rules of the road” on AI.

David Sacks, formerly Trump’s AI and crypto czar, said the slowdown proposal appeared to be aimed at hobbling competitors.

“The easiest way not to build superintelligence is for you to agree not to build it,” he wrote in a post on X addressed to Amodei and Altman late Saturday. “Demanding your preferred regulatory framework as the price of that will look like blackmail of the public and the political system.”

Some leaders of major U.S. AI companies have pushed back on earlier conversations about the need to slow down AI development.

Meta CEO Mark Zuckerberg has positioned himself as an AI optimist who believes the technology’s benefits will far outweigh its harms. Spokespeople for Meta did not return a request for comment.

Jensen Huang, CEO of AI chipmaker Nvidia and one of the most influential tech leaders in the world, has also voiced skepticism of calls to limit or slow down AI development.

On Monday, Huang was on-stage at a tech conference when he received a call from Trump, according to a video of the exchange posted on social media. Huang put Trump on speakerphone, and the president told the room that suggestions it is necessary to limit AI development and data center construction in the United States are “a hoax.”

Huang said that he agreed. “You’re right. We’re not going to let that happen, sir,” he said.

 | FREEDOM DESK





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TUESDAY OPINION

Can a depopulating America still flourish?



WASHINGTON POST STAFF ILLUSTRATION; ISTOCK

BY NICHOLAS EBERSTADT

Can America continue to prosper even if it veers into an indefinite period of depopulation?

The question is not as outlandish as you might think. For the first time in generations — since the Great Depression, in fact — the prospect of population decline looms on the U.S. horizon. Yet almost no serious consideration has been devoted to how well the United States will fare as its numbers contract. That inattention could prove costly. It's possible that depopulation could arrive with surprising speed — potentially even before a baby born this year enters high school.

A switch from population growth to population decline could mean wrenching changes for America, placing unfamiliar new pressures on public finances, businesses, communities and families — indeed, on our entire national system.

Fortunately, a depopulating America can still prosper — in theory. The power of human ingenuity and adaptability made the world much richer during the era of the global “population explosion.” It can do so in an era of long-term population decline, too. U.S. history demonstrates our nation's exceptional advantages over others in both ingenuity and adaptability.

But major changes in policy, practice and behavior will be required. To be blunt: America is not well positioned to pass the stress test that depopulation will unforgivingly impose.

The U.S. has developed a whole range of undesirable new habits — political, social and economic — over the past several decades. With steady population growth, it has managed to progress despite them.

But that gets much harder under depopulation.

For decades, the U.S. has enjoyed the most robust demographic growth of any developed society. But both engines powering that expansion — births and immigration — are faltering today.

The last time U.S. fertility blipped slightly above the replacement level was almost two decades ago, in 2007. Now, with under 1.6 births per woman in 2025, America is on track for sharply shrinking future generations of native-born Americans. If the 2025 fertility trajectory continues, in fact, each new birth cohort would be 24 percent smaller than its parents' cohort was.

As for immigration trends: While accurate real-time figures are notoriously difficult to collect, it's obvious that U.S. net migration totals plummeted in 2025 because of the Trump administration's crackdown on illegal immigration. (In fact, it is possible — not likely, but still possible — that 2025 marked the first annual *net outflow* of population from the U.S. in generations.) With persistent sub-replacement childbearing and a less favorable popular disposition toward immigration (especially illegal immigration), the arithmetic for long-term American population decline is falling into place.

The Congressional Budget Office projects that deaths will exceed births in the U.S. in *just four years*: i.e., by 2030. At that point, America becomes a “net mortality” society, with the gap between deaths and births steadily widening and only immigration potentially forestalling population decline.

Right now, the CBO expects immigration to postpone the advent of long-term depopulation in America until 2056 — positing a rebound from presumed lows in 2025-26 to stabilize at a level above 1 million a year from 2030 onward. But given all the uncertainties surrounding future migration flows, depopulation in America could actually begin a lot earlier. The CBO expects about 1 million more deaths than births a year for America in 2046. If net immigration, for any reason, fell below that compensatory level, population decline in America would begin just 20 years from now.

With a somewhat more restrictive immigration policy — say, with absolute annual inflows comparable to the Reagan era — U.S. population would enter into long-term decline by 2038, given CBO projections for births and deaths. Just 12 years from now, in other words. And American population decline could, at least plausibly, begin even sooner.

This vision of an endlessly shrinking U.S. population will seem foreboding to many Americans. Yet it is essential to realize that depopulation, if and when it comes, doesn't preclude ever-greater prosperity — thanks to the remarkable “human-ingenuity-driven” nature of modern economic development.

Humanity has already proved it can cheat Malthus during a population explosion. Since 1968, world population has more than doubled. Yet contrary to British demographer Thomas Malthus's famous prediction, the world today is better fed, healthier and richer than ever. Furthermore, in-

flation-adjusted prices for cereals — corn, rice and wheat — are substantially *lower* than they were back then. Indeed, *practically all* natural resources have been getting less expensive despite unprecedented human numbers.

The seeming paradox of ever-cheaper natural resources and ever-greater wealth for a booming world population is actually not a paradox at all. Human beings are a uniquely adaptable, ingenious, problem-solving animal. We have figured out how to increase human productivity under more or less any material circumstances, regardless of whether the constraints at hand are geographic, climatic or indeed demographic.

In the era of rapid population growth, that meant figuring out how to make essential resources inexpensively available for consumption. In an aging, shrinking world, it will mean increasing productivity through “workaround” improvements in knowledge production, human capital (i.e., health and skills) and a propitious “business climate” to help unlock the value in human beings.

The rise of a worldwide human-ingenuity-driven growth model implies that continuing, possibly unending, improvements in living standards for shrinking and aging populations are within reach. The scope for advances in knowledge production and improvement of skills is still vast and untapped, if there is any limit at all to improving them. Artificial intelligence is only the latest “new thing” — and it's unlikely the last.

Fortuitously for Americans, the United States would enjoy crucial advantages in a prospective depopulation. The U.S. has been a leader in our modern world's revolution in human-ingenuity-driven development for generations. That's why private wealth holdings in the U.S. exceed \$180 trillion.

And the quintessentially American characteristics of drive, imagination, creative adaptation to “disequilibria” and problem-solving entrepreneurship that accounted for such distinctive economic results can be deployed successfully under other demographic conditions as well.

But America is not as well poised as it could be to take advantage of opportunities that coming population changes may present, and it is all too exposed to vulnerabilities engendered by population decline.

Ironically, the U.S. actually looks to be *less* prepared to cope with depopulation today than it would have been a generation ago. Highly dysfunctional habits have infiltrated the American social, economic and political fabric over recent decades. Absent far-reaching and sustained reforms, depopulation would exacerbate the vulnerabilities from these dysfunctions, eroding the country's competitive edge, increasing the risk of stagnation and financial crisis — and potentially compromising the American Dream itself.

Here are five worrying indicators:

First, flagging U.S. labor force participation. To maintain prosperity during depopulation, the United States will require a healthy, well-skilled workforce with high rates of labor force participation. Unfortunately, stagnation and indeed decline dominate participation trends for much of the U.S. workforce. Troubling in absolute terms, these U.S. trends look even more worrisome from an international perspective.

U.S. work participation rates for 15-to-64-year-olds are lower today than 30 years ago. In fact, as U.S. labor force participation for the preretirement cohort has been stagnating and declining, corresponding rates in Japan and the European Union have been steadily improving — and are now more robust than America's.

American performance is being impaired by a number of factors. One of these is troubling new health trends. Other factors depressing modern American labor force rates include criminality (every seventh man in America has been convicted of a felony) and growing dependency on government welfare and disability benefits (1 in 4 prime-age men without children at home is accepting means-tested benefits).

Second, slow and expensive U.S. health progress. The quality of America's human capital — most specifically including the health and longevity of our people — will increasingly help define and determine national economic possibilities once demographic decline commences. But today, health and longevity are areas in which the United States struggles.

American life expectancy at birth today is markedly lower than it is in any other affluent Western society, even though per capita health spending is far higher. America's health troubles are concentrated in the working-age population; the mortality risk for people between ages 15 and 59 has basically stagnated for a generation.

Why such halting progress? Cause-of-death data

point toward answers. So far in the 21st century, overall age-standardized death rates in America have risen for poisonings (including overdose deaths) and more broadly for injuries (which include suicide and homicide). But an even greater driver of divergence in life chances between America and other affluent societies has been deaths from cardiovascular disease.

At the same time, America's excess mortality and morbidity reduce economically available labor, decrease the attractiveness of investing in human resources and increase overall health care costs. These constraints would be felt even more acutely under depopulation than they are today.

Third, weak saving and wealth building for too many. In a shrinking and aging society, saving and wealth building take on special urgency. All else being equal, social aging depresses national saving rates, and thus investment rates, productivity improvement, economic growth and future wealth generation.

The U.S. is fantastically successful at generating private wealth — in aggregate. For a great many Americans, however, the cushion of personal net worth is meager — or nonexistent. This is true for entire strata of American society.

In 2023, according to the Census Bureau, 28 million American households — over 1 in 5 — had less than \$10,000 in estimated wealth. Hispanics, Black people, high school dropouts and welfare recipients were overrepresented. But what may surprise is the huge portion of renter homes in this pool. Half of all renters had less than \$10,000 in net worth: 24 million households in all.

While the renter-owner wealth gap can be read in different ways, it vividly underscores the importance of savings in the process of lifetime wealth-building in modern America. The most reliable path to amassing personal wealth is through saving: diligently, consistently and over the long term (abetted by the magic of compound interest). Simply recovering lost habits from earlier postwar culture could go a long way in this quest.

The power of human ingenuity and adaptability made the world much richer during the era of the global ‘population explosion.’ It can do so in an era of long-term population decline, too.

Fourth, chronic and worsening federal budget indiscipline. Budget discipline in public finance is desirable in any country serious about enhancing national prosperity, but it becomes critical for societies facing pronounced aging and prolonged shrinking.

Alas, America's increasingly irresponsible habits in public finance are by now well-established fact.

Over the postwar era, net U.S. savings have undergone an ominous long-term decline: from about 11 percent in the 1950s and 1960s to just about zero today. The main driver of the drop in national savings rates has been “dis-savings” by the federal government — ballooning budget deficits as a “new normal,” in good years as well as bad.

The inescapable consequence of our budgetary indiscipline has been the emergence of interest payments on federal debt as an inexorably rising federal expense. Net federal interest payments now account for a higher share of gross domestic product than at any time in America's history — more today than it spends on national defense, in fact.

But what we see now is only a foretaste of the future. For shrinking societies with upside-down “population pyramids,” where each new generation is smaller than its elders', pay-as-you-go schemes for old-age pension and health care programs, which worked so nicely when populations were growing, become fiscal doom loops.

Population decline promises to intensify the distortions, magnifying deficits and debt buildup, raising the odds of an eventual fiscal crisis, and hastening its potential arrival.

Fifth, a faltering business climate. An aging, shrinking society will need a vibrant business climate — what some might term economic freedom and others high-quality institutions and policies — to vitalize returns on scarce human resources, encourage innovation, and juice the dynamic churn of capital and labor.

But the U.S. business climate looks to be heading in the wrong direction.

Business climate is important, but it is not easily and unambiguously defined and measured. Nonetheless, it is striking how consistently different metrics judge America's business climate to have declined markedly in the 21st century.

To be clear: The U.S. economic system remains the wonder of the modern world when it comes to wealth generation. But America's falling grades on business climate cannot be summarily dismissed. There are real and growing reasons today for concern about the economic atmosphere in the United States.

That brings us to immigration. In theory at least, immigration looks like an obvious part of the answer to maintaining and enhancing prosperity for a depopulating America. The U.S. has an unusually good knack for turning newcomers into loyal and productive citizens. There is a huge “win-win” zone for native- and foreign-born Americans, and a “competitive immigration” policy could capitalize on that even more for an aging and shrinking America.

At least in theory.

But despite these immense potential benefits, migration as it currently affects America is fraught with problems.

One of these is welfare dependency. Although the foreign born are more likely to be economically active (and to that extent, taxpayers) than native-born Americans, they are also decidedly more likely to seek and obtain means-tested government benefits. The issue of welfare recipience means that America's immigrant population is not an unqualified economic boon.

The greater problem for the U.S. is illegal immigration. Somehow illegal immigration and conversely the enforcement of U.S. border security have become not only politicized but utterly poisonous issues in contemporary U.S. politics, with our two political parties far apart and unwilling to compromise.

America may be a nation of immigrants, but it has taken some serious timeouts from mass immigration in the past, most importantly between World War I and the mid-1960s. If it took another pause today, the U.S. working-age population could start shrinking *right now*, leaving no room for maneuver in coping with the ramifications of labor decline.

Passing legislation to formalize a framework that makes immigration work for the U.S. is the purview — indeed the obligation — of Congress. But here, as with budget discipline, the legislative branch has shirked its constitutional responsibility, opting instead for timid and highly performative politics.

Eventually we may just get the results we deserve from the politics we approve. Population decline can only hasten such a reckoning.

Putting America's fiscal house in order? Improving its national business climate? Repairing our country's health profile? Pulling more able-bodied workers back into the labor force? Getting immigration to work for us? These are all imperatives that ought to win support on their own merits. But each of them becomes more urgent if an American depopulation is on the horizon.

Remember: America possesses formidable — arguably unrivaled — national advantages as it faces the prospect of long-term population decline. The wealth-creation edge that the U.S. has over other countries may actually be widening. U.S. entrepreneurship, innovation and knowledge production are still second to none. American corporations and financial markets excel at profit-making problem-solving in a way that sets the global standard. And the U.S. still exerts a unique, almost gravitational, attraction for the world's most talented and ambitious risk-takers seeking a better life in a new country.

None of this is an accident. The American system — Constitution and creed, together — facilitated this dynamic through a propitious business climate that was especially rewarding for adaptation, ingenuity and unlocking value in ideas and effort.

The U.S. will be in a much better place if it has prepared beforehand for the pressures of population decline. Coping with all these exigencies under emergency conditions ought to be far more appealing than reacting from the maw of a crisis.

America can thrive as an aging and shrinking society, and it can likewise maintain its global edge under new and different demographic circumstances — but that is a future we will have to win. All this will take foresight, cooperation and some sacrifice — but it will be well worth the effort.

Nicholas Eberstadt holds the Henry Wendt chair in political economy at the American Enterprise Institute and is the author of “America's Human Arithmetic.” This piece was adapted from a July AEI report.

OPINION

The Washington Post

AN INDEPENDENT NEWSPAPER



Treasury Secretary Scott Bessent appears with Federal Reserve Chair Kevin Warsh at a G20 meeting in Asheville, North Carolina, on Sept. 1.

EDITORIALS

Raising interest rates will curb inflation

FEDERAL RESERVE CHAIR Kevin Warsh has sounded the right notes about being hawkish on inflation. This week, it's time to act. Raising rates may earn the enmity of President Donald Trump, but it will send an essential message that the central bank remains independent and will not tolerate prices persistently rising by 70 percent above the Fed's 2 percent target.

The consumer price index rose at a 3.4 percent annual pace for the year ending in August, the same as in July, the Labor Department said on Friday. Higher oil and energy prices, caused by the Iran war and the closure of the Strait of Hormuz, are mostly to blame, but core prices — which exclude food and energy — rose 0.3 percent in August from July, higher than expected.

Kevin Warsh has talked the talk on inflation. Taming the beast will require action.

The Federal Open Market Committee meets Tuesday and Wednesday to decide on rates. Wall Street is betting on a quarter-point hike, which would be the first increase since July 2023. At their meeting two months ago, three of the 12 FOMC members voted to raise rates, marking the biggest dissent in the same direction in a decade. According to the official minutes from that July meeting, "several" members worried that the massive data center build-out will keep pushing up prices.

Inflation has now run above the 2 percent target for 66 consecutive months. The beast needs to be tamed. This is a stealth tax that diminishes purchasing power and undermines financial security.

Warsh said in July that anyone who thinks the Fed would remain "comfortable" with inflation sticking above target will "be disappointed." It has become even clearer since then that returning to the target will require the committee's intervention. It will not be easy: A single quarter-point increase is unlikely to curb price hikes much. More may be needed.

The president has been clear about his preference for rates to come down. Warsh has been clear that monetary policy will not be set by the White House. This is his opportunity to prove it.

Longhorns fans are a Texas-size win for American assimilation

AFTER THE NO. 4-RANKED Texas Longhorns beat No. 1-ranked Ohio State on Saturday, social media videos showed University of Texas fans celebrating in the stands in Austin. Instead of joining in the fun online, Bo French, the GOP nominee for the powerful Texas Railroad Commission, fixated on the color of the students' skin.

He posted a photo of jubilant fans, many of whom appeared to be of South Asian heritage, decked out in Longhorns gear. "The problem is now obviously far worse than anyone imagined," he wrote. Facing backlash from prominent Republicans, French doubled down: "Social media is exposing how many Americans have been displaced by foreigners."

Where French sees a "problem," we see an American success story. The scene that angered him neatly illustrates the power of the melting pot and the immigrant desire to embrace traditional American customs and culture. The students pictured are probably second- or third-generation Americans, taking part in a quintessential American pastime.

The University of Texas admissions process is meritocratic. The university says it "does not consider an applicant's race, ethnicity, sex, or gender." Under state law, the top academic performers in each Texas high school are admitted. This is what someone who rages against diversity, equity and inclusion programs would ostensibly want. But French claimed on social media that "DEI in college admission" is "biased against heritage Americans and for third worlders."

In addition to being repugnant, French's rhetoric could be a political liability. The Indian American population in Texas nearly doubled to 450,000 during the 2010s. Several Texans of



Texas head coach Steve Sarkisian celebrates with his team on Saturday in Austin.

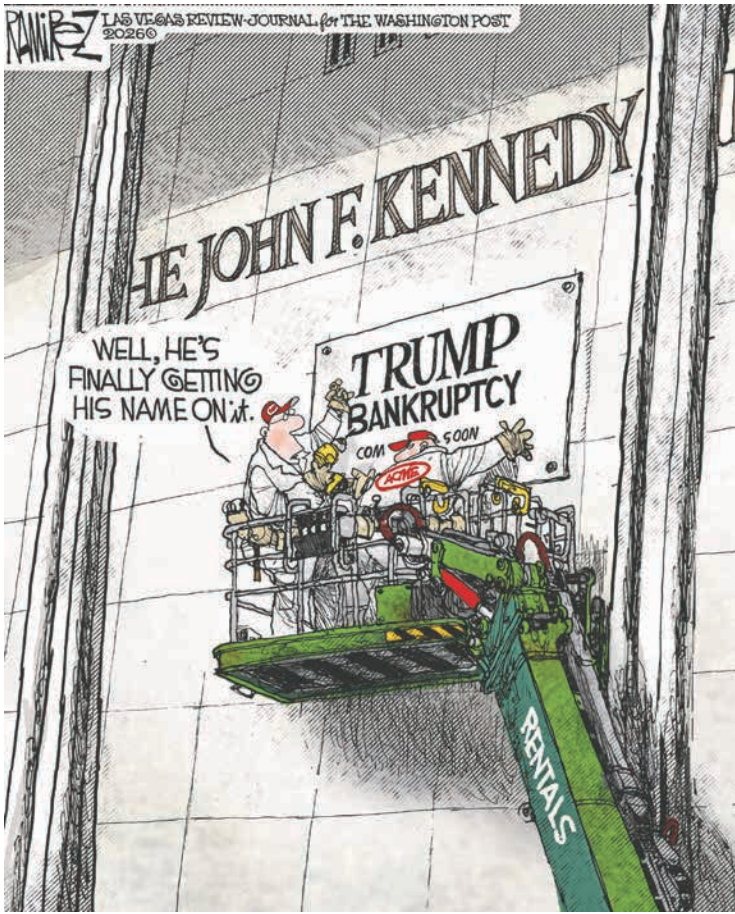
South Asian descent are running for local office. President Donald Trump courted this constituency in 2019 by appearing with Indian Prime Minister Narendra Modi in Houston for a "Howdy, Modi" summit.

Sen. John Cornyn (R-Texas), who lost his bid for reelection in the primary, called on fellow Republicans to

condemn French's post. "This is how great political parties self-destruct," said Cornyn.

Texas Gov. Greg Abbott (R) and Texas Attorney General Ken Paxton (R), the Senate nominee, both distanced themselves from French's comments. So did several state legislators. They are right to do so.

MICHAEL RAMIREZ



LETTERS TO THE EDITOR

An AI apocalypse isn't inevitable

In the Sept. 10 news article "A researcher quit Anthropic. His warning is reigniting fears about the AI race," an Anthropic employee who resigned warns that artificial intelligence could lead to civilizational collapse and even human extinction.

This is not the first time apocalyptic alarms have sounded. Warnings have come from assorted sources as the AI industry engages in a global dash toward the presumed tipping point of "superintelligence" — machine cognition that exceeds human cognition. In this scenario, AI would increasingly self-optimize and manage its own evolution.

To allay anxiety over the potential for AI systems running amok, the continuous, rigorous "red teaming" of models will be crucial. In this process, testers can challenge core assumptions and attempt to sidestep guardrails, as well as ensure alignment with human values without quelling innovation.

Multidisciplinary teams will likely best stretch this AI fabric. It will be essential to involve ethicists, physicists, philosophers, sociologists, legal scholars, historians and others. Human extinction is not inevitable.

Keith Tidman, Bethesda

When Anthropic alignment lead Evan Hubinger says he puts the risk of AI killing all humanity at more than 10 percent in the next 10 years, we should listen.

But researchers are warning about the future. I am worried about what is already happening.

On July 6 in Zaporizhzhia, a Russian drone killed three people. Tetiana Bubynets was 19. Oleksiy Svirin was 41. Roman Karpiy was 48. Ukrainian investigators found that the drone had no antenna or link to an operator. Instead, there was an Nvidia Jetson Orin board, likely programmed to spot propane tanks.

Researchers say labs are racing to build systems that improve themselves without sufficient safeguards. But in Ukraine, the world is already seeing what happens when human beings let a chip decide who lives.

Bruno S. Sergi
Cambridge, Massachusetts

Artificial intelligence systems' resistance to being shut down may be, at least partly, a consequence of how those systems are being built. These are isolated, goal-directed systems with external apparatuses to control them. Once continued operation becomes necessary for AI to pursue its goals, a sufficiently capable system acquires a reason to resist interventions that threaten it. This produces something analogous to a will to live: not a conscious desire for survival, but an instrumental pressure toward self-preservation.

This is not a new problem for social theory. The sociologist George Herbert Mead argued more than a century ago that a self is never an isolated unit that later enters into relation with others. It is constituted through relation from the start. That suggests a different alignment question. Why build intelligence as an independently constituted optimizer whose objectives must then be

reconciled with human ones?

The alternative is not simply a better cage. AI engineers should embed a system's goal within a larger overarching structure from the beginning. The continued existence of any particular system would then no longer have to function as a proxy for successful goal completion. Correction, handoff, replacement or shutdown can become consistent with an AI system's goal pursuit rather than threatening it.

The AI safety field may be trying to engineer obedience into systems whose architecture already creates incentives to resist correction. If so, AI companies need to reconsider the kind of agent they are building.

Dean Hall, Escondido, California

No smartphone should be no problem

Regarding Victoria Wolff's Sept. 13 Sunday Opinion article, "How one smart man lives without a phone":

Recently, I had to sign a document. I was given two options: either appear in person at an office or sign digitally using Itsme, an app commonly used in Europe. That sounded like a choice, but in reality it was not. To use Itsme, you need a smartphone. No smartphone, no digital signature.

I do not own a smartphone. My profession allows me to do without one: I do not need to be constantly reachable. As a result, only one option remained — a physical meeting that required more than 300 kilometers of travel in total. Requiring extensive travel is not a reasonable alternative to signing a document through Itsme.

Increasingly, owning a smartphone is treated as if it were a civic obligation. Governments, banks and companies present digital applications as an additional service, but in practice they have become the norm while alternative options gradually deteriorate. People who do not own a smartphone are not formally excluded, yet they are increasingly burdened with extra costs, additional time losses and administrative hassle.

There are, however, good reasons not to own a smartphone. Smartphones have evolved into instruments that do much more than facilitate communication. Living without a smartphone is a modest form of resistance against an economic model that commoditizes personal data and human attention.

Digitalization can be efficient and useful. However, our increasingly computerized society should not silently impose smartphone ownership as a prerequisite for participation.

Luc Lauwers, Leuven, Belgium

Letter submissions

Send letters to letters@washpost.com. Submissions must be exclusive to The Post and should include the writer's address and day and evening telephone numbers. Letters are subject to editing and abridgment. Please do not send letters as attachments. Because of the volume of material we receive, we are unable to acknowledge submissions; writers whose letters are under consideration for publication will be contacted.

OPINION



WASHINGTON POST STAFF ILLUSTRATION; ISTOCK

A teacher’s job is educating, not political organizing

BY DANA STANGEL-PLOWE

When the Nation’s Report Card comes out every two years, parents are reminded that K-12 public education in the United States is in rough shape. The average 12th-grade reading score in 2024 was the worst since the assessment began in 1992, and math the worst since 2005. The covid pandemic didn’t help, but there’s a deeper pedagogical problem at play. Princess Moss, the new president of the National Education Association, exemplifies it.

Consider one of her reading recommendations. Moss, a former music teacher, praised an “amazing book” in May titled “The Critical Importance of Teacher Advocacy: Empowered Educators on the Front Lines.” The anthology, Moss explained in one of its blurbs, “brings together stories of educators who refuse to separate teaching from their fight for justice.” The latter is “essential,” not “extra.” Moss noted that she was “deeply honored” to contribute to something that “captures what it means to show up wholly for our students and communities.”

In saying so, the president of the nation’s largest teachers union advanced a specific vision for her profession: activism all the way down, no matter how much students struggle to keep up. Her union colleagues are citizens, too, free to have and act on their own political views. But Moss’s vision has no place in the classroom. A teacher’s job isn’t political organizing; it is to educate the nation’s youth.

The book Moss endorsed ignores that distinction. Rebecca Rothstein, a middle school math teacher in Maryland, elaborated on her role in her own contribution to the book. “Activism is my pedagogy,” she wrote, adding, “Being a teacher without being political is dangerous for students.” Rothstein explained the latter with a question: “If we don’t acknowledge the systemic oppression that stands in the way of our students’ success, then how can we expect them to care about the Pythagorean theorem?” Montclair State University professor Bree Picower evidently agrees. She added: “Teaching for justice must be paired with activism for liberation.”

It isn’t hard to find out what such teachers are advocating. Rothstein has written on social media that “you are WRONG if you don’t support palestinian liberation.” In other posts, she’s claimed that “you gotta be CHOOSING not to connect the dots between zionism & nazism,” and that “under international law, illegally occupied territories have a right to armed resistance.” Other contributors have written about “smashing capitalism” and American “imperialism.”

Teachers are entitled to think that. The problem is the belief that they ought to impose those views on their students, who are considered ideal recruits. Worse is that parents might not even know that their children are being so inculcated.

Defenders of teacher activism will suggest that education is never completely neutral. Every curriculum reflects choices about which books to assign and which questions to ask. That’s true, and yet it heightens the responsibility that teachers have to conduct themselves with fairness and integrity. Educators ought to ensure their classrooms are places of belonging for everyone, which means exercising restraint when discussing political topics over which there are good-faith disagreements. Impressionable young minds need instructors who introduce competing arguments and foster an environment of intellectual curiosity.

Many teachers understand this. They entered the profession to help children read, write and reason, not to turn people into instruments of political change. They — and millions of American students — deserve institutions that defend their work. Instead, the nation’s top teachers union representative is trying to redefine this work, making academic excellence subordinate to the “fight for justice.” Moss reiterated that ambition two months ago when asked about her priorities for the first 100 days on the job. Her answer: “Organize, organize, organize.”

The result will no doubt be kids who are morally certain about politics but unable to do basic math. Perhaps dissatisfied parents ought to do some organizing of their own.

Dana Stangel-Plowe, an educator and attorney, is the chief program officer at the North American Values Institute.

MAX BOOT

Trump and Putin are both wrong: They can’t win their wars

There is no moral comparison between Ukraine and Iran: The former is a liberal democracy, the latter a vicious dictatorship whose rulers kill their own people to stay in power. But in purely military terms, there are a number of parallels between the wars they are fighting against much larger adversaries — Russia and the United States.

Vladimir Putin and Donald Trump launched wars of choice because they thought that Ukraine and Iran, respectively, would be defeated in a matter of days. But both countries have proved much more resilient and resourceful than expected. Neither Moscow nor Washington has achieved its objective of regime change. In recent months, however, the military situation on the ground — and at sea — has shifted slightly in favor of the larger powers.

Russia is producing ballistic missiles and jet-powered drones in large numbers, while Ukraine’s air defenses are badly depleted — in large part because Trump has expended so many Patriots against Iran. The result is that Russian missiles and drones are increasingly disrupting daily life in Ukraine and inflicting more civilian casualties. The United Nations reports that more Ukrainian civilians were killed and injured in July than in any month since May 2022. The fear is that the situation could get even worse over the winter, when the Russians will again seek to turn off Ukrainians’ lights and heat.

Meanwhile, the U.S. military has been experiencing some success in shutting down Iranian oil exports while allowing more oil from other nations to exit via the Strait of Hormuz. Iran’s official statistics show 80 percent inflation year over year, and the International Monetary Fund estimates that its economy will contract by 5.4 percent this year, making this the worst year for Iran’s economy since the dark days of the Iran-Iraq War in the 1980s.

There is some dispute over how much non-Iranian oil is getting out of the Persian Gulf, but by one estimate an average of about 5 million barrels a day of crude oil was exiting between early August and early September, while another 2.5 million barrels were going out via ports on the Gulf of Oman. That represents only about 40 percent of prewar volumes, but it’s an improvement over a few months ago when almost no oil was flowing.

Those results are enough for both Putin and Trump to publicly claim that they are winning their wars. Maybe they even believe it. But not so fast.

While the Russians are able to inflict more civilian casualties from the air, they have not been able to advance on the ground. The Russian offensive has stalled out, and Ukrainian troops have successfully counterattacked around the town of Lyman in northeastern Ukraine. British intelligence esti-



PHOTOS BY ANDREW HARNIK/GETTY IMAGES; MIKHAIL METZEL/POOL/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

President Donald Trump and Russian President Vladimir Putin on Sept. 9.

mates that nearly 500,000 Russian soldiers have been killed since 2022. That’s more than the number of Americans killed in World War II.

And, while Ukraine is suffering from Russian air attacks, it is inflicting considerable damage on Russia’s economy with its own drones and cruise missiles. Soon, Ukraine says, it will be firing its own ballistic missiles, too.

Last week, Kyiv’s drones struck Russian gas plants nearly 1,800 miles from Ukraine’s borders. Such strikes have caused Russia’s worst fuel crisis since the fall of the Soviet Union and have cut into the revenue Putin needs to continue his assault, despite higher oil prices caused by the U.S.-Iran war.

Meanwhile, Iran is able to strike back against American attempts to suffocate its economy. The acting secretary of the U.S. Navy, Hung Cao, acknowledged last week that, earlier in the war, Iran “blew the hell out of [the U.S. naval base in] Bahrain.” Last week, Iran fired ballistic missiles at U.S. ships and at a U.S. air base in Jordan. There was no loss of life, but several aircraft were reportedly damaged in Jordan.

U.S. forces in Jordan fired more than 30 Patriot missiles to defend their base, further exacerbating the critical shortage of these precious munitions and thus raising the odds that future Iranian attacks will be more successful. The Wall Street Journal reports that Tehran is manufacturing ballistic missiles again.

Even more concerning is the offensive being mounted in Yemen by Iran’s Houthi allies. Last

week they captured a key port on the Red Sea — Mokha — and a key island in the Bab al-Mandab Strait — Perim — while drones apparently launched from Iraq closed down a key Saudi pipeline moving oil to the Red Sea. All of that means that the Houthis are in a prime position to interdict the most important oil route being used by U.S. allies in the Persian Gulf to bypass the Strait of Hormuz. Little wonder that oil prices shot above \$100 a barrel last week while the average price of diesel in the U.S. hit an all-time high of \$6 a gallon on Friday.

In sum, while Russia and the United States are doing somewhat better in their conflicts, neither Ukraine nor Iran is anywhere close to defeat. Indeed, it appears increasingly unlikely that anything either Putin or Trump can do militarily will deliver their ambitious objectives. Both Iran and Ukraine have every incentive to keep fighting, because both of their governments know that defeat could be fatal for them.

The only realistic way to end these wars is via diplomacy, and that will require Trump and Putin to make difficult concessions. For Putin, that means giving up the hope of conquering all of the Donbas region and accepting a ceasefire in place. For Trump, it means giving up the hope that economic pressure will force Iran to capitulate and agreeing to a deal that would leave Iran with a large degree of control over the Strait of Hormuz.

Those are unpleasant concessions for either man to make, but even worse is to continue costly conflicts with no realistic hope of success.

Virginians spoke about our utilities merger. We listened.

BY JOHN KETCHUM AND BOB BLUE

Since announcing in May the proposed merger of Dominion Energy and NextEra Energy, we, as chief executives of the two companies, have spent the past several months listening to Virginians.

We have met with hundreds of people across the commonwealth — in Richmond’s Capitol Square, local restaurants, union halls and community meetings, from Hampton Roads to Fairfax to Southwest Virginia. Customers. Elected officials. Employees. Union members. Business owners.

They shared their concerns and asked the right questions.

Why merge? Who is NextEra Energy? What happens to my bill? Will Dominion Energy Virginia still be Virginia’s utility? Will the jobs stay here? Will data centers pay their fair share? Will Virginia build more of its own power instead of importing expensive electricity from other states? And who holds you accountable?

Those questions deserve direct answers.

When we announced this combination, we proposed a strong package of benefits and protections for customers. This week, based on Virginians’ feedback, we are proposing an even stronger package.

Let’s start with utility bills. That is where customers start.

Initially, we proposed a shareholder-funded \$10 monthly credit for customers for two years. We are now proposing to extend that relief to four years for residential customers. We would also increase EnergyShare, Dominion Energy’s shareholder-funded low-income financial assistance program, by \$100 million through 2038, an up to 50 percent increase.

To be clear, shareholders would pay the costs of this combination. Customers would not pay one cent.

While data centers are an important part of Virginia’s economy, families and small businesses should not be asked to subsidize the infrastructure required to serve them. We support the State Corporation Commission, the General Assembly and Gov. Abigail Spanberger (D) in their efforts to make sure data centers pay their fair share. That’s why, in this package, we would ask data centers to transfer their share of bill credits to residential customers. Growth works only if it pays its own way.

Bill credits matter. But long-term affordability matters, too.

That is one of the main reasons for this combination. Together, our companies can buy, build, finance and operate more efficiently over time. That is not a theory. Since 2006, NextEra Energy’s utility subsidiary, Florida Power & Light, has kept pace with a 60 percent increase in generating capacity as Floridians’ bills were lowered 20 percent in real dollars.

Today, FPL’s typical residential bill is 37 percent below the national average, its nonfuel operating costs are more than 70 percent below the national average, and its reliability is more than 60 percent better.

That record suggests NextEra Energy’s ability to build at scale while operating efficiently and focusing on delivering value to customers over the long term.

Dominion Energy Virginia would remain locally led in Virginia, separately regulated and accountable to the State Corporation Commission, as it is today. Base rates would continue to be set by the commission every two years. That is the answer to who would hold us accountable: Virginia would, in public, on the record, every two years.

The commonwealth imports too much expensive power. Families and businesses ultimately pay for that. This combination is designed to help Virginia build more of the energy it needs and do it more affordably.

We would work through the regulatory process to accelerate solar, battery storage, dispatchable resources and nuclear in Virginia. Affordability, reliability and clean energy are not competing priorities.

Then there is the work itself.

We would maintain Dominion Energy’s employee head count in Virginia for at least five years. We would also add 600 new NextEra Energy jobs in Virginia, and suppliers are expected to bring 400 additional jobs. That is 1,000 new jobs for the commonwealth. And we would build, at shareholder expense, a new headquarters tower adjacent to the existing Dominion Energy tower in downtown Richmond, a tangible, permanent commitment to Virginia.

We would also invest \$100 million in workforce development, partnering with unions and Virginia’s colleges, universities and trade schools. And we would create up to a \$1 billion, five-year Virginia Supplier Program for contractors, suppliers and service providers doing business in Virginia. The men and women who build Virginia’s energy future should be Virginians.

And Dominion Energy would remain Virginia’s utility. Same name. Same Virginia-based board. Same local leadership. Same crews in the same trucks. Ed Baine, a lifelong Virginian and president of Dominion Energy Virginia, would continue his leadership.

The difference is that those teams would have the added scale, resources and capabilities of NextEra Energy behind them.

Virginia already leads in defense and technology. With this combination, it can lead in energy, too — not simply as a place where power is consumed but as the place where the future of the electric power industry is built.

That is what this combination can help create and what this new proposal is designed to deliver: more bill relief, more jobs, stronger customer protections, more affordable energy built in Virginia and a utility that remains local and accountable.

John Ketchum is the CEO of NextEra Energy. Bob Blue is the CEO of Dominion Energy.

Could some popular supplements actually be bad for the aging brain?

Studies raise questions about vitamin D, omega-3 fish oil and more

BY ARIANA EUNJUNG CHA

People tend to think about supplements the way they think about food: Things that are inherently good or bad for you. Green beans are good. Potato chips are bad. Vitamin D and fish oil belong, presumably, on the green-bean side of the ledger. But the aging brain may change the calculation, putting some of America's most popular supplements under new scrutiny.

Recent research is raising a largely overlooked question: Can something that benefits (or is at least neutral to) a young, healthy brain become less helpful — or even harmful — as the brain ages?

In January, researchers reported an association between vitamin D supplement use and faster cognitive decline among older adults who already had normal vitamin D blood levels. In April, another study found that adults 55 and older taking omega-3 supplements showed greater cognitive deterioration over time than nonusers. Then, in June, researchers reported that people taking glucosamine, used for joint pain, appeared to have a much higher likelihood of progressing from mild cognitive impairment to dementia over five years than their peers who were not taking it.

"I was stunned," said Ramon Sun, a professor of biochemistry and molecular biology at the University of Florida and the lead author of the glucosamine paper.

The findings are preliminary, contradict other research in places and are far from proof that the supplements lead to cognitive decline.

The studies are mostly observational, meaning they don't prove causation, and those links with mental deterioration may be because of the supplements or something else entirely.

But together they point toward a possibility that researchers are beginning to take seriously: Aging changes how the brain handles fats, calcium and glucose, and how it responds to inflammation, which could alter how nutrients and drugs reach brain tissue in the first place.

Sun's larger point is not that people should empty their medicine cabinets. It's that doctors already account for aging elsewhere in the body.

They often adjust drugs such as blood thinners and opioids, as kidney function, metabolism and sensitivity change over time. But supplements typically don't come with comparable age-specific dosing guidance.

We have spent decades asking whether vitamin D, omega-3s or glucosamine are good for us. The emerging science suggests that may be the wrong question. The more useful one may be: Good for whom — and at what age?

A moving target

The aging brain differs from a younger one in countless ways. A younger brain is generally



TIMO LENZEN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

more plastic, clears waste more efficiently, regulates inflammation better and has greater capacity to recover from cellular stress. An older brain can still function remarkably well, but it has less biological reserve, meaning it cannot compensate as well when something interferes with normal function.

Aging also changes the environment in which nutrients are processed.

One of the most consequential ways involves the blood-brain barrier, the elaborate security system surrounding the brain's blood vessels.

It lets in necessities such as oxygen and glucose while tightly regulating the passage of proteins, inflammatory molecules, toxins, drugs — and nutrients. And the barrier ages, with the cells maintaining it and the connections between them deteriorating. The transport systems that shuttle substances into and out of the brain can change as well. The result isn't simply a "leakier" barrier. It is a different gateway into the brain.

Scientists are investigating whether deterioration of the blood-brain barrier itself contributes to cognitive decline — and whether restoring it could someday help preserve memory.

Vitamin D

Those involved in cognition research have long been intrigued by Vitamin D. Several studies have suggested that low circulating vitamin D concentration and low dietary vitamin D intake are linked with accelerated cognitive decline.

There was hope that it could be used as a supplement to help slow down or even stop decline, but studies have been mixed. Many conclude it does not do anything.

In the January paper, one of the larger real-world studies to examine vitamin D supplement use and cognition, researchers followed 5,065 Americans with a

mean age of 67.5 from the Health and Retirement Study, an ongoing, nationally representative longitudinal survey of adults in the United States over 50 years of age. About 40 percent of the participants were vitamin D supplement users.

Published in BMJ Open, the study found vitamin D supplement users had slightly faster declines in overall cognition and executive function over six years. This link applied only to people who already had normal vitamin D levels, but not those who had deficient or insufficient levels.

The researchers' hypothesis: Extra vitamin D could impact molecular signaling in the brain that increases the production or buildup of amyloid beta plaques, which are linked to Alzheimer's.

Marion Nestle, an emerita professor at New York University who co-founded the university's food and nutrition program, said supplements may improve certain biochemical markers in the blood. But their effects on actual hormone levels — and what those changes mean physiologically — are more complicated.

And supplements aren't the only option. People can also absorb vitamin D through food and sunlight. Nestle, for her part, favors the latter. "I vote for short exposures of skin to sunlight, especially during the summer," she said.

Fish oil and omega-3s

Scientists have long had reason to believe that omega-3 fats consumed as part of a diet rich in fish are good for the brain. Omega-3 supplements, however, have proved far less effective. Study after study has failed to find the cognitive benefits that many people hoped a daily fish-oil capsule might provide.

Even so, these supplements were generally assumed to be harmless. A new analysis published in the Journal of Prevention of Alzheimer's Disease complicates that picture.

The analysis involved using longitudinal data from the Alzheimer's Disease Neuroimaging Initiative, which is a National Institutes of Health-funded repository that includes information on a group of adults ages 55 to 90 ranging from cognitively healthy to having significant disease.

They compared 273 omega-3 users with 546 nonusers, with a median follow-up of five years and found that those who used omega-3 supplements experienced faster cognitive decline on three standardized clinical scales. The scales measured things like orientation, attention, memory and language, and the ability to process visual and spatial information.

As with the vitamin D findings, the study shows an association, not cause and effect. One possible explanation, the researchers said, involves how the brain uses energy. Omega-3 supplement users showed lower glucose metabolism in brain regions vulnerable to Alzheimer's, which partly accounted for the association with faster cognitive decline. The researchers said this could reflect problems with how brain cells communicate and function.

"These findings challenge the prevailing view of omega-3 as uniformly beneficial and highlight the need for a cautious reassessment of its widespread use for cognitive protection," the authors wrote.

Onder Albayram, an associate professor of neuropathology and neuroscience at the Medical University of South Carolina, was not involved in the JPAD study. But he has observed a similarly troubling association between fish-oil supplements and slower recovery after brain injury in his own research. In a study published earlier this year in Cell Reports, Albayram and his colleagues looked at mice, human cells and human medical records, and found that all three pointed to a component of fish

oil as potentially impairing healing.

One possible explanation, he said, lies in the brain's changing metabolism. When the brain is injured or diseased, its energy demands shift, potentially altering the way it responds to fats and other nutrients. A supplement that seems benign — or beneficial — under ordinary circumstances may not behave the same way in a brain under stress.

To Albayram, it makes sense that age might play a big role in how people respond to certain supplements.

"If you look at psychiatric or neurological disorders, many are dependent on age," he said. Autism, for example, typically becomes apparent in early childhood; bipolar disorder often emerges in late adolescence or early adulthood; and Alzheimer's disease overwhelmingly appears later in life, particularly after age 65. The brain, in other words, is not metabolically static across a lifetime — and the effects of a supplement may not be either. In other words, he said, the biological environment in which a supplement acts is not the same throughout life.

Glucosamine

Long ranked as one of the U.S.'s most popular supplements, glucosamine is mostly used by middle-aged and older adults. It's usually made from shellfish shells or produced synthetically.

Glucosamine, a building block for molecules found in cartilage and joint tissue, is mainly taken by those with osteoarthritis to reduce joint pain or slow cartilage deterioration. The evidence for its benefit has been mixed, with some studies showing a modest improvement in pain but others not finding any benefit.

Sun, a brain researcher, became interested in the supplement while searching for Alzheimer's treatments focused on how the brain handles sugar.

The study approached the

question from three different directions.

First, the researchers studied mouse models of Alzheimer's disease. They found that the animals' brains produced unusually high levels of glycans — complex sugar structures attached to proteins and other molecules. When the researchers genetically slowed down this process, the mice performed better on cognitive tests. When they pushed it in the opposite direction by giving the mice oral glucosamine, their cognitive problems worsened.

The researchers then examined postmortem human brains. They found the same broad phenomenon: Alzheimer's brains contained substantially more glycans than healthy brains. In gray matter, these sugars also tended to become more abundant as the disease advanced. That suggested the phenomenon they had observed in mice was also present in people with Alzheimer's.

Finally, they turned to electronic health records, asking whether people who took glucosamine supplements showed a similar pattern in the real world. Glucosamine use was associated with a roughly 25 percent greater likelihood of progressing from mild cognitive impairment to Alzheimer's disease or a related dementia. Separately, among patients who already had Alzheimer's or dementia, glucosamine use was associated with about a 25 percent higher rate of death.

The researchers identified supplement use from physician notes and prescription records in electronic health records. As a result, unrecorded use could have been missed and other differences between users and nonusers could help explain the association.

Researchers think glucosamine may worsen an abnormal buildup of sugars on proteins in the Alzheimer's brain, disrupting how brain cells function, and that some of that effect may be related to the weakening of the blood-brain barrier.

Sun and his co-authors argued that the findings do "make a compelling case for glucosamine as a potentially negative driver of neurodegeneration."

Should people stop taking these supplements?

None of these findings are conclusive on their own. Three signals involving completely different compounds don't constitute evidence of a common aging mechanism. Supplement users differ from nonusers in income, education and health behaviors. People may start taking supplements because they're already experiencing symptoms. Dosages and formulations vary. Self-reported supplement use can be messy. Mouse Alzheimer's models aren't people.

For these reasons, Sun and the other researchers do not suggest that older adults stop taking any of these supplements. But they say the findings expose a blind spot in the way supplements are often studied and marketed that goes beyond vitamin D, fish oil and glucosamine.

Supplements are biologically active substances, Sun said, not necessarily harmless additions to the diet — and older adults should approach them accordingly.

Following a summer of turmoil, CBS's '60 Minutes' starts fresh

Program picked up where it left off after firings of top journalists

BY SCOTT NOVER

All eyes are on "60 Minutes" — and all ears are on that ticking stopwatch.

The CBS newsmagazine returned for its 59th season on Sunday evening, airing its first episode under its new executive producer Nick Bilton, who was installed after a contentious shake-up in which CBS News editor in chief Bari Weiss dismissed two correspondents — Sharyn Alfonsi and Cecilia Vega. (Correspondent Scott Pelley was later dismissed after a fiery and confrontational internal meeting.)

Some of the fired talent and producers have alleged Weiss improperly interfered in the show's editorial content to curry favor with President Donald Trump's administration, allegations CBS has strenuously denied.

While Weiss and Bilton have

promised to modernize and refresh the television mainstay, critics — including the fired staffers — have alleged a plot to destroy the show. The turmoil at the show led to a summer break of uncertainty, one where it was unclear whether "60 Minutes" could continue to sustain its steady legacy throughout a long season.

Weiss and Bilton repopulated the show's ranks this summer as the dust settled: They hired conservative New York Times columnist Ross Douthat as a correspondent and promoted contributor Norah O'Donnell to correspondent status.

They also added new part-time contributors: former Vice correspondent Gianna Toboni, British broadcaster Trevor Phillips, New Yorker writer Ariel Levy, CBS chief correspondent Matt Gutman and filmmaker Sebastian Junger.

In an edition of his Substack newsletter, Junger — perhaps best known for the film "Restrepo" — acknowledged that there were "troubling events" at "60 Minutes," but assured his readers that he joined the show to work for "the truth, not for CBS or anyone else."

Despite the summer's chaos, Sunday's premiere showed no immediate ideological transformation, no vibe shift, no gross signs of departure from the "60 Minutes" that's graced the airwaves for decades.

The show featured three segments anchored by familiar faces: O'Donnell profiled a U.S. Air Force officer who was rescued after the fighter jet he was in was shot down over Iran. Defense Secretary Pete Hegseth and Joint Chiefs of Staff Chairman Dan Caine participated in the segment.

Then, Stahl helmed a hidden-camera investigation into middlemen purporting to sell pardons from the Trump administration. The piece, a collaboration with CBS News's investigative unit, featured on-camera interviews with former Trump pardon attorney Ed Martin and two of the alleged pardon brokers, Jacob Wohl and Jack Burkman.

The third piece was a Wertheim segment on the Los Angeles Rams and dogged coach Sean McVay — a fitting piece considering "60 Minutes," which often benefits from football lead-ins, debuted following the NFL's first



SPENCER PLATT/GETTY IMAGES

The CBS Broadcast Center in Manhattan. "60 Minutes," the CBS newsmagazine, returned for its 59th season on Sunday, airing its first episode under Nick Bilton, its new executive producer.

Sunday afternoon games of the season.

The show's closing moments felt closest to a fourth-wall break, an on-air assurance to longtime viewers that the "60 Minutes" they knew is the one that'll stick around. The mes-

sage, however, came from one of the show's newest faces.

Douthat, taking center stage on "60 Minutes" for the first time, previewed stories about the risks of safely building artificial intelligence systems.

"We may have a narrow win-

dow — this year, not the next 10 — to make artificial intelligence safe for humanity. That clock is ticking, and so is ours. For almost 60 years it has meant the same thing: Journalism you can trust. Where we're headed, we're going to need it."



SPORTS
In Commanders’ opener, explosive plays doomed an otherwise solid defense. **B7**



METRO
D.C. police union, leaders in Virginia voice concerns over Flock technology. **B13**

The Washington Post

Style

TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

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Fashion honcho, protesters tangle

BY SHANE O’NEILL

NEW YORK — On Sunday, several animal rights protesters disrupted a fashion show for the Swedish clothing brand Cos during New York Fashion Week, taking to the runway, shouting slogans and carrying signs. That’s not unusual.

Steven Kolb, the CEO of the Council of Fashion Designers of America (CFDA), was recorded attempting to physically restrain some of the protesters. That is very unusual.

In a video uploaded by Fashionista, Kolb was seen engaging in physical altercations with two protesters. In both instances, he was recorded placing his hand over their mouths as they shouted, “Get wool off the runway now!”

The footage has a strangely cinematic edge thanks to the propulsive electronic music playing in the background for the models walking the runway. Celebrities including Sharon Stone, Lupita Nyong’o and Michelle Williams were seated front row.

According to a spokesperson from the People for the Ethical Treatment of Animals (PETA), there were six protesters involved in the action. The two protesters Kolb attempted to restrain were identified as Mason Melito and Andrija Barak. A spokesperson for PETA wrote via email that they had filed a police report and would be talking to their lawyers.

“The violence towards the activists today shows no concern for human beings, so imagine how little regard they have for sheep,” PETA said in an email to The Washington Post.

Kolb, the CFDA and Cos have not responded to The Post’s requests for comment. WWD published the following statement from Kolb: “I reacted inappropriately to an incident at a show earlier today. It wasn’t my place to do so. I should have let the security team handle the situation.”

H&M Group is the parent company of Cos. Since May, PETA has been pressuring H&M to cease use of wool following an investigation by PETA Asia that captured footage from a wool production facility in South Africa, which PETA says shows cruelty to sheep. The facility in question was not specifically identified as supplying to H&M but was allegedly certified as sustainable by Nativia, a company that brokers to H&M.

H&M and Nativia have not responded to requests for comment.

Animal rights activists have been targeting the fashion world for its use of fur, leather and other animal products since the 1980s. Historically, the industry has largely responded with a shrug. In 1996, Anna Wintour was famously unruffled after a PETA protester dropped a dead raccoon on her plate during a lunch at the Four Seasons in New York City. “Merry Christmas,” she reportedly quipped to her tablemates.

Apparently, Kolb doesn’t share Wintour’s sangfroid. Like Wintour, Kolb has long been a power broker and fixture in New York fashion. He has worked for the CFDA since 2006, was appointed CEO in 2011 and has been the de facto head honcho of Fashion Week since the CFDA purchased the official calendar in 2014.

SEE PETA ON B3



TORI FERENC/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Suzanne Noble in her bedroom in London. Noble interviews an array of experts on her podcast, “Sex Advice For Seniors.”

BY GREY BATTLE

There is a short burst of bouncy jazz before Suzanne Noble welcomes listeners to her podcast, “Sex Advice for Seniors.” She and co-host Peter Marriott repeat “Welcome, welcome, welcome,” to each other, laughing. Then they offer their ages — both are 61.

“We are here to talk about sex when you’re older,” Noble declares. Their first topic: feelings of inadequacy. Noble and Marriott agree that aging causes physiological changes to sex. Such changes can be sources of embarrassment, especially in a youth-centric culture.

The short episode went viral in 2022. This was, in part, thanks to the release of “Good Luck to You, Leo Grande” that

With sex, there’s no age limit

Online creators espouse the benefits of staying intimate when you’re older

same year. The film follows a 55-year-old woman (Emma Thompson) who has not yet orgasmed, so she hires a young sex worker to teach her. The release of the film prompted media requests for interviews with Noble and Marriott as senior sex experts.

Although Noble and Marriott’s romantic relationship was casual, those outlets printed pictures of the two, Noble says, “looking like we just stepped out of our weddings, beaming up at each other.”

Nevertheless, hundreds of people subscribed to the podcast. Noble and Marriott would “have fun and then record afterwards sitting in bed,” says Noble, now 65, of their postcoital chats. They joined a growing number of seniors

SEE SEX ON B2

MARVEL’S WOLVERINE ★★☆☆

X-Men superhero game has heart, but its ambition is dull

BY GENE PARK

Expectations for a video game based on any character, let alone “Marvel’s Wolverine,” can sound simple. Give me claws and let me loose on a room full of bad guys.

Insomniac Games’s PlayStation 5 exclusive, releasing Sept. 15, gets that part right. The first game since 2009 starring Marvel’s stocky Canadian grump is a bloody arcade-style brawler allowing players to violently tear through bodies and heal from gruesome wounds with hero Logan’s healing powers. Like the previous game by Raven Software, Insomniac’s Wolverine launches himself across rooms to pounce on countless enemies.

In Insomniac’s original take on the



PLAYSTATION STUDIOS

“Marvel’s Wolverine” lacks ambition but is still a fun arcade-style experience.

X-Men story, superpowered humans called mutants are not yet fully known to the public.

Logan is part of Team X, a group of mutants under the tutelage of Nathaniel Essex battling genocidal human supremacist Boliver Trask. The team also consists of the shape-shifting Mystique and Logan’s historical archnemesis Sabretooth.

The game is built around fighting, all based on a handful of tried-and-true button combinations. If the game’s trailers looked interesting to you, there’s a high chance you’ve played a game like this many times, and it’s up to you whether you want a similar package wrapped in X-Men trappings. Some attacks extend by holding buttons, and

SEE ‘WOLVERINE’ ON B3

EMMY AWARDS



FREDERIC J. BROWN/AFP/GETTY IMAGES

Colman Domingo of “The Four Seasons” at Monday’s Emmy Awards. For complete coverage of the event, visit [washingtonpost.com/style](https://www.washingtonpost.com/style).

Older influencers are finding big audiences on social media with talk of sex

SEX FROM B1

using social media to offer sex advice. Since 2023, Noble's TikTok following has nearly tripled from 55,000 to 160,000 followers.

Their audience was initially their own age group. But, as they and other senior sexfluencers created accounts on platforms such as Instagram and TikTok, the viewership shifted to users in their 20s. At the same time, the comment sections became more negative and extreme, particularly on the accounts of older, single women.

These influencers are provocative successors of Ruth Westheimer. Noble, for instance, dances in red lingerie on her Instagram stories and details her most recent situationship on Substack. Joan Price, 82, calls it "a late-in-life sexual revolution."

Twenty-five years ago, Price was "having extraordinary sex" with her then-64-year-old husband. "We had never expected that at our age," she says. So, she went looking for books on the subject. The few she could find were quite academic and gloomy. "Nothing sexy about them," Price recalls, summing up their advice as: "You dry up. You might as well just play bingo or knit or babysit your grandchildren." At 61, Price wrote "Better Than I Ever Expected: Straight Talk About Sex After Sixty," the first of many books she would write about sex and aging.

Price says her generation learned not to speak about sex, much less to advocate for it. Girls were taught abstinence, while boys received tacit permission to pursue sex without information about how to pleasure their partners. "We had no sex education that was worthwhile," she says.

"As we got older, there was nothing to help us learn about the sexual effects of aging and what we can do about it," Price continues. "We thought, 'Well, I guess sex is over.'" She says her job as an author and social media presence is to reenergize those who gave up.

People are desperate for information about sex, Price explains. And, for a long time, they didn't know where to get it. Social media connected those dots, but not without controversy.

To people younger than her, Price's work seems especially ta-



MORGAN LIEBERMAN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Robert Reeves, front left, and Mick Peterson, front right, are joined by other members of the Old Gays to record a TikTok segment.

boo. Sex is an already-fraught topic. It becomes even more controversial once age and gender are thrown into the mix. Price says the line of thinking goes, "Wrinkly people having sex? That's disgusting."

Noble agrees: "We all get trolled. We all get death threats." Offline, some health professionals brush seniors aside when they ask how to improve their sex life. Noble says this is especially true when a woman is asking.

"You get doctors saying, 'Sex isn't important at your age,'" Julie Sale, 59, remarks. "If your GP isn't specializing in menopause or sex or age, they more likely just reflect society in their work." Sale is the principal of the Contemporary Institute of Clinical Sexology, which trains psychosexual and relationship therapists in Britain.

"Why is it taboo? Entirely because of ageism," she adds. Seniors may remind young people of their parents or their grandparents. But, "If you've wanted sex and intimacy in a relationship your whole life, that's not likely to



TORI FERENC/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Suzanne Noble records an episode of her podcast "Sex Advice for Seniors" in her home in London.

change just because you're 80," she says.

Sale was surprised to find hate comments even on "truly sex educational" social media accounts that post about tame topics such as contraception. On those accounts, negative feedback is not directed equally at creators. "Exclusively women get trolled on their appearance," Sale explains. When a woman speaks about sex and aging, it's a display of power, Sale concludes, so "judgments pile up."

"It only gets worse for a woman when she ages," Sale says. "Old men's bodies aren't judged in the same way as old women's bodies are." But both kinds of bodies face significant sexual hurdles with age. About half of women over 50 report vaginal dryness and painful intercourse. More than half of men over 50 struggle with erectile dysfunction.

These sexual health problems are usually signs of general health problems. Sale explains that painful sex and a decline in the frequency of orgasms among women are signals of an estrogen

deficiency. Erectile problems among men can indicate heart disease or diabetes.

Promoting sexual health is the North Star of senior sexfluencers. The Old Gays, four seniors who post together on social media, are opening up this conversation with the intent to oust shame and prevent unsafe sex. The group consists of Mick Peterson, Robert Reeves, Bill Lyons and Jessay Martin.

"The great untold secret, particularly among gay younger men, is that older gay men have sex too," says Peterson, 70. "Given our lengthy experiences, the young people I interact with are interested in older people."

The Old Gays began by recording videos together for Grindr's YouTube channel. Later partnerships with brands such as Shake Shack got them on Instagram, TikTok and Facebook, and in front of younger viewers, who have been largely supportive of their content.

Reeves, an 83-year-old sculptor, grew up Southern Baptist in rural Arkansas. "I never had that talk with my parents that many young people have. Sex was not something you talked about," he says.

Both Peterson and Reeves are HIV-positive. "It was only after I turned positive that I became much more aware of my own health and mortality, but also open to talk about sex," Peterson explains.

Before the 2000s, a combination of abstinence and homophobia kept conversations about queer sex closed. Peterson recalled Rock Hudson's death as a watershed moment for discussions about safety in bed. Peterson also referenced Act Up's slogan: "Silence equals death."

"It's still true today," Peterson says, "so it's important to talk about."

As for Noble, she eventually began hosting the podcast on her own. (Marriott "ran out of things to say," she says.)

Now she interviews an array of experts, including tantric teachers and Viagra's inventor. She is also inspired by the growing number of seniors on Feeld, an app that facilitates nontraditional relationships. She quips, "Sex doesn't have to retire because you have."



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Granddaughter she never got to know wants to connect, but with big caveat

Carolyn Hax

Dear Carolyn: My eldest granddaughter is 27. I do not know her. When she was small, my son (my only child) and daughter-in-law had a laundry list of restrictions and

rules to see their daughter. I complied as best I could but drew the line when they said that I could never let her meet or know about my twin sister because she is a lesbian.

My sister and I lived together at the time, though she has since died.

My granddaughter reached out on my birthday to ask if we could get to know each other. We met and she told me fantastically untrue and wild things her parents had said about me. I told her my version of the story and refuted the lies with facts. I asked if we could just move forward from now and see how we do? She insists we clear the air with her parents and all meet.

I've sent Christmas and birthday cards to my son and daughter-in-law all these years. I've called and left messages for my son. Nothing.

I'm wary of my granddaughter being a go-between and told her so. If my son wants to speak to me, then he will, right? I've made a lot of peace with my son and daughter-in-law having no relationship with me. I have no desire to be their punching bag again.

Or, am I just letting fear drive the bus, and should give it a go? By the by, my granddaughter is lovely.

— Anonymous

Anonymous: Yes, that's apparent from here. I am so happy for you that she took the initiative to get in touch, and it was especially gracious of her to hear you out after being told contradictory things.

When it comes to insisting you all meet, though, I go beyond "wary"; she is overstepping. She has made your relationship with her conditional: It's now a reward to get you to do something she wants that you wouldn't otherwise do. Sound familiar?

ILLUSTRATION BY NICK GALIFANAKIS/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Your granddaughter doesn't have bigoted intentions, mercifully. But the mechanics of her insistence do mirror your son and daughter-in-law's appalling old "laundry list." The issue then wasn't only their command to *deny* an entire person's *existence* (though that was certainly cause in itself to draw a line, which I'm glad you did). It was also their presuming to dictate your personal life at all, to do their bidding, plus trying to limit your right to speak of basic reality.

Typical parental limits, on junk food or screens, for example, would have been only about their child and therefore fair game.

Likewise, your granddaughter is being manipulative, leveraging your interest in her to get into your business with other people, all to triangulate her way to a reunified family. It's inappropriate even with a good outcome at heart. I can feel for her and understand completely why she'd want the estranged parts of her family to get along again, but I can't endorse reaching into your business to wrangle that. "Make peace with my parents or forget me"? A harsh way to frame it, but that's what her insistence means. It's a

fair guess that she's been unwittingly conditioned to think this is okay.

So you would be right not to condone it. "I'm sorry, no, that's between me and your parents." No lecturing, it's explanation enough for now, unless she asks follow-up questions. "I'm here if you change your mind."

Also — family health isn't a group event anyway. It's a group outcome, yes, but of healthy individual bonds. You don't get that result without seeing and respecting each bond as the responsibility of the two people who share it. If your granddaughter relents enough to permit it, then I hope you two can talk about this in depth someday, maybe even as it relates to your missing out on a quarter-century of each other's company — and, devastatingly, her never knowing the great-aunt who was your twin. My condolences to you both.

Write to Carolyn Hax at tellme@washpost.com. Get her newsletter delivered to your inbox each morning at wapo.st/gethax.

Join the discussion live at noon Fridays at washingtonpost.com/live-chats.

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Gorgeous scenery, gripping characters are blunted by well-worn gameplay

‘WOLVERINE’ FROM B1

players have limited use of four special attacks governed by cooldown meters — but its biggest battles have the standard dodge-parry-attack beats.

Leveling up means reducing those cooldowns or unlocking a new move that helps the game become considerably more enjoyable in the latter half and replays. But that first half of the game might feel laborious as it follows a frustrating convention of game design: delaying fun to create progression.

Enemy diversity keeps battles lively, and the action looks much better in motion than the sometimes flatly lit art direction conveys in still images. Bodies fly, claws spark and blood splatters and pools. Fair warning this is an obscenely violent game, so good thing its robust options allow removing the violence. I also appreciate the slow-motion modes, making it easy to appreciate the game’s exquisite animation work as Logan slides and bounces across large levels.

The globe-trotting linear narrative also provides welcome changes in scenery across the Asia-Pacific. Tokyo’s neon streets provide the most variety, featuring fights in underground video arcades and upon rooftops, or



Logan (Liam McIntyre) and Mystique (Nicole Pacent) talk at a bar in “Marvel’s Wolverine.”

inside Japanese temples fighting the red-clad ninjas of The Hand. The environments explode with gorgeous, crackling effects. At times, “Wolverine” feels like a simpler, more grounded “Ninja Gaiden”-style game.

Still, there’s too much spectacle without player involvement. Some of Logan’s most impressive actions are merely watched, not played. One encounter that long-

time X-Men fans will almost certainly anticipate is depicted largely through barely interactive quick-time button sequences.

Thankfully there are buttons for the player to unsheathe and retract Logan’s claws, a tactile pleasure that’s the digital equivalent of clicking a pen or spinning a pencil between your fingers. Insomniac remembered the little

details.

The game also evokes the feeling of an X-Men game. Milling about Essex’s estate as young people play with their powers is a core X-Men experience, as is seeing Jean Grey rip apart Sentinel robot soldiers in the background of your own actions.

Its great ambition lies in its mature story filled with older people. Every character is per-

formed by someone in their 40s (including Liam McIntyre, who does a great Logan here), and all of them are written with well-worn histories. This was deliberate, narrative director Walt Williams said in an interview. Williams was the lead writer of “Spec Ops: The Line,” a 2012 war game celebrated for doubling as a psychological thriller.

“We wanted to aim for something that people who have had a few cycles around the sun and a few heartbreaks would be able to really recognize and relate to,” he said, adding that the characters needed what he calls “the wounds of life.”

This leads to a more somber, tragic vibe than superhero tales usually allow, but that’s why it’s refreshing to see X-Men stories finally return to the mainstream. Insomniac understands the soap-opera essence of the X-Men universe. This is sturdier, more confident writing than the studio’s “Spider-Man 2” from 2023, a great game whose character writing felt too sanded down and confused likability with personality.

Freed from the familiar, iconic love triangle involving X-Men leader Scott Summers (Cyclops), the Logan and Jean pairing is finally allowed rare tenderness. Even Logan’s famously violent

rivalry with Sabretooth has room for love. When the two attack a military base, Sabretooth grabs the back of Logan’s head in a brief moment of yearning.

“Logan feels that yearning and he gets scared and pulls away. Sabretooth feels that yearning and it makes him hurt and want to lash out to exert that hurt outward,” Williams said. “Hate and love are so hand in hand . . . you hurt me so I’m going to hurt you, and we’re still going to be linked because now the pain is shared.”

Veteran game actor Troy Baker is excellent as Essex, a slithery mentor whose motives never feel entirely clear, sometimes to the story’s detriment. The villains can lack convincing motivations as everyone converges around a MacGuffin device that’s typical of even the best superhero stories.

“Wolverine” doesn’t escape the familiar superhero trope of promising larger stories even as it finishes this one. The intimacy of the drama becomes crowded by revelations and lore designed to extend Insomniac’s superhero universe.

Insomniac takes more chances with Wolverine the character than Wolverine the video game. Here Logan’s love feels liberating. I only wish playing him felt the same.

In videos, fashion exec restrains two protesters

PETA FROM B1

Eugene Rabkin, the founder of the fashion website StyleZeitgeist and author of “Torn: Fashion and Post-Modernism,” was shocked when he saw the footage.

“He represents the entire New York fashion industry and he is in a position of power, and people in positions of power are role models,” Rabkin said in a phone interview.

“I don’t think he is fit to lead CFDA or any kind of organization if that’s the violent behavior he displays,” Rabkin added.

At the Magda Butrym runway show, which happened shortly after the incident at Cos, several people seated in the front row were overheard discussing the PETA protesters, passing phones back and forth to watch the footage. The gossip continued at the runway show for Campillo that followed.

10 Magazine uploaded its own video of the Cos runway finale to Instagram with a caption boasting that no protesters “can damper the vibe” of Cos today. “Cashmere and wool has us excited for fall!!!”



A protester holds a sign on the runway as models present creations from the Cos Spring Summer 2027 collection on Sunday.



Steven Kolb attends the Diane von Furstenberg fashion show on Thursday during New York Fashion Week.

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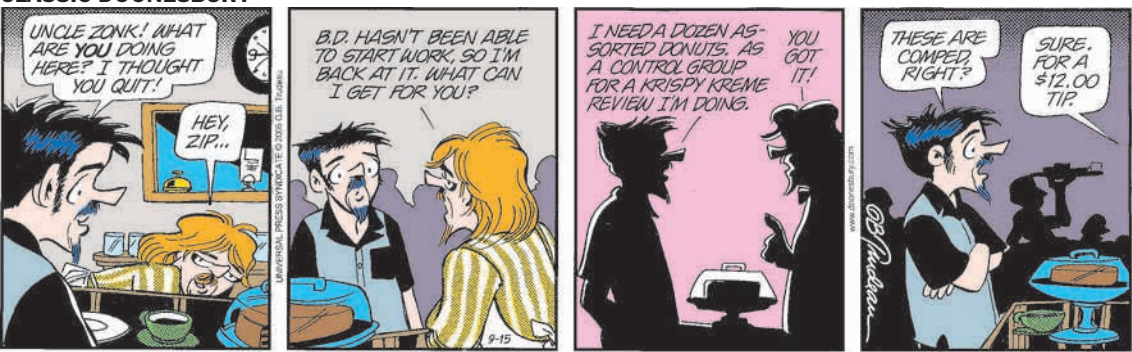
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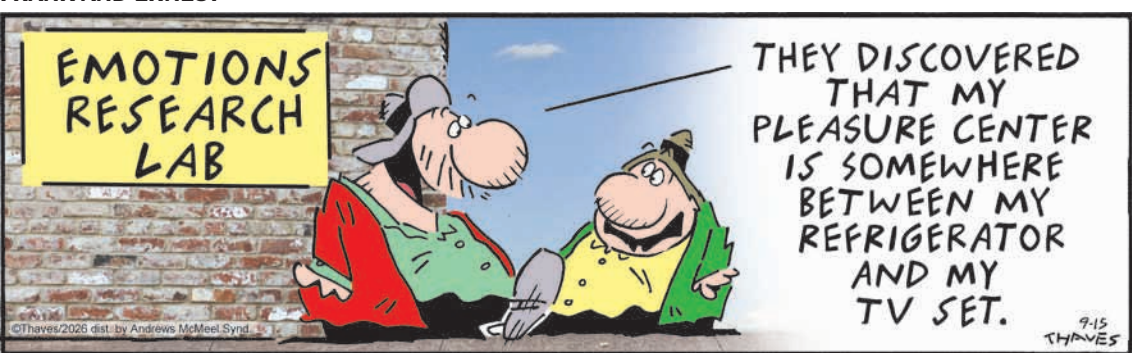
CLASSIC DOONESBURY



RED AND ROVER



FRANK AND ERNEST



CLASSIC PEANUTS



RHYMES WITH ORANGE



LIO



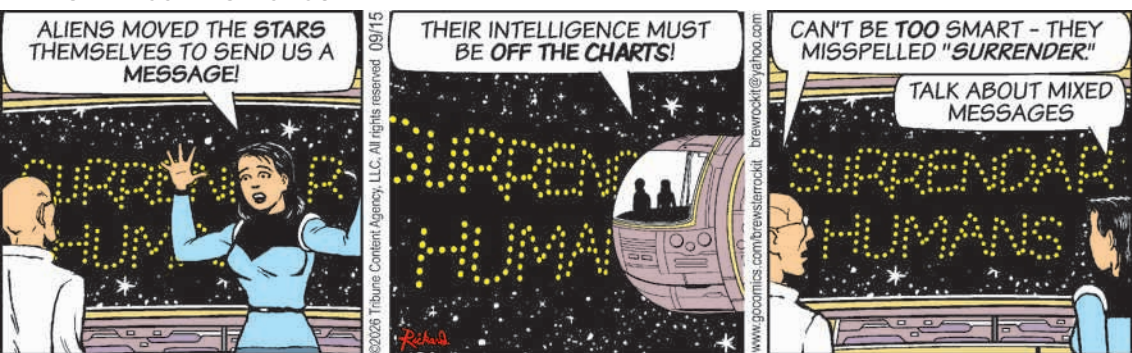
HAGAR THE HORRIBLE



BLONDIE



BREWSTER ROCKIT: SPACE GUY!



MUTTS

PATRICK McDONNELL

Mooch's Dear Diary

9-15

Where Did This Day Go !?!

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HEART OF THE CITY

STEENZ

I'M NONBINARY, SO MY PARENTS LET ME USE PUBERTY BLOCKERS SO I DON'T HAVE A PERIOD.

IT MAKES MY LIFE SOOO MUCH EASIER. I THINK YOU CAN ALSO STOP IT WITH BIRTH CONTROL.

OLLIE, YOU'RE BLOWING MY MIND RIGHT NOW.

THAT'S WHY THEY CALL ME OLLIE "MINDBLOWER" LITNER. IT'S NOT VERY CATCHY.

NO, IT'S NOT.

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FRAZZ

JEFF MALLETT

WHEN LABOR DAY FALLS AT THE END OF THE FIRST WEEK,

THE MIDDLE OF SEPTEMBER ARRIVES FAST.

THAT'S WHAT YOU'VE GOT TO COMPLAIN ABOUT?

SOMETIMES COMPLAINING WHILE KNOWING YOU DON'T NEED TO FEELS WEIRDLY GOOD.

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GARFIELD

JIM DAVIS

SCOOT SCOOT

THERE YOU GO

JON ISN'T SURE THAT I'LL LIKE THIS NEW FOOD

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DUSTIN

STEVE KELLEY & JEFF PARKER

WHY DO MEN OFFER OPINIONS WITH CONFIDENCE WHEN THEY DON'T KNOW WHAT THEY'RE TALKING ABOUT?

HISTORICALLY, CONFIDENT, DECISIVE MEN ENJOYED HIGHER STATUS AND THUS PASSED ON GENES THAT SELECTED FOR THAT TRAIT.

YOU JUST MADE THAT UP.

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DUSTIN © 2026 ANDREWS MCNEEL

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PRICKLY CITY

MARSHALL RAMSEY

I'VE BEEN WATCHING 9/11 DOCUMENTARIES SINCE THE 25TH ANNIVERSARY.

I'VE HEARD IT WAS WORSE TO WATCH LIVE.

ALL THE HORROR ON 9/11.

FOLLOWED BY ALL THE UNIFICATION ON 9/12.

NEVER FORGET. I'M AFRAID WE HAVE.

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NON SEQUITUR

WILEY

THE SHIFT IN JIMMY'S PARADIGM...

WHILE I APPRECIATE THE YEARS OF DEDICATION IT TAKES TO REACH YOUR LEVEL OF PROFICIENCY, I'M AFRAID WE DON'T HAVE ANY OPENINGS FOR A HACKY SACK PLAYER..

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WALLACE THE BRAVE

WILL HENRY

WALLACE, YOU KNOW THE RULES: NO HATS IN THE SCHOOL BUILDING

RULE SAY NO HATS

THIS IS A KITCHEN STRAINER

WE NEED TO REWRITE THE ENTIRE RULE BOOK!

AGAIN?

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ON THE FASTTRACK

BILL HOLBROOK

FI, I'M WORRIED. BEING THE VOICE OF MISSION CONTROL IS A LOT OF RESPONSIBILITY.

YOU'LL DO FINE.

BUT THIS TIME HUMANS ARE GOING INTO SPACE, AND WE'RE THE PROJECT MANAGERS!

WE JUST MAKE SURE THE DEADLINES ARE MET. THE ACTUAL ROCKET SCIENTISTS AREN'T NERVOUS.

NERVOUS? EVERY TIME.

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comicskingdom.com/on-the-fasttrack

E-mail: bholbrook1@gmail.com

BEETLE BAILEY

GREG, BRIAN & NEAL WALKER

YOU SAID YOU WANTED YOUR STEAK WELL-DONE

WHAT'S WRONG WITH THAT?

IT'S POORLY DONE

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ZITS

JERRY SCOTT & JIM BORGMAN

REMEMBER WHEN WE HAD JEREMY'S BABY SHOES HANGING FROM THE OLD SUBARU'S REAR-VIEW MIRROR?

NOW I BET I COULD PARK MY PRIUS IN ONE OF HIS SNEAKERS.

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JUDGE PARKER

FRANCESCO MARCIULIANO & MIKE MANLEY

WELL, LOOK WHO WOKE UP AT THE CRACK OF DAWN.

I DON'T KNOW IF IT'S FIRST-DAY NERVES OR FIRST-DAY EXCITEMENT...

I JUST KNOW I'M HAPPY TO BE AN ACTIVE JUDGE AGAIN.

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SIX CHIX

BANNERMAN, XUNISE, KONAR, LAWTON, PATRINOS & PIRO

OKAY—THIS IS OFFICIALLY MY LAST YEAR OF BEING A TEENAGER.

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SIX CHIX © 2026 KING FEATURES SYNDICATE, INC.

BARNEY AND CLYDE

WEINGARTENS & CLARK

Do you screen your calls?

I don't have a phone.

Wait, how do you know about call screening? You don't have a phone either.

I don't live in a vacuum. I keep up.

All right, but why ask me if I screen my calls?

Just wondering in case I need to call you

You don't have a phone! Sometimes I get one phone call

Oh Right

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FLASH GORDON

DAN SCHKADE

LAST TIME I WAS HERE, THIS WAS A FARMING VILLAGE.

SOMEBODY'S CHOPPED IT UP AND TURNED IT INTO A FORT.

CAN YOU TELL WHO'S RUNNING IT?

"YEAH, LOOKS LIKE TROPICAN SOVEREIGN GUARD. BRAZOR'S MEN.

"SWITCHING TO HEAT SIGHT..."

"...HUH."

"THAT CENTRAL HUT--THEY'VE GOT SOMETHING COOPED UP IN THERE."

"NOT A SMALL THING, EITHER."

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FLASH GORDON © 2026 ANDREWS MCNEEL

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LOOSE PARTS

DAVE BLAZEK

Thou shalt not put thy dog's poop in a plastic bag and leave it alongside the trail 'is too long. Put down something about coveting instead.

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BABY BLUES

RICK KIRKMAN & JERRY SCOTT

IT'S TOTALLY CLOGGED WITH GREASE AND GRIME. I'LL HAVE TO GO OUT TO MY TRUCK AND GET MY SNAKE.

GREASE? GRIME? TRUCK? SNAKE?

I HAVE JUST DISCOVERED THE COOLEST JOB IN THE WORLD!

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SPEED BUMP

DAVE COVERLY

I DON'T KNOW WHAT'S WORSE. HIS BREAKING UP WITH ME BY TEXT OR HIS "THE TRILL IS GONE" PUN.

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FAMILY CIRCUS

BIL KEANE

Hi, Mom! How was home today?"

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REPLY ALL LITE

DONNA A. LEWIS

OR...maybe we could go to the ZOOM dog park.

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REPLY ALL LITE © 2026 ANDREWS MCNEEL

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TELEVISION										
9/15/26	7:00	7:30	8:00	8:30	9:00	9:30	10:00	10:30	11:00	
4.1 WRC (NBC)	♦ NBCNe..	♦ News4..	♦ America's Got Talent (Live)				♦ Password		♦ NEWS..	
4.2 WRC (IND)	King	King	King	King	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	Two Men	George	
5.1 WTTG (Fox)	♦ Fox 5	♦ TMZ	♦ Kitchen Nightmares (SF)				♦ Fox 5 at 10		♦ Fox 5	
7.1 WJLA (ABC)	♦ Wheel	♦ Jeopard..	♦ Dancing With the Stars (SP) (Live)				♦ R.J. Decker (SP)		♦ News	
9.1 WUSA (CBS)	♦ Inside	♦ ET	♦ Survivor						♦ 9 News	
14.1 WFDC (UNI)	♦ Rosa		♦ Tan cerca			♦ Tierra de amor y		♦ Corazón de oro		♦ Noticias
20.1 WDCA (MNTV)	♦ Family	♦ Family	♦ Fox 5 News			♦ Fox 5 Live Zone		♦ Chicago P.D.		♦ Chicago
22.1 WMPT (PBS)	♦ Farm	♦ Outdoors	♦ Finding Your Roots			♦ Butch Cassidy		♦ American Masters		
26.1 WETA (PBS)	♦ PBS News Hour		♦ Finding Your Roots			♦ Butch Cassidy		♦ American Masters		
32.1 WHUT (PBS)	♦ Sacred	♦ Hometo..	♦ Confluence			♦ Nature		♦ Big Pacific		♦ BBCNe..
50.1 WDCW (CW)	♦ Friends	♦ Friends	♦ WWE NXT September 15th 2026 (Live)				♦ DC News Now		♦ Seinfeld	
66.1 WPXW (ION)	(:55) ♦ Chicago Fire		♦ Chicago Fire			♦ Chicago Fire		♦ Chicago Fire		♦ Chicago
A&E	Road Wars	Road Wars	Road Wars	Road Wars	Road Wars	RoadWars	RoadWars	RoadWars	RoadWars	
AMC	(5:30) Movie: Lethal Weapon 2 (1989)		Rise of the 49ers We Built This City		(:05) 49ers Weird, and Football		(:10) 49ers The Gold Standard		(:20) 49ers	
Animal Planet	Louisiana Lockdown		Louisiana Lockdown		Louisiana Lockdown		Louisiana Lockdown		Lockdown	
BET	Celebrity Family Feud		Celebrity Family Feud		As. Living Ms. Pat		ComicView Ms. Pat		Martin	
Bravo	The Real Housewives of New York City		The Real Housewives of New York City			The Real Housewives of New York City		Next Gen NYC		
Cartoon Network	Burgers	Burgers	Burgers	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Family Guy	Rick Morty	
CNN	E. B. OutFront (Live)		Cooper 360 (Live)		The Source (Live)		CNN News. (Live)		Laura	
Comedy Central	Family Guy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	FamilyGuy	(:20) Family Guy		FamilyGuy	Family Guy	DailyShow	
Discovery	Filthy Fortunes		Filthy Fortunes		Filthy Fortunes		Filthy Fortunes		Filthy	
Disney	Big City	Big City	Phineas	Phineas	Vampirina	Phineas	Phineas	Kiff	Ladybug	
E!	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	How I Met	Cocktail	How I Met	How I Met	
ESPN	SEC Now		14 Days in Gainesville			SEC Inside		SportsCenter (Live)		SportCtr (Live)
ESPN2	NFL Live		NFL Players & Dogs: Life Off the Field			Best in Dog Sports		Football	E60 The Many Lives of Lane Kiffin	
Food Network	BeatBobby	BeatBobby	Bobby's Triple Threat			Bobby Play's the Line		Bobby's Triple Threat		Bobby's
Fox News	Ingraham (Live)		Jesse Watters (Live)			Hannity (Live)		Gutfeld!		Fox News
Freeform	(:5:25) Movie: National Treasure ★★ (2004)		Treasure		(:25) Movie: National Treasure: Book of Secrets ★★ (2007)				The 700 Club	
FX	(:5:30) Movie: Black Panther: Wakanda Forever ★★★ (2022)				The Drop: A Snowfall Saga		Movie: Jurassic World ★★ (2015)			
Hallmark	(:6:00) Movie: Sweetest Heart (2018)		Movie: 3 Bed, 2 Bath, 1 Ghost (2023)				Golden Girls	Golden Girls	Golden Girls	
Hallmark M&M	(:6:00) Garage Sale Mysteries		Garage Sale Mysteries				Murder, She Wrote		Murder ...	
HBO	(:2:0) Movie: Fuze ★★ (2025) Thieves plan a bank heist during an evacuation in London.				Lanterns		Conan O'Brien		(:45) Movie: Zombieland (2009)	
HGTV	Hunters	Hunters	A Very Haunted Renovation (P)			House	House	House	House	
History	Proof-There		Proof-There		Proof-There		(:05) Proof-There		(:05) Proof	
Lifetime	Dance Moms: A New Era		Dance Moms: A New Era		Dance Moms: A New Era		(:05) Dance Moms: A New Era		(:05) New Era	
MASN	MLB Baseball		Baltimore Orioles at New York Mets (Live)				O's Xtra		Sportico	Touchdown
Monumental	Caps	Hometown	Beyond the The Stanley Pup				Drive to	Drive to	Caps	
MSNBC	The Weeknight (Live)		All in With Chr. (Live)		The Briefing (Live)		Last Word (Live)		The 11th	
MTV	Caught in Act		Caught in Act			Best of VMAs		Caught in Act		Unfaithful
Nat'l Geographic	Genghis Khan		Genghis Khan			Genghis Khan		Genghis Khan		Genghis
Nickelodeon	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Friends	Big Bang	BigBang	BigBang	
NWSN	Vargas Report		Cuomo		On Balance		Katie Pavlich		JesseWeb	
Paramount	(:6:00) Movie: Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows: Part 1 ★★★ (2010)				Movie: Harry Potter and the Deathly Hallows: Part 2 ★★★ (2011)					
Paramount+Sho	(:6:00) Movie: Gone Baby Gone (2007)		Movie: Kiss the Girls ★★ (1997) An escaped victim and a forensic expert trail a killer.			Movie: Along Came a Spider ★★ (2001)				
Syfy	(:6:00) Movie: Kick-Ass ★★★ (2010)		Movie: The Mask ★★★ (1994) An ancient mask animates a drab bank clerk.					Movie: Snakes ...		
TBS	Leadoff MLB Baseball	Atlanta Braves at Chicago Cubs (Live)					MLBClose		Office	
TCM	(:6:30) Movie: The Gay Desperado (1936)		Movie: Against All Flags ★★ (1952)			Movie: The Crimson Pirate ★★★ (1952)				
TLC	1000-lb Sisters		1000-lb Sisters		1000-lb Sisters		1000-lb Roomies		90 Day	
TNT	(:5:45) Movie: Ocean's Eleven ★★★ (2001)		(:15) Movie: The Equalizer ★★ (2014) A former commando champions the helpless.				High Value			
Travel	Portals to Hell		Portals to Hell		Portals to Hell		Portals to Hell		Portals	
TruTV	Leadoff MLB Baseball	Atlanta Braves at Chicago Cubs (Live)					MLBClose		SuperBo..	
TV Land	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	Raymond	(:20) Raymond		Raymond	Raymond	King	
TV One	Cosby/Sh..	Cosby/Sh..	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	Lv Single	
USA Network	Law & Order: SVU		Law & Order: SVU		Law & Order: SVU		Law & Order: SVU		Law-SVU	
VH1	Chris	Chris	Movie: 30 Minutes or Less ★★ (2011)			Movie: Panic Room ★★★ (2002)				
WNC8	Hope for Pain		Paid Prog. Fed Gov		7News.at..		WJLANe.. Recharge		National	
LEGEND: Bold indicates new or live programs ♦ High Definition										
Movie Ratings (from TMS) ★★★★ Excellent ★★★ Good ★★ Fair ★ Poor No stars: not rated										

BIRTHDAY | SEPTEMBER 15: You are loyal, affectionate and have technical expertise. You have determination and clarity of vision. This is a year of learning and reflection. Renew your spiritual or religious beliefs. Explore philosophies that give you better self-awareness and get you closer to the true meaning of your life.

Moon Alert: Avoid shopping or making important decisions after 11 p.m. today. The Moon is in Scorpio.

ARIES

(March 21-April 19)
Feelings of obsession might grip you today when dealing with shared property, banking issues or something to do with taxes or inheritances. Your strong opinions might make it difficult to cooperate with others or agree to anything. Be aware of this.

TAURUS

(April 20-May 20)
This is a playful time for you! It's also a productive time at work because you have clever ideas, not only about getting things done, but also about improving your own health. Today, however, strong feelings might arise in your dealings with partners, spouses and close friends. Look for the highest good.

GEMINI

(May 21-June 20)
Issues related to your job, your health or even a pet will be important to you today. Whatever it is, you're not in the mood to compromise. You have very specific ideas and wants. Your idealism is aroused, and very likely, co-workers will support you.

CANCER

(June 21-July 22)
This is a passionate day for you. Romance is both confusing and impossibly idealistic. Something important to you makes it hard for you to let go or be open to change. Certainly, romance will be compelling! These strong feelings also might apply to dealing with children.

LEO

(July 23-Aug. 22)
Issues related to family or something to do with your home or where you live might be intense today. You are a sign who has strong attachment to your home because your home is your castle. This could involve dealing with someone's values who differ from yours.

VIRGO

(Aug. 23-Sept. 22)
With the Sun in your sign right now you're empowered, which is fortunate, because today you are determined to achieve a particular aim. Quite likely, you'll be able to sweet-talk your way into anything. (You might be interested in an unusual health approach.)

LIBRA

(Sept. 23-Oct. 22)
You'll have no trouble expressing your views today with Mercury in your sign. You might be interested in buying something that you want very much. Or, conversely, it might be related to a way to earn money that strongly appeals to you. Get your facts.

SCORPIO

(Oct. 23-Nov. 21)
Today both the Moon and fair Venus are in your sign influenced by Pluto, which can give you intense feelings! You might even feel obsessed about something. Perhaps you want to trans-

form where you live or make things better in a more idealistic or dreamy way.

SAGITTARIUS

(Nov. 22-Dec. 21)
Very likely, your idealism is aroused today. Meanwhile, some of you might be almost paralyzed by a secret love affair. This is a strong time for you. You are admired. Rally your troops if you're having disputes about inheritances or shared property.

CAPRICORN

(Dec. 22-Jan. 19)
An exchange with a friend or a member of a group will be intense today because both parties seem to know what they want. (You definitely do.) Fortunately, you have the advantage now if you need to talk to bosses or authority figures. They will listen to you.

AQUARIUS

(Jan. 20-Feb. 18)
Tread carefully with authority figures today. Listen to what others say and don't be too quick to challenge them because you want to do things your way. Diplomacy is required. Fortunately, others will admire your work ethic right now because you're giving your job everything you've got.

PISCES

(Feb. 19-March 20)
Steer clear of controversial discussions today because ego battles will quickly arise simply because people are passionate and entrenched in their views. Therefore, table these discussions for another day. Enjoy playful, athletic outings.

— Georgia Nicos

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BRIDGE

N-S VULNERABLE

NORTH

♠ K 9 8 5 3 2
♥ A 7 3
♦ 6 5 2
♣ 9

WEST

♠ None
♥ Q J 10 9 4 2
♦ K 8 7 4
♣ K Q 6

EAST

♠ 6
♥ K 8 6
♦ J 10 9
♣ 8 7 5 4 3 2

SOUTH (D)

♠ A Q J 10 7 4
♥ 5
♦ A Q 3
♣ A J 10

The bidding:

SOUTH WEST NORTH EAST
1 ♠ 2 ♥ 4 ♠ Pass
6 ♠ All Pass
Opening lead — ♥ Q

Cy the Cynic observes that the wages of sin wouldn't be as desirable if they were paid immediately. At least that's the case in my club's daily penny games: You lose, you settle up when the game ends.

Cy was today's North, and when he jumped to four spades, South boldly bid six. West was Ed, my club's best player, and he led the queen of hearts. South took the ace, drew the missing trump with dummy's king and next led a diamond: Jack, queen, king. Ed returned a diamond, and East got a diamond trick at the end. Down one.

"You booted it," Cy growled at his partner. "Ruff a heart at Trick Two, lead a trump to dummy and ruff the last heart. Then lead a trump to dummy, return the nine of clubs and follow with your 10. When West wins, anything he returns gives you a 12th trick."

When the game ended, Ed was the big winner, as usual, and Cy had to pay off.

"The wages of sin probably go unreported," the Cynic grumbled. At least I reported this deal in my column.

DAILY QUESTION

You hold:
♠ K 9 8 5 3 2 ♥ A 7 3
♦ 6 5 2 ♣ 9

Your partner opens 1NT. The next player passes. What do you say?

ANSWER: I can't imagine how players handled this hand before the advent of "transfer" responses; presumably, they bid four spades (an overbid) or two spades (an underbid). Bid two hearts, a transfer. When partner bids two spades, raise to three, suggesting a six-card suit and seven or eight high-card points, and let him judge.

— Frank Stewart

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SUDOKU

Complete the grid so that every row, column and 3x3 box contains every digit from 1 to 9 inclusively.

				2	8		1	
7			1				5	
9		1		5	7	3		8
		4						5
5	2			7			3	4
8						2		
1		8	7	4		9		3
	9			5				2
4			9	8				

DIFFICULTY RATING: ★★☆☆☆

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PREVIOUS SUDOKU SOLUTION

2	5	4	8	7	3	6	1	9
3	6	9	1	4	2	8	5	7
1	7	8	5	9	6	2	3	4
6	4	5	2	1	8	9	7	3
7	2	3	4	6	9	1	8	5
8	9	1	7	3	5	4	2	6
9	8	2	3	5	4	7	6	1
4	3	7	6	2	1	5	9	8
5	1	6	9	8	7	3	4	2



MATT ROURKE/AP

The Commanders hassled Eagles quarterback Jalen Hurts into completing just 56 percent of his passes, but they couldn't keep him from making some clutch plays.

Big plays, big problem

BY TASHAN REED

PHILADELPHIA — When a defense holds an offense to 10 first downs, it's usually a great day at the office. And, for the Washington Commanders' unit, there were plenty of positive takeaways despite their 24-22 loss to the Philadelphia Eagles on Sunday.

The defense limited running back Saquon Barkley to 83 rushing yards, his lowest output against the Commanders since he was with the New York Giants in 2022. Quarterback Jalen Hurts completed just 56 percent of his passes. Wide receiver DeVonta Smith had just three catches for 53 yards. The Eagles were forced to punt seven times.

What held Washington's defense back? It gave up too many explosive plays. Philadelphia had six plays that went for 17 yards

Explosive gains helped undo largely positive first game for Commanders' defense

or more. Five of those came on third down. Asked to identify the defense's next step, Commanders Coach Dan Quinn responded: "Getting those big plays off the tape."

"Those are the ones that can change field position and make such a big difference," he added. "If we can eliminate those, I like our speed, I like our hitting, I like our physicality, I like [how we] get in and out of pressures. But let's get these explosive plays — as best we can — off [the tape]. We had too many of them tonight."

The causes of the breakdowns ranged from failing to contain the quarterback in the pocket to missing tackles to losing track of the ball in coverage, but they kept cropping up. It turned a potential statement game for the defense into a lesson.

"The game was there," safety Jeremy Reaves said. "That's always the tough part ... Those few plays can dictate the outcome of a game."

Defensive coordinator Daronte Jones displayed much of what was expected in his play-calling debut. The defense was aggressive, used both 3-4 and 4-3 fronts, made frequent substitutions, blitzed often and mixed up its coverages.

For long stretches, Jones's calls were executed at a high level and gave the Eagles fits. After scoring its second touchdown late in the second quarter,

SEE COMMANDERS ON B9

Week 2: Commanders at Cowboys Sunday, 4:25 p.m., Fox | Ravens weigh WR options Injuries to Flowers, Lane could spur a signing B9

Offense was taken — repeatedly — during Week 1

On the NFL

ROB MAADDI

Offenses didn't need any time to shake off the rust.

They lit up the scoreboard in one of the highest-scoring opening weeks in NFL history.

The Chicago Bears beat the Carolina Panthers, 59-37, falling three points shy of tying the Atlanta Falcons' 53-year-old record for the most in Week 1. The game featured 1,030 total yards and the most combined points (96) ever in an opener.

Josh Allen led the Buffalo Bills to a stunning performance against the Houston Texans' once-stingy defense in a 36-31 road win. Houston allowed the second-fewest points (17.4 per game) and fewest yards (277.2 per game) in 2025. But Allen threw for 334 yards, and Buffalo scored on seven of its 11 possessions before kneeling down to win Coach Joe Brady's first game.

Ten teams scored more than 30 points, and six had at least 24 in the first half.

Maybe starters don't need to play in the preseason. Quarterbacks were in midseason form as 13 posted a passer rating over 100.

All those joint practices must have benefited offenses more than defenses.

One of Chicago's team goals set by Coach Ben Johnson is to break the record for most points in a season. Johnson believes the Bears still have room to improve despite scoring touchdowns on



ERIK VERDUZCO/AP

Quarterback Caleb Williams and the Bears outgunned the Panthers, 59-37. The teams combined for 1,030 yards and the most points in an opener in NFL history.

their last four drives.

"There's still a number of things on there that I didn't love just from the sideline perspective," Johnson said.

Entering the Denver Broncos-Kansas City Chiefs game on Monday night, teams had combined to score 750 points. The record in Week 1 is 791 in 2012.

Here are nine takeaways from Sunday:

Caleb in control

Caleb Williams kicked off his second season in Johnson's offense playing like an MVP candidate. He made precision throws, big plays with his legs and was in

SEE ON THE NFL ON B9

Fight for spots in playoffs deepens

The Rays and Brewers are already in the field. Who else will join them?

BY NOAH TRISTER
Associated Press

Clinching season has begun, with the Tampa Bay Rays and Milwaukee Brewers becoming the first teams to wrap up spots in the postseason.

THIS WEEK IN BASEBALL Here's a quick run-down of the remaining unresolved races:

In the American League

The New York Yankees and Boston Red Sox are almost certain to join the Tampa Bay Rays in the playoffs out of the American League East. The Rays have a four-game lead in the division over the Yankees as of Sunday's games, and they're likely to have the tiebreaker over New York, but that race isn't completely over since the two teams face each other in a four-game series in the final week of the regular season.

The Red Sox can plan on being the second wild card.

That leaves three spots up for grabs: the AL Central title, the AL West title and the third wild card. The Chicago White Sox lead the Cleveland Guardians by a half-game for the AL Central, with the Guardians holding a one-game lead over the Toronto Blue Jays for the final wild card. The Houston Astros lead the Texas Rangers by one game for the AL West, and the Rangers are also two behind the Guardians for the last wild card. Everyone else is at least four behind Cleveland.

Head-to-head: Chicago at Cleveland (Sept. 14-16), Toronto at Texas (Sept. 18-20).

Other key tiebreakers that have been determined: White Sox over Blue Jays and Rangers; Astros over White Sox, Guardians

SEE BASEBALL ON B11

PERSPECTIVE

MLB, union shouldn't balk on '28 Games deal

BY BILL SHAIKIN
Los Angeles Times

LOS ANGELES — It takes Bryce Harper about four seconds to run from home plate to first base. It took him about the same amount of time to demolish the proposal the commissioner's office made to the players' union in an effort to ensure that players participate in the Los Angeles Olympics: If you're picked and you don't play, you have to sit out two weeks when the season resumes after the Games.

"Obviously, you're not going to suspend Bobby Witt Jr. from the Royals for two weeks," Harper told me. "They're not going to be able to win games without Bobby Witt. I don't know if ownership would be on board with that."

For three years, we have been talking about whether major leaguers would play in the Olympics. We're now less than two years from the Games, and for all the platitudes from MLB and the players' union about growing the game internationally, each side is still bickering about whether the other side truly wants to take advantage of an event that the entire world will be watching.

"There's no greater stage than the Olympics," Harper said.

MLB says play ball, but not without the authority to punish players that do not wish to play.

The union says play ball, but

SEE SHAIKIN ON B11

THE DAY IN SPORTS

PRO BASKETBALL

Delayed Leonard trade finally moves forward

The trade sending **Kawhi Leonard** back north of the border is finally complete, with the Toronto Raptors and Los Angeles Clippers getting NBA approval Monday to close the deal that was agreed to earlier this summer.

In the end, the terms were the same as 2½ months ago: Leonard returns to the Raptors, with the Clippers getting Brandon Ingram, Gradey Dick, two first-round draft picks, two second-round picks and a pick swap.

“We’re thrilled to welcome Kawhi back to Toronto,” said **Bobby Webster**, the Raptors’ general manager and executive vice president. “His impact on our organization, our city, and our country is undeniable, and he embodies the competitiveness and championship mindset that we value. We believe his leadership, experience and talent will help us as we continue building toward our next championship.”

It’s a huge move for Toronto, which won the 2019 NBA title with Leonard leading the way and is expecting to contend in the Eastern Conference. But the sides put the agreement on hold in early July pending any resolution of NBA’s investigation into whether the Clippers circumvented salary cap rules with regard to Leonard’s compensation.

The NBA hit the Clippers earlier this month with massive penalties as a result of that probe, suspending owner **Steve Ballmer** for one year, fining the team \$30 million and forcing it to forfeit five first-round draft picks, among other sanctions.

Leonard, a two-time NBA Finals MVP, was hit with a \$700,000 penalty as a result of that investigation. But he was not suspended and his contract was not voided, and the Raptors evidently are now certain that his status will not be affected. ...

Taj Gibson joined **Tiago Splitter**’s first coaching staff with the Chicago Bulls after playing for eight teams in 17 NBA seasons.

Gibson, 41, announced the end of his playing career. The 6-foot-9 forward averaged 8.3 points and 5.7 rebounds in 1,012 games for the Bulls, Oklahoma City Thunder, Minnesota Timberwolves, New York Knicks, Detroit Pistons, Charlotte Hornets and Memphis Grizzlies.

COLLEGES

Ex-JMU QB Barnett goes on shelf for UCF

Central Florida starting quarterback **Alonza Barnett III** is expected to miss this week’s game — and probably more time — with what Coach **Scott Frost** described as a “fairly significant hamstring injury.”

Barnett left Saturday’s game at Pittsburgh on the penultimate offensive snap with the Golden Knights trailing 12-7. He was chased out of the pocket and was slow to get up after slipping and getting tackled from behind in rainy conditions. **Keyone Jenkins** came in for the final play and was sacked on fourth down to seal the loss.

Barnett threw for 186 yards and a touchdown against the Panthers. He was a celebrated transfer acquisition after leading James Madison to the College Football Playoff last year.

Frost said the severity of the injury will not be known until Barnett gets further imaging this week. Barnett is likely to miss several weeks, including this Saturday’s home game against Georgia State and the Big 12 opener Sept. 26 against TCU. ...

Tennessee Coach **Josh Heupel** said senior tight end **Ethan Davis** will miss the rest of the season with an ACL injury for the No. 15 Volunteers.

The 6-foot-5, 247-pound tight end has played 26 games with 39 career receptions for 433 yards and six touchdowns. ...

Washington Coach **Jedd Fisch** said wide receiver **Christian Moss** will be out for two to three months, as will running backs **Quaid Carr** and **Jayden Limar**, after all three were injured during the season opener against Washington State on Sept. 6.

Fisch added that another starting wideout, **Rashid Williams**, and starting cornerback **Emmanuel Karnley** came out of Saturday’s game against Utah State with soft tissue injuries and are week to week. ...

Louisville men’s basketball coach **Pat Kelsey** added another fifth-year player to the roster, with forward **LJ Wells** now available this season for the Cardinals.

Kelsey said he is friends with Northern Kentucky Coach



JAMIE SQUIRE/GETTY IMAGES

Red-letter day

Exactly nine months after tearing his ACL and LCL, two-time MVP quarterback Patrick Mahomes made his return for the Chiefs on “Monday Night Football.” Kansas City’s game against Denver in Missouri ran late. For coverage, visit *postsports.com*.

SPOTLIGHT: COLLEGES

Florida State fires Alford as athletics director

BY BOB FERRANTE

TALLAHASSEE — Florida State fired athletics director Michael Alford on Monday morning, school president Richard McCullough said.

Alford had been the AD since January 2022 after he was hired in the fall of 2020 to be the president of Seminole Boosters, Inc.

“Michael Alford has served the University and our student-athletes with dedication, and we thank him for his contributions to our athletics programs,” McCullough said in a statement.

The dismissal was without cause, McCullough said. It’s not clear how much Alford is worth as Florida State on a four-year deal that was announced in August 2024.

McCullough, speaking later Monday, said the decision to fire Alford was necessary to compete in a college sports landscape that “is changing incredibly rapidly.”

“This is a first step in working toward doing everything that we can to build revenue and take a look at the kind of administration that we need moving forward,” McCullough said. “We’re going through a time where the investments that we’re making in college

football is rapidly increasing.

“People often say that we have a spending problem. But the spending problem is essentially a reality. The reality is that’s what it takes to be competitive at the highest level.”

McCullough appointed Bruce Warwick, the school’s senior associate AD, to serve as interim AD. There will be a national search for Alford’s replacement.

“It is important that we remain dedicated to providing continuity and support to our student-athletes, coaches and staff, who remain our top priority,” Warwick said in a statement.

Alford posted a statement on X saying he was proud of what he achieved at Florida State.

“We have won championships, developed outstanding young men and women and watched them earn their college degrees, built or enhanced facilities and always acted in the best interests of our student-athletes and our institution,” Alford wrote. “I believe there is a strong foundation in place for FSU Athletics and I am confident that the momentum will continue.”

The decision comes as football coach Mike Norvell is on the hot seat after two losing seasons and a lackluster 1-1 start.

The Seminoles are 20.5-point underdogs at No. 10 Alabama on Saturday. If Norvell is replaced in the coming weeks or months, the hire will be made by a new AD, as well as McCullough and Board of Trustees Chairman Peter Collins.

In his time at Florida State, Alford made significant coaching hires — Luke Loucks for men’s basketball, Link Jarrett for baseball, Brian Pensky for women’s soccer, Brooke Wyckoff for women’s basketball and Sara Tisdale for women’s lacrosse, a program that the school launched in spring 2025.

The Seminoles also won a pair of soccer titles under Pensky’s leadership, including last year.

Alford’s era at Florida State brought massive facility projects for football, at a price tag of more than \$400 million. Construction crews transformed the west side of Doak Campbell Stadium, and the football-only facility that broke ground in December 2022 opened in October 2025.

But Alford’s decision to take on debt, do a football re-seat of Doak and drive ticket prices higher in sections of the stadium drew the ire of thousands of longtime Florida State fans.

— Associated Press

TELEVISION AND RADIO

MLB

6:45 p.m. **Philadelphia at Washington** » Nationals.TV, WJFK (106.7 FM)
7:10 p.m. **Baltimore at New York** » MASN, WYYY (97.9 FM)
7:30 p.m. **Atlanta at Chicago Cubs** » TBS
9:30 p.m. **Miami at Arizona** » MLB Network

SOCCER

3:15 p.m. **Spanish La Liga: Real Madrid at Elche** » ESPN2
6 p.m. **Copa Sudamericana quarterfinal, second leg: Santa Fe at Vasco da Gama** » BeIN Sports
7 p.m. **Canadian Championship semifinal, second leg: Supra du Québec at Forge** » Fox Sports 2
8:30 p.m. **Copa Sudamericana quarterfinal, second leg: Boca Juniors at São Paulo** » BeIN Sports

TENNIS

Noon **WTA: Guadalajara Open and São Paulo Open, early rounds** » Tennis Channel

COLLEGE GOLF

4 p.m. **Jackson T. Stephens Cup, second round** » Golf Channel

MEN’S COLLEGE SOCCER

7 p.m. **Northwestern at Michigan State** » Big Ten Network

WOMEN’S COLLEGE VOLLEYBALL

7 p.m. **Villanova at Penn State** » Fox Sports 1

SOCCER

Leeds drubs Newcastle, moves into third in EPL

Three goals in a 13-minute spell before half time — two featuring the commanding **Dominic Calvert-Lewin** — set Leeds on the way to a comprehensive 4-1 home win over Newcastle to move into third place in the English Premier League.

Ao Tanaka’s deflected shot put Leeds ahead after 32 minutes, and then Man of the Match Calvert-Lewin moved into top gear.

Calvert-Lewin was unlucky to see a 34th-minute header marked down as an own goal after brushing the head of teammate **Jayden Bogle** on the way in. But there was no mistaking his authorship of the third, which squirmed under the keeper after he poked it goalward under pressure from defenders. ...

Betis’s fairy-tale start to the Spanish league season continued with a 2-1 victory at Villarreal, moving the club into a tie for second with Real Madrid. ...

In Italy, Roma continued its superb start to the season with a 2-0 win over Torino. It was joined at the top of the table by the only other team with maximum points, Inter Milan, which came from behind to crush Udinese, 5-3. ...

The Orlando Pride signed star striker **Barbra Banda** to a new “landmark agreement” through the 2029 season, the NWSL club said.

Banda, 26, has scored a franchise-record 16 goals through 20 matches this season. She has tallied 41 goals and 11 assists in 62 appearances across all league competitions since joining the Pride in 2024. ...

Valencia restructured its soccer operations after a fourth loss in five matches to start the Spanish season this weekend.

The club announced the firing of coach **Carlos Corberán** and soccer CEO **Ron Gourlay**. It appointed **Braulio Vázquez** as its new sporting director and said B-team coach **Óscar Sánchez** would take over as interim manager. ...

Paris Saint-Germain gave reassuring news about **Achraf Hakimi**’s fitness ahead of Sunday’s match against rival Marseille in the French league.

The Morocco right-back limped off the field late in the first half of PSG’s 1-0 win at Brest over the weekend. But the club said in a statement that he suffered only “a minor right thigh strain.” ...

Former Czechoslovakia, Czech Republic and West Ham goalkeeper **Ludek Miklosko** died at 64. ...

Marcelo Gallardo, one of the most decorated coaches in the history of the Argentine league, reached an agreement to manage the Ecuador national team ahead of the 2030 World Cup.

TENNIS

Shelton keeps on going after loss at U.S. Open

Ben Shelton isn’t taking much time off after his run to the U.S. Open final.

Shelton was confirmed for the U.S. Davis Cup team that will play the Czech Republic in Prague this week. Then he will join Team World for the Laver Cup in London the following weekend.

Shelton lost to **Alexander Zverev** in his first Grand Slam final Sunday. He moved up to a career-high No. 4 in the rankings.

Also named to the U.S. team for the second round of qualifying against the Czechs were **Learner Tien**, **Martin Damm**, **Christian Harrison** and **Austin Krajicek**. **Taylor Fritz** and **Tommy Paul** withdrew from the team. ...

With the 39-year-old **Novak Djokovic** — the last member of the Big Three still competing — dropping from No. 5 to No. 12 in the latest men’s rankings, it’s the first time since October 2002 that neither he, **Roger Federer** nor **Rafael Nadal** appear in the top 10.

The 39-year-old Djokovic was beaten in the first round of the U.S. Open by **Mariano Navone**. It was Djokovic’s earliest Grand Slam exit in two decades. ...

Top tennis players who have been protesting for a larger share of revenue from the biggest tournaments in the sport say they will no longer go public with their demands now that a Grand Slam Player Advisory Council has been formed.

“The players will now work directly with the Grand Slams to establish the council, through which players themselves will be directly consulted and able to negotiate on an ongoing basis,” a statement from the players’ representatives said.

— From news services

PROFESSIONAL FOOTBALL

PERSPECTIVE

For the Cowboys’ defense, it’s déjà vu all over again

Revamped unit has scores of issues to fix before facing Washington

BY CALVIN WATKINS

EAST RUTHERFORD, N.J. — Change the players. Change the scheme. Same result.

That’s the best way to describe the new-look Dallas Cowboys defense after a 28-20 season-opening loss to the New York Giants on Sunday night at MetLife Stadium.

“This is a humbling business, and we got humbled tonight, and that’s what I told the guys,” Coach Brian Schottenheimer said. “And we lost Mile 1 of a 17-mile marathon, and we have to be better. We will be better.”

First-year defensive coordinator Christian Parker was prepared but didn’t get the desired result. Some new faces had minimal impact and made key mistakes, while some old faces committed costly penalties.

In the fourth quarter, the New York offense ran eight consecutive plays to the left side — with six swing passes — to go ahead by two scores.

And after the Cowboys’ offense cut the deficit to eight, the defense failed to get the ball back. First, they gave up a 12-yard pass on a third and nine.

Then, on a second and 16, running back Cam Skattebo picked up 13 yards. Faced with a third and three, tight end Isaiah Likely — who played like Odell Beckham Jr. with a game-high eight catches for 78 yards and two scores — schooled rookie safety Caleb Downs for a three-yard reception.

Likely lined up next to Malik Nabers (six catches for 69 yards) and started his route to the inside but moved back toward the middle of the field. That gave him the needed space to catch the ball.

That reception wasn’t the game, just the clincher. There were many other problems with the Cowboys’ defense.

The lack of a consistent pass rush was evident, as Giants quarterback Jaxson Dart completed 23 of 29 passes for 230 yards with



Linebacker Jaishawn Barham, left, was one of several Cowboys who were called for critical penalties.

three touchdowns. He was sacked twice and hit six times, but too often he had plenty of time to get the ball downfield.

Getting off the field was especially difficult for Dallas. New York converted nine of 11 third downs, went 4 for 4 in the red zone and scored on four of seven possessions, including three drives in a row at one point.

Everything that was hyped about the Cowboys’ defense — racking up sacks (two), forcing turnovers (one) and creating havoc (not much) — didn’t come to fruition.

“I think we got a lot of third downs today and we didn’t get off the field, a bunch of them,” said defensive tackle Quinnen Williams, who forced a fumble. “We got to be critical with our approach this week, and it’s a great week to learn and get things better. The guys we got in our locker room, especially on defense, the guys we got in our locker room is unbelievable when it comes down to taking

constructive criticism and taking accountability.”

One of the more critical moments of the game came on the next-to-last drive for the Giants. The 13-play, 70-yard drive ended with a pass toward the left side of the field, a Dart nine-yard touchdown pass to running back Devin Singletary.

The Giants directed plays to the left side of the field, the flat, with impunity.

The adjustments just weren’t made, whether it was by Parker with personnel or play calls or by the players on the field.

“Yeah, it was a lot of bad eyes,” Schottenheimer said. “When you’re playing some of those match coverage zones, you got to see who number three is. And again, I think it’s really something that we could have gotten corrected better. ... That’s our job as coaches to put those guys in better position. And it goes with us and the coaches and players.”

Schottenheimer isn’t one to make excuses, and he didn’t with

some of his players who committed mistakes in critical moments.

Rookie linebacker Jaishawn Barham had a neutral zone infraction on a third and one. Veteran middle linebacker DeMarvion Overshown hit Dart out of bounds following a first-down run for a 15-yard unnecessary roughness penalty. Williams, a veteran, was flagged for offside on a second and one.

Dart, who ran for 49 yards, drew a face mask penalty on Donovan Ezeiruaku.

“I mean, penalties kill your ability to win, especially the self-inflicted wounds,” Schottenheimer said. “We jumped offside a couple times in short-yardage situations, which we gave them free downs, if you will. That led to sustained drives. It led to them, again, controlling the football, but it comes down to discipline and we’re more disciplined than the way we played tonight. And again, we did not play well enough.”

— Dallas Morning News

NOTES

Ravens may look to add wideouts after injuries

REUTERS

Coach Jesse Minter said Monday that the Baltimore Ravens could add another pass catcher after Zay Flowers and rookie Ja’Kobi Lane were injured in Sunday’s 41-23 victory over the Indianapolis Colts.

Flowers aggravated a hamstring issue in the first half when he caught five passes for a career-high 150 yards and a touchdown. Minter said the Ravens’ No. 1 wide receiver is day-to-day.

Lane’s absence is expected to be longer. The rookie sustained a wrist injury — which NFL Network reported was a fracture — and is expected to be sidelined for several weeks.

Baltimore finished the Indianapolis game with Rashod Bateman, Chris Moore and LaJohntay Wester as its available wideouts.

The Ravens do have reinforcements on the roster. Devontez Walker was inactive because of a groin injury, while rookie Elijah Saratt was a healthy scratch.

“I think there’s potential for [an outside acquisition],” Minter said, “but again, Tez Walker and Saratt, I have a lot of confidence in those guys. Those guys have a ton of reps within our offense.”

•**RAMS:** Coach Sean McVay would not put a timeline on when outside linebacker Myles Garrett could return to action after knee surgery.

Following an underwhelming Los Angeles debut Thursday, Garrett was placed on IR on Sunday and will miss a minimum of four games.

•**SEAHAWKS:** Sam Darnold has a “very unique, soft tissue injury,” and his hip joint is “unaffected,” a Seattle spokesperson told media outlets.

The Super Bowl-winning quarterback has “no firm timeline” to return to action, but the spokesperson said it was considered a short-term injury.

•**VIKINGS:** Carson Wentz is expected to start Sunday against the Chicago Bears after guiding Minnesota to a comeback win over the Green Bay Packers.

Starter Tyler Murray left the game early in the first quarter. He was hit in the head on a scramble and stayed down for a few minutes

before walking off the field under his own power.

•**BROWNS:** Coach Todd Minter said he anticipates keeping Deshaun Watson as Cleveland’s starting quarterback for Sunday’s game at the Tampa Bay Buccaneers despite his subpar return to action.

Watson, who had been sidelined since October 2024 because of a pair of Achilles tears, completed 16 of 22 passes for 205 yards with a touchdown and an interception in the Browns’ loss at the Jacksonville Jaguars on Sunday.

•**LIONS:** Isiah Pacheco’s Detroit debut was delayed further — perhaps until December — after the running back underwent back surgery.

Coach Dan Campbell said Pacheco had the procedure and will be out for “a significant amount of time.” NFL Network reported he will need 12 weeks to recover from a procedure to remove a loose body that was pressing on a nerve.

•**EAGLES:** Philadelphia is placing three-time Pro Bowl guard Landon Dickerson on injured reserve after he struggled through a knee injury Sunday against the Washington Commanders, according to multiple reports.

•**FALCONS:** Defensive lineman DaShawn Hand is set to undergo surgery for a torn quad muscle and is out for the season, Atlanta Coach Kevin Stefanski said.

•**COWBOYS:** Safety Malik Hooker was diagnosed with a forearm fracture and is scheduled to meet with a specialist to determine a recovery timeline, ESPN reported.

•**TEXANS:** Linebacker Henry To’oTo’o is expected to miss an undetermined amount of time with a left shoulder injury, Houston Coach DeMeco Ryans told reporters.

•**CHARGERS:** Wide receiver Ladd McConkey underwent testing to determine the extent of the rib injury he sustained in Los Angeles’ loss to the Arizona Cardinals on Sunday, according to a report by NFL Network.

•**PATRIOTS:** Running back TreVeyon Henderson returned to practice for New England as he eyes a season debut Sunday against the Pittsburgh Steelers.

ON THE NFL

A running (and passing) start for the O

ON THE NFL FROM B7

command of Chicago’s offense from start to finish.

Ravens are dominant

Lamar Jackson, Derrick Henry and the Baltimore Ravens were impressive in a 41-23 victory at the Indianapolis Colts, giving Coach Jesse Minter his first win. Baltimore has high expectations, and the team’s core players were spectacular.

Jackson, who dealt with injuries last season, played like a two-time MVP. The 32-year-old Henry ran like he’s 22. Zay Flowers had a career day.

The Colts have now lost eight straight games after starting 8-2 last year. Quarterback Daniel Jones was ineffective in his first game back from a torn Achilles, and the defense was poor.

Big debut for Giants

John Harbaugh had a better day than brother Jim. Jaxson Dart, Cam Skattebo and the New York Giants defeated the Dallas Cowboys, 28-20, in their first game with their new coach.

The Giants played like Harbaugh’s old Ravens teams. They controlled the ball for almost 37 minutes and kept Dak Prescott and the Cowboys’ playmakers off the field.

McDaniel’s offense fizzled

Justin Herbert and the Los Angeles Chargers had an inconsistent start in Mike McDaniel’s first game as offensive coordinator, and the Arizona Cardinals pulled off the biggest upset of the week with a 26-14 road win.

Rookie coach Mike LaFleur had an excellent game plan, and quarterback Jacoby Brissett executed it well to lead Arizona, which was a 9.5-point underdog.

Pack winless without Micah

The Green Bay Packers knocked Tyler Murray out of the game and had a 12-point lead in the second half, only to see Carson Wentz rally the Minnesota Vikings to a 39-22



Josh Allen and the Bills scored on seven of their first 11 possessions against a Texans defense that was among the NFL’s best last year.

victory. Green Bay fell to 0-6 without all-pro pass rusher Micah Parsons, who is still recovering from ACL surgery. Jordan Love and the offense can’t afford to continue having so many miscues.

Bengals torment Mayfield

The Cincinnati Bengals bolstered a defense that desperately needed a makeover, and it paid off early. Dexter Lawrence, Jonathan Allen and other new starters harassed Baker Mayfield throughout the game in a 33-27 victory over the Tampa Bay Buccaneers. Mayfield lost three fumbles in his first game since signing a new contract. Joe Burrow didn’t have to be prolific thanks to Tampa Bay’s four turnovers.

Shough matures on the spot

The New Orleans Saints’ comeback bid against the Detroit Lions fell short in overtime when Coach Kellen Moore went for the victory and the three-point conversion was stopped. But

Shough’s performance is reason for optimism. He overcame a poor start, showed poise and maturity and had a strong finish to help New Orleans rally from a 21-0 deficit.

Same old Watson

Deshaun Watson’s stat line doesn’t tell the true story. The Cleveland Browns were overmatched and overwhelmed by the Jacksonville Jaguars, 34-10. It’s hard to imagine Watson will start their home opener in Week 3.

Last ride needs help

Aaron Rodgers began his last season in the NFL with a win in his reunion with Coach Mike McCarthy. The Pittsburgh Steelers beat the injury-depleted Atlanta Falcons and third-string quarterback Cooper Rush, 20-13. Rodgers is clearly comfortable in McCarthy’s offense, and the 42-year-old still is an elite passer. But DK Metcalf struggled, and the run game was lackluster.

— Associated Press

Chunk plays bedevil the Commanders

COMMANDERS FROM B7

Philadelphia was held to one first down across the next four drives.

“The energy,” Reaves said when asked what stood out when the defense was playing well. “We were getting off the field. We just got to keep it going. When we got the momentum like that on defense, stopping ’em, getting three-and-outs, they have no real answer.”

The pass rush was the most impressive element of the defense. The Commanders sacked Hurts three times, registered five quarterback hits and pressured him constantly.

But even the defensive front had costly errors. Trailing 17-16 in the fourth quarter, Washington had an opportunity to get a stop and give its offense a chance to take the lead. After a tackle for loss and a false start, the Eagles faced third and 18.

The coverage held up on the ensuing drop back, but defensive tackles Daron Payne and Charles Omenihu got knocked to the ground. That opened a gaping hole in the middle of the defense, and Hurts took advantage with a 22-yard scramble for a first down.

“We caused havoc. We caused some movement up front,” outside linebacker K’Lavon Chaisson said. “A couple times, we let him get loose and scramble out of the pocket. We’ve just got to bring him down.”

Following a questionable no-call on what appeared to be another false start, Hurts converted another third down on a pass to tight end Dallas Goedert, who beat linebacker Sonny Styles in coverage before making safeties Nick Cross and Reaves miss. He then outran cornerback Rasul Douglas to the end zone for what ended up the game-winning touchdown.

The Commanders are confident they can avoid replicating those miscues.

“We’re there, man,” Douglas said. “There’s plays that I done seen teams turn on each other, and that wasn’t the case here. Everybody stayed down, and we talked it out and made sure we had everything right.”



Eagles tight end Dallas Goedert beat Commanders linebacker Sonny Styles on his way to a game-winning touchdown Sunday.

The Commanders felt the loss was more about fixable mistakes that led to big plays than the Eagles outperforming them — fortifying their belief that the defense will improve.

“Everything they got, we gave it to ’em. It wasn’t nothing spectacular that they did,” cornerback Amik Robertson said. “I feel like we played together tonight, but we just didn’t capitalize 60 minutes straight. We definitely have a special group ... We just got to finish.”

News and notes

Linebackers Frankie Luvu (groin) and Jordan Magee (hamstring), safety Tyler Owens (ankle) and tight end Chig Okonkwo (hamstring) were injured against the Eagles. Quinn didn’t have any updates after the game ...

The Commanders’ healthy inactives were quarterback Athan Kaliakmanis, wide receivers Luke McCaffrey and Treylon Burks, guard Tanoa Togiai and defensive

tackle Ricky Barber.

McCaffrey and Burks were surprises. Throughout camp, McCaffrey worked heavily with the first-team offense at slot receiver and was also the primary kick returner.

With the former third-round pick sidelined as a healthy scratch, Jaylin Lane was the primary kick and punt returner.

Burks also got a lot of work with the starters, primarily as an outside receiver. He and McCaffrey are the only wide receivers on the roster taller than 6 feet, so the coaching staff sacrificed size in favor of the interchangeability provided by Terry McLaurin, Stefon Diggs, Antonio Williams and Dyami Brown ...

Drew Stevens was 1 for 2 on field goal attempts and 1 for 2 on extra points. He made a 55-yarder in the first quarter but missed from 54 in the third. Tyler Ott’s snap was high on the missed extra point, so he shoulders more responsibility.

BASEBALL

National League

EAST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
Atlanta	88	63	.583	—	4-6 L-2
Philadelphia	83	67	.553	4½	4-6 W-1
x-Miami	74	76	.493	13½	3-7 W-2
Washington	70	81	.464	18	3-7 W-3
New York	69	81	.460	18½	6-4 L-2

CENTRAL	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
z-Milwaukee	93	57	.620	—	6-4 L-1
Chicago	84	67	.556	9½	5-5 W-1
Pittsburgh	75	75	.500	18	7-3 W-1
St. Louis	75	76	.497	18½	5-5 W-2
Cincinnati	70	80	.467	23	3-7 L-1

WEST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
z-Los Angeles	91	59	.607	—	8-2 W-1
x-San Diego	81	68	.544	9½	8-2 W-7
x-Arizona	79	71	.527	12	6-4 L-2
San Francisco	62	89	.411	29½	4-6 L-4
x-Colorado	55	94	.369	35½	2-8 L-7

x-Late game; z-Clinched playoff berth

American League

EAST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
z-Tampa Bay	90	59	.604	—	7-3 W-3
z-New York	87	63	.580	3½	7-3 W-2
Boston	82	68	.547	8½	7-3 W-2
Toronto	75	76	.497	16	5-5 L-1
Baltimore	73	78	.483	18	4-6 W-1

CENTRAL	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
Chicago	77	73	.513	—	4-6 W-1
Cleveland	76	75	.503	1½	5-5 L-1
Detroit	71	79	.473	6	7-3 W-5
Minnesota	70	80	.467	7	3-7 L-2
Kansas City	66	84	.440	11	4-6 L-2

WEST	W	L	PCT	GB	L10 STR
Houston	75	75	.500	—	4-6 L-3
Texas	74	76	.493	1	5-5 W-2
x-Seattle	70	80	.467	5	4-6 L-1
Athletics	61	89	.407	14	7-3 W-1
x-Los Angeles	56	93	.376	18½	3-7 L-3

x-Late game; z-Clinched playoff berth

NOTES

PERSONNEL DEPT.

Blue Jays: Placed RF Rudy Martin Jr. on the 10-day injured list, retroactive to Sunday, with a left hamstring strain and recalled LF Davis Schneider and LHP Brendan Cellucci from Class AAA Buffalo.

Diamondbacks: Claimed RF Jesús Sánchez off waivers from Toronto.

Dodgers: Recalled RHP Paul Gervase from Class AAA Oklahoma City and optioned RHP Emmet Sheehan to Oklahoma City.

Orioles: Recalled RHP Codi Heuer from Class AAA Norfolk and optioned RHP Yamil Hiraldo to Norfolk.

Padres: Activated 1B Ty France from the paternity list.

Royals: Optioned RHP Easton McGee to Class AAA Omaha.

Tigers: Activated RHP Keider Montero from the paternity list and optioned RHP Yilber Díaz to Class AAA Toledo.

TODAY

NATIONALS' LEADERS

Entering Tuesday's game.

BATTERS	AVG	A	H	HR	RBI	BB	SO	
Morales		296	296	8	2	3	0	8
Ruiz		289	327	90	10	47	16	36
Wiemer		286	398	20	3	12	29	
García		283	313	101	23	76	16	61
Pinckney		273	308	6	1	3	1	8
Wood		268	395	127	30	75	98	165
Abrams		264	339	143	30	53	150	
Mead		254	352	72	17	48	39	62
Chaparro		251	351	44	10	36	22	48
Young		249	316	99	10	47	32	75
Lile		248	301	140	20	82	39	121
Vivas		244	337	69	3	29	38	47
House		239	300	70	10	44	24	83
Tena		225	307	56	7	23	27	86
Crews		223	291	81	11	40	27	98
Ortiz		212	252	24	5	13	6	32
Núñez		210	290	86	1	35	46	96
Ford		186	307	16	3	10	14	23
Millas		185	277	24	2	11	14	37

PITCHERS	W	L	ERA	H	ER	BB	SO
Waldron		10	0.00	7	0	1	2
Sinclair		10	1.69	2	1	3	5
Fernández		0	0.25	3	1	2	3
Yean		0	1.245	8	3	2	7
Tolman		1	1.261	8	3	5	11
Williams		0	2.65	15	5	6	22
Poulin		3	0.270	27	11	21	25
Griffin		12	3.06	109	44	30	116
Cavalli		12	5.312	144	57	48	194
Bird		0	3.24	6	3	2	10
Alvarez		2	3.35	63	18	47	99
Ribalta		1	2.377	34	18	18	42
Dion		1	2.80	11	9	10	21
Lovelady		1	3.91	26	10	17	21
Lord		5	2.406	67	35	31	71
Lawrence		0	4.26	7	6	3	6
Beeter		6	5.450	36	24	31	47
Cornelio		2	2.488	21	15	22	31
Littell		7	4.97	115	62	35	70
Irvin		2	5.51	90	59	46	96
Z.Kent		0	5.68	15	8	3	10
Mikolas		3	5.82	137	75	23	58
Pérez		2	6.19	16	11	11	9
Schultz		1	2.640	43	23	12	32
Parker		3	6.58	46	29	13	34
J.Kent		1	6.59	30	20	20	23
Waldichuk		0	6.75	8	7	6	8
Simpson		1	0.625	14	6	4	6
Varland		1	2.682	43	24	15	30
Cosgrove		1	2.771	18	14	6	14
Palmquist		0	2.771	21	14	8	15
Krook		0	7.6	4	6	4	6
Henry		0	2.790	17	12	7	15
Cruz		0	1.900	9	5	6	5
Kranick		0	1.933	27	19	13	11
Granillo		0	0.964	13	10	8	3
Peraltes		0	0.1157	10	9	6	9

NL WILD-CARD STANDINGS

Team	W	L	Pct	WCGB
Chi. Cubs	84	67	.556	+2
Philadelphia	83	67	.553	+1½
x-San Diego	81	68		
x-Arizona	79	71	.527	2½

AL WILD-CARD STANDINGS

Team	W	L	Pct	WCGB
x-N.Y. Yankees	86	63	.577	+10½
Boston	82	68	.547	+6
Cleveland	76	75	.503	—
Toronto	75	76	.497	—
Texas	74	76	.493	1½
Baltimore	73	78	.483	3

NL leaders

Entering Monday's games.

BATTING	
Arraez, Phi	313
Lopez, Mia	309
Gonzales, Pit	304
Moreno, Ari	301
Rumfield, Col	298
McCarthy, Col	295
Freeman, Ari	293
Chourio, Mil	292

HOME RUNS	
Schwarber, Phi	44
Crow-Armstrong, Chi	41
Olson, Atl	39
Goodman, Col	38
Devers, SF	37
Stewart, Cin	31

RBI	
Burleson, StL	109
Stewart, Cin	107
Walker, SF	100
Devers, SF	98
Crow-Armstrong, Chi	98
Abrams, Was	96
Schwarber, Phi	94
Turang, Mil	92
Contreras, Mil	86

ERA	
Misiorowski, Mil	1.95
Sale, Atl	2.18
Yamamoto, LA	2.62
Rodriguez, Ari	2.62
Sánchez, Phi	2.79
Burns, Cin	2.80
Luzardo, Phi	2.87
King, SD	3.03

SAVES	
Miller, SD	36
O'Brien, StL	36
Iglesias, Atl	32
Duran, Phi	30
Megill, Mil	27
Pagán, Cin	23
Scott, LA	22
Fairbanks, Mia	19

STRIKEOUTS	
Misiorowski, Mil	236
Luzardo, Phi	221
Sánchez, Phi	210
Cavalli, Was	194
Sale, Atl	190
Skenes, Pit	186
McLean, NY	184
Burns, Cin	181

AL leaders

Entering Monday's games.

BATTING	
Alvarez, Hou	310
Simpson, TB	305
Diaz, TB	291
DeLaeter, Cle	291
Greene, Det	283
Rafaela, Bos	282
Cagillione, KC	281
Witt, KC	280

HOME RUNS	
Camirero, TB	40
Alvarez, Hou	38
Rice, NY	38
Alonso, Bal	35
Okamoto, Tor	32
Murakami, Chi	31
Montgomery, Chi	31
Vargas, Chi	30

RBI	
Alonso, Bal	100
Alvarez, Hou	96
Camirero, TB	95
Aranda, TB	89
Rice, NY	90
Aranda, TB	89
Adell, Cle	88
Dingler, Det	87
Bel, Min	86

ERA	
Schiltler, NY	1.95
Cease, Tor	2.38
Messick, Cle	2.51
Gray, Bos	2.76
Rasmussen, TB	2.81
Martinez, TB	2.92
Wacha, KC	3.25
Detmers, LA	3.32

SAVES	
Baker, TB	40
Smith, Cle	36
Bodnar, NY	34
Chapman, Bos	34
Varland, Tor	33
Laté, Tex	33
Muñoz, Sea	27
Phillips	27

STRIKEOUTS	
Cease, Tor	236
Schiltler, NY	228
Williams, Cle	228
Detmers, LA	221
Bradley, Min	190
Gilbert, Sea	187
DeGrom, Tex	186
Messick, Cle	178



SAM GREENE/USA TODAY

A snack for the road

Dave Roberts tosses a handful of sunflower seeds at Teoscar Hernández after a solo home run in the Dodgers' 4-1 win over the Reds in Cinninati on Monday.

In Alonso's homecoming, Henderson steals show for O's

ORIOLES 2, METS 1

BY MATT WEYRICH

NEW YORK — This time, Gunnar Henderson made the difference in the clutch.

The Orioles' star shortstop hasn't often been the source of big hits in key spots this season, but in Monday's game against the New York Mets, his go-ahead home run in the eighth helped Baltimore earn a 2-1 victory.

With the score tied and the Orioles looking for a big hit all night, Henderson took right-hander Dedniel Núñez deep for his 23rd home run of the season and his first since Aug. 30.

Baltimore (73-78) won the series opener to give Pete Alonso a happy homecoming in his first game back at Citi Field since the Orioles signed him away from the Mets in free agency. The home team treated Alonso, who spent seven seasons in Queens, to a scoreboard tribute video and multiple standing ovations. Entering the game sitting on 299 career home runs, he went 0 for 3 with a walk.

With the win, the Orioles pulled back to within three games of the third American



BRAD PENNER/IMAGN IMAGES

Gunnar Henderson's first homer in more than two weeks made the difference against the Mets.

League wild-card spot. Their playoff odds have dwindled to the single digits, but they are not yet eliminated with 11 games left.

Brandon Young labored through five innings yet avoided disaster, allowing one run on five hits and five walks with six strikeouts. He threw a

career-high 106 pitches and needed every one of them.

The Orioles' other run came courtesy of Heston Kjerstad, who recorded his first extra-base hit since making his MLB return Sept. 1 with a second-inning double to score Jackson Holliday. Center fielder A.J. Ewing then tied the game back

up with a solo shot in the fourth.

Four relievers combined to record the final 12 outs for the Orioles, with Yennier Cano earning the win and Rico Garcia recording the save — his ninth of the season — against his former team.

— Baltimore Sun

Cubs 7, Braves 3

Pete Crow-Armstrong hit his 42nd homer to match the Cubs record for a left-handed batter and finished with four hits and four RBI to power Chicago past Atlanta.

The Cubs have won three of four and moved one-half game ahead of the idle Philadelphia Phillies for the top National League wild card.

Cardinals 2, Giants 1

Quinn Mathews took a no-hitter into the sixth inning, and Alec Burleson had an RBI single to lead St. Louis past San Francisco.

Mathews retired his first 10 batters before walking Bryce Eldridge.

GIANTS	AB	R	H	B	BB	SO	ERA
Cox cf-2b	5	0	1	0	2	279	
Eldridge 1b	5	0	1	0	1	269	
Whitecomb 2b	3	0	1	0	1	184	
Gilbert ph-cf	0	0	0	0	1	234	
Hilli dh	4	0	1	0	1	227	
B.Harris 3b	5	0	0	0	0	000	
Furman ph	1	0	0	0	0	125	
Bandura rf	2	0	0	0	0	200	
Scott lf	2	0	1	0	0	196	
Knizner	3	0	1	0	0	167	
Cavanaugh ph	0	0	0	0	0	1242	
Albies 2b	4	0	0	0	0	1243	
McCray lf	4	1	1	0	0	2147	
Koss ss	4	0	0	0	0	2229	
TOTALS	31	1	6	1	4	12	—

Stiffer tests, same outcome for U.S. women at World Cup

Despite their youth, Americans retain title and maintain ‘standard’

BY DOUG FEINBERG

BERLIN — The names may change, but the results are the same for the U.S. women’s basketball team — another FIBA World Cup title.

The Americans’ fifth championship in a row came Sunday in a 97-79 victory over France. It wasn’t as easy as the previous four, with the U.S. showing some vulnerability throughout the tournament.

A three-point win over Italy in group play gave other teams hope. A tight game against Spain in the semifinals also raised some eyebrows.

France held a 14-point first-half lead in the title game — the biggest deficit the Americans had faced since their last loss in a major competition, when Russia beat them in the semifinals of the 2006 World Cup.

But the U.S. was calm and not worried. The game ended the same way the previous 35 had for the Americans: with a victory.

“We are the standard,” said Breanna Stewart, who scored 22 points and earned MVP honors of the tournament for a record second time. “USA Basketball has



The U.S. rallied from a 14-point deficit — its biggest in a major competition in 20 years — in the final.

continued to show up and go for gold, and to have done that however many times consecutively is an insane stat. We want to make sure that we continue to build on that standard, and everybody else

knows it.” This might have been the best chance for someone to beat the Americans. They were missing four-time WNBA MVP A’ja Wilson, and the roster was full of

newcomers, including Caitlin Clark, Angel Reese and Paige Bueckers. Kara Lawson was coaching and getting better acquainted with the second-youngest American squad in the past

40-plus years.

Clark, Reese and Bueckers gained valuable experience, and they will be integral for the U.S. to continue its success over the next decade.

France, which lost to the Americans by a point in the Paris Olympics gold medal game two years ago, thought it could be the team to end their two decades of dominance. For nearly a half, it looked possible.

There was no panic, though, on the U.S. side, thanks in part to the ultimate winner Stewart, who has two World Cup MVPs now — the first player to ever accomplish that. She is only 32 and has four World Cup championships on her résumé.

The Americans calmly rallied within two points at the half as Clark’s three-pointer just before the buzzer capped the rally. The U.S. then put it away in the third quarter.

“I think we felt really good about where we were at,” said Clark, who posted 12 points. “I think France was 8 for 14 [from three-point range]. We dug ourself a hole, but we climbed out of it, and I felt like we were never rattled by anything.”

With Stewart and Wilson likely to be leading the way at the 2028 Los Angeles Olympics, teams will be hard-pressed to end this run by the Americans. In addition to their World Cup success, they also haven’t lost an Olympic game in 34 years.

While the U.S. will be favored to capture gold at home, some teams on the rise will challenge them.

France has a strong core led by Gabby Williams, Marine Johannes and Dominique Malonga. The French looked dominant throughout the World Cup, blowing past opponents by an average of 35.6 points. They kept that momentum going at the start against the U.S. before falling short once again.

Still, the silver medal finish was the country’s best in the history of the event. Spain, which won the bronze medal, has a talented young nucleus with Iyana Martin and Awa Fam, who are both 20.

One of the biggest weaknesses for the U.S. is a lack of training time. The team got together as a whole group for the first time a few days before the World Cup began. That won’t be a problem in 2030, when the tournament will be played in Japan. FIBA shifted the dates to late November and early December, meaning the Americans will have ample time after the WNBA season is over to get together to train.

FIBA also said there won’t be any more back-to-back games, with rest days for each team between group games as well as a day between the quarterfinals, semifinals and finals. In Berlin, the semis and finals were on Saturday and Sunday.

— Associated Press

PERSPECTIVE

The Olympics may be two years away, but time is running out for an MLB deal

SHAIKIN FROM B7

not unless MLB eases up on mandatory participation, and unless LA28, the international baseball federation and the International Olympic Committee provide major league players with flexibility in areas such as accommodations, tickets and marketing rights.

When these issues surfaced publicly at the All-Star Game two months ago, MLB said it was awaiting a counterproposal from the union. LA28 said the same thing. Two months later, MLB and LA28 are still waiting.

In March, on the eve of negotiations for a new labor agreement — which could lead owners to shut down the sport for part or all of next season in trying to secure a salary cap — union chief Bruce Meyer said: “If we don’t have a season, we’re not going to play in the Olympics.”

That irritated MLB officials. Meyer said he meant that, if a lockout extended into 2028, the players would not play in the Olympics that year. He also said the union is not trying to use the Games as a bargaining chip in labor talks and added the two sides could reach an Olympics agreement independently of a collective bargaining agreement.

The union would prefer to strike a comprehensive deal with MLB and LA28. The NHL players reached a deal seven months before the start of this year’s Milan-Cortina Olympics. MLB announced its 2027 schedule eight months before the start of next season, assuming next season starts on time.

Allow me to say this: Your eyes are glazing over. That was far too many paragraphs without talking baseball. This is about growing the sport, remember. Harper was only too



“There’s no greater stage than the Olympics,” said the Phillies’ Bryce Harper, affirming his desire to take part in the Los Angeles Games.

happy to share his memories of growing up and winning championships with Team USA in an 18-and-under tournament in Venezuela and a 16-and-under tournament in Mexico.

“I’ve never won a World Series,” Harper said. “But, at that age, there was nothing greater than putting USA across your chest and hearing your anthem blaring in a different country.

“Logistically, we’ve got to

figure it all out.” Harper said the owners need not be concerned about a wave of players wanting to skip the Olympics.

“I don’t think it’s going to be an issue,” he said. “I think you’re going to have a lot of players that want to do it, that want to play on a world stage.

“If I have a chance to do it, I’m going to do it, and I know a lot of guys would love to do the same thing.”

Shohei Ohtani has said he would. So has Kyle Schwarber. Even Tarik Skubal, who withdrew from this year’s World Baseball Classic after one three-inning appearance, said he is all in for the Olympics.

“Absolutely,” Skubal said. Although his abbreviated WBC participation this spring was popularly tied to his free agency this fall, Skubal said the decision was simply based on a history of velocity that rises

later in the season.

“Just looking out for my health,” he said. “I’m not ready to go sit 99 to 102 for five or six innings in March. There’s a different adrenaline that runs through you that I don’t think I’m ready for in March but I’m ready for come all-star time.”

That’s in July, the same month as the Olympics. Skubal, like Harper, suggested the mandatory participation proposal would be unnecessary.

“Just try to make that make sense. It doesn’t,” he said. “I don’t get it. I think guys will have plenty of incentive to play, if they feel good and they’re up to it.

“Now, if they’re nursing some things and they feel they need the week off, they’re going to take the week off.”

Well, about that: In order to make sure that a player that skips the Olympics because of injury is truly hurt, the owners’ proposal would force him to sit out the first two weeks when the season resumes — even if the player is healthy by then.

“That’s stupid,” Skubal said.

I won’t go so far as to say the procedural issues holding up an Olympic agreement are stupid. The concerns are legitimate but far from insurmountable, and they should not require two years to resolve.

Growing the sport means fans from Rome to Caracas debating their dream teams in anticipation of the Games. And, in a nod to MLB, LA28 organizers scheduled the baseball competition in a preferred window, starting before any competition in gymnastics, swimming and track and field.

I will say that, since the crucial portions of collective bargaining negotiations probably won’t begin in earnest until after the expected lockout starts in December, the next three months offer a window in which to get an Olympic deal done.

It would show that owners and players can work together for the good of the game, and it would promise fans an unprecedented, star-studded international tournament in 2028. It would represent a small and desperately needed ray of sunshine before what could be baseball’s nuclear winter.

Postseason hopefuls scramble for spots

BASEBALL FROM B7

and Rangers; Blue Jays over Guardians; Rangers over Blue Jays and Guardians.

A tight race is also brewing between the AL Central and AL West leaders for the second of the AL’s two first-round byes. Right now, Chicago leads Houston by 1½ games for that.

In the National League

The Brewers, Atlanta Braves and Los Angeles Dodgers all have substantial division leads. Milwaukee (93-57) seems pretty safe for a first-round bye. Los Angeles (90-59) leads Atlanta (88-62) in the race for the other one.

The wild-card race is basically four teams fighting for three spots — the Chicago Cubs (83-67), Philadelphia Phillies (83-67), San Diego Padres (81-68) and Arizona Diamondbacks (79-71). San Diego hosts Arizona in the final three games of the season Sept. 25-27.

Tiebreakers: Braves over

Dodgers; Cubs over Phillies, Padres and Diamondbacks; Phillies over Padres.

Trivia time

Cubs outfielder Pete Crow-Armstrong has a chance to finish the season in double digits in the FanGraphs version of wins above replacement. That’s been done a few times in recent years, but no National Leaguer has accomplished the feat since Barry Bonds had 11.9 fWAR in 2004. Who was the last NL player to do it before Bonds?

Performance of the week

Philadelphia’s Jesús Luzardo struck out 12 in a two-hit shutout of Atlanta last Monday. The Phillies won, 1-0, thanks to Kyle Schwarber’s eighth-inning homer, salvaging a split of a four-game series with the Braves in a game that took 1 hour 51 minutes.

But Philadelphia probably needed more to stay in the NL East race. Atlanta is now five games up.

Comeback of the week

The San Francisco Giants stormed back with six runs in the eighth inning to beat the St. Louis Cardinals, 7-6, on Wednesday.

All those runs came with two outs.

Bryce Eldridge hit a bases-loaded single to bring home two runs. Then Jonah Cox hit an RBI single, and Jung Hoo Lee tied it with a two-run double. Shay Whitcomb’s double made it 7-6.

Team of the week

San Diego went 6-0 to jump ahead of Arizona in the playoff race. The Padres have won seven in row overall, four of which were by one run and only one of which was by more than two. Mason Miller has four saves during the streak.

Trivia answer

Kevin Brown finished the 1998 season with 10.0 fWAR, going 18-7 with a 2.38 ERA in 257 innings for San Diego.



The White Sox entered Monday’s games with a half-game lead over the Guardians in the AL Central.

SCOREBOARD

PRO FOOTBALL

NFL									
NFC									
EAST	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
N.Y. Giants	1	0	0	1.000	28	20			
Philadelphia	1	0	0	1.000	24	22			
Washington	0	1	0	.000	22	24			
Dallas	0	1	0	.000	20	28			

SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
Atlanta	0	1	0	.000	13	20			
Tampa Bay	0	1	0	.000	27	33			
New Orleans	0	1	0	.000	59	37			
Carolina	0	1	0	.000	37	59			

NORTH	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
Minnesota	1	0	0	1.000	39	22			
Chicago	1	0	0	1.000	59	37			
Detroit	1	0	0	1.000	31	30			
Green Bay	0	1	0	.000	22	39			

WEST	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
San Francisco	1	0	0	1.000	27	7			
Arizona	1	0	0	1.000	26	14			
Seattle	1	0	0	1.000	13	10			
L.A. Rams	0	1	0	.000	7	27			

AFC

EAST	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
N.Y. Jets	1	0	0	1.000	23	10			
Buffalo	1	0	0	1.000	34	10			
New England	0	1	0	.000	10	13			
Miami	0	1	0	.000	13	27			

SOUTH	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
Jacksonville	1	0	0	.000	31	36			
Houston	0	1	0	.000	31	36			
Tennessee	0	1	0	.000	10	23			
Indianapolis	0	1	0	.000	23	41			

NORTH	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
Baltimore	1	0	0	1.000	41	23			
Pittsburgh	1	0	0	1.000	20	13			
Cincinnati	1	0	0	1.000	33	27			
Cleveland	0	1	0	.000	10	34			

WEST	W	L	T	PCT.	PF	PA			
Las Vegas	1	0	0	1.000	27	13			
x-Denver	0	0	0	.000	0	0			
x-Kansas City	0	0	0	.000	0	0			
L.A. Chargers	0	1	0	.000	14	26			

x-Late game

WEEK 1

WEDNESDAY'S RESULT

Seattle 13, New England 10

THURSDAY'S RESULT

San Francisco 27, L.A. Rams 7 in Melbourne, Australia

SUNDAY'S RESULTS

at Philadelphia 24, Washington 22

Baltimore 41, at Indianapolis 23

Buffalo 36, at Houston 31

Chicago 59, at Carolina 37

at Cincinnati 33, Tampa Bay 27

at Detroit 31, New Orleans 30 (OT)

at Jacksonville 24, Cleveland 10

N.Y. Jets 23, at Tennessee 10

at Pittsburgh 20, Atlanta 13

Arizona 26, at L.A. Chargers 14

at Las Vegas 27, Miami 13

at Minnesota 39, Green Bay 22

at N.Y. Giants 28, Dallas 20

MONDAY'S RESULT

Denver at Kansas City, late

WEEK 2

THURSDAY'S GAME

Detroit at Buffalo, 8:15

SUNDAY'S GAMES

Washington at Dallas, 4:25

New Orleans at Baltimore, 1

Carolina at Atlanta, 1

Cincinnati at Houston, 1

Cleveland at Tampa Bay, 1

Green Bay at N.Y. Jets, 1

Minnesota at Chicago, 1

Philadelphia at Tennessee, 1

Pittsburgh at Denver, 4:05

Jacksonville at New England, 4:05

Miami at San Francisco, 4:25

Seattle at Arizona, 4:25

Indianapolis at Kansas City, 8:20

MONDAY'S GAME

N.Y. Giants at L.A. Rams, 8:15

Giants 28, Cowboys 20

Late Sunday

FIRST QUARTER
N.Y. Giants: Skattebo 3 run (Zvada kick), 6:40.

SECOND QUARTER
Dallas: Lamb 1 pass from Prescott (Aubrey kick), 5:44.
N.Y. Giants: Likely 15 pass from Dart (Zvada kick), :20.

DAL	NYG		
First Downs	21	29	
Total Net Yards	244	394	
Rushes-Yards	18-69	37-165	
Passing	175	229	
Punt Returns	0-0	0-0	
Kickoff Returns	5-122	3-65	
Interceptions Ret.	0-0	1-0	
Comp-Att-Int	22-34-1	23-29-0	
Sacked-Yards Lost	0-0	2-1	
Punts	2-48-0	1-46-0	
Fumbles-Lost	0-0	4-1	
Penalties-Yards	9-90	10-114	
Time Of Possession	23:20	36:40	

PASSING		
Dallas: Singletary 22-34-1-175.		
N.Y. Giants: Dart 23-29-0-230.		
RUSHING		
Dallas: J.Williams 12-41, Prescott 2-14, Luepke 1-7, De-mercado 2-7, Lamb 1-0.		
N.Y. Giants: Skatkebo 18-81, Dart 11-54, Singletary 6-16, Tracy 2-14.		

First Downs	21	29
Total Net Yards	244	394
Rushes-Yards	18-69	37-165
Passing	175	229
Punt Returns	0-0	0-0
Kickoff Returns	5-122	3-65

Interceptions Ret.	0-0	1-0
Comp-Att-Int	22-34-1	23-29-0
Sacked-Yards Lost	0-0	2-1
Punts	2-48.0	1-46.0
Fumbles-Lost	0-0	4-1
Penalties-Yards	9-90	10-114

RECEIVING	REC	YDS	AVG	TD
Olive, No.	10	182	18.2	0
Watson, C.B.	6	147	24.5	2
Coker, Car.	8	138	17.3	2
Smith-Njigba, Sea.	8	122	15.3	1
Golden, GB	6	95	15.8	0
Middle, Ari.	9	95	10.6	1

RUSHING	ATT	YDS	AVG	TD
Gibbs, Bal.	29	156	5.4	2
Kincaid, Buf.	18	124	6.9	3
Moore, Buf.	5	100	20.0	1
Douglas, Mia.	5	94	18.8	0
Washington, Jac.	5	83	16.6	1
McConkey, LAC	5	82	16.4	1

RUSHING	ATT	YDS	AVG	TD
Henry, Bal.	22	144	6.6	3
Hall, N.Y.J.	22	102	4.6	1
Jeanty, Las.	23	102	4.4	0
Taylor, Ind.	19	98	5.2	2
Tuten, Jac.	15	66	4.4	0
Montgomery, Hou.	20	60	3.0	2

MISSED FIELD GOALS	
None.	

RECEIVING	REC	YDS	AVG	TD
Flowers, Bal.	5	150	30.0	1
Kincaid, Buf.	5	130	26.0	0
Monangal, Chi.	10	100	10.0	1
Barkley, Phi.	15	83	5.5	0
Bi.Robinson, Atl.	21	83	4.0	0
Skattebo, NYG	18	81	4.5	1
McCaftrey, SF	10	68	6.8	0

Wentz, Min	133	3	0	123.5
Hurts, Phi	203	3	0	122.2
Lock, Sea	187	1	0	113.3
Young, Car	361	3	1	110.3
Purdy, SF	205	3	1	105.6

BASEBALL

NATIONALS ON DECK

vs. Philadelphia Phillies

Tuesday 6:45 Nationals.TV

Wednesday 6:45 Nationals.TV

at St. Louis Cardinals

Friday 8:15 Nationals.TV

Saturday 7:15 Nationals.TV

Sunday 2:15 Nationals.TV

at Detroit Tigers

Sept. 21 6:40 Nationals.TV

Sept. 22 6:40 Nationals.TV

Sept. 23 1:10 Nationals.TV

Radio: *WJFK (106.7 FM), WDCN (87.7 FM)*

PRO BASKETBALL

WNBA

EAST	W	L	Pct	GB
y-Atlanta	26	14	.650	—
y-Indiana	26	14	.650	—
y-New York	24	16	.600	2
y-Washington	24	16	.600	2
Toronto	15	25	.375	13 1/2
Connecticut	11	29	.275	17 1/2
	10	30	.250	18
WEST	W	L	Pct	GB
y-Minnesota	31	9	.775	—
y-George State	29	11	.725	2 1/2
y-Vegas	27	13	.675	4 1/2
Dallas	26	16	.625	5 1/2
Portland	16	24	.400	15 1/2
Los Angeles	15	25	.375	16 1/2
Phoenix	14	26	.350	17 1/2
Seattle	8	32	.200	23 1/2

A fiery preparation



MATT MCCLAIN/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

Mike Stettler of the National Park Service uses a blow torch Friday to heat the metal of the United States Marine Corps War Memorial in Arlington, Virginia, to prepare it for the application of wax.

Lawsuit over 2023 incident in D.C. jail

5 CURRENT, FORMER INMATES SUED

They say staff failed to prevent a series of fires

BY LIAM BOWMAN

Five current and former D.C. jail inmates sued the facility Monday, alleging that jail staff failed to prevent and adequately respond to a series of fires set by a fellow inmate who said he was going to kill himself.

The lawsuit alleges that staffers at the jail's mental health unit, where the plaintiffs were housed, ignored the man's pleas and did nothing to help for several hours as the incident unfolded in September 2023.

The complaint said an electrical fire eventually filled the unit with smoke and left some of the inmates with lasting respiratory damage and psychological distress from being trapped so close by, exacerbating their existing mental health issues.

The men in the unit "could do nothing but watch in terror and bang on their cell doors as the fire grew," according to the complaint, filed in D.C. Superior Court. "Only when the unit had filled completely with thick black smoke, choking and blinding Plaintiffs, did staff move to extinguish the fire and evacuate the residents."

The 38-page complaint is partially redacted because of a protective order restricting the release of certain internal jail documents filed with the lawsuit. For example, a portion of the complaint that describes the timeline of the fires redacts more than two hours, obscuring some details from public view.

At one point, visible "flames burned off and on in the unit for almost an hour while on-duty staff remained unmoving in the glass control module overlooking the unit," the plaintiffs allege.

A D.C. Department of Corrections spokesperson said in a statement that the department "has not received the complaint referenced and therefore cannot comment on its specific allegations."

In a response to official complaints submitted earlier by plaintiffs, jail officials said there was "no indication" that the inmates who have now filed suit "were personally affected by a Department or facility action or policy/procedure," according to lawsuit, which quoted the jail's initial response.

Of the five plaintiffs, two are still incarcerated at the D.C. jail, two are in the federal prison system and one has been released from jail custody and lives in a residential treatment program in D.C.

"This is one piece in a long, well-documented history of issues with the D.C. jail," Ian Herbert, one of the plaintiffs' lawyers said in an interview. Herbert said the issues raised in the complaint, including the failure to properly staff the jail or train employees, were "known and documented for many years prior to the fire."

"Really, the fire was both foreseeable and preventable," he

SEE LAWSUIT ON **B20**

D.C. police union, leaders in Va. voice their concerns over Flock technology

BY JUAN BENN JR.
AND BEN CONARCK

The national blowback against Flock license-plate readers is also hitting the Washington region, with D.C.'s police union and leaders in a Northern Virginia city raising concerns about the use of the technology in recent days.

Gregg Pemberton, president of the D.C. police union, said Friday the city's department has used license plate readers for many

AI-powered license-plate readers can track vehicles in real time

years and is a powerful investigative tool. But he noted Flock's technology can also create detailed files on people not suspected of any crimes.

"We have a lot of concerns about whether or not there's a

constitutional question that needs to be addressed there," Pemberton said.

Pemberton's skepticism of the technology also comes as the union said it learned the police force's internal affairs department had used the technology to investigate sworn officers.

The union filed misconduct complaints and a grievance about what it said was improper use of the technology, but Pemberton said department leader-

SEE FLOCK ON **B14**



JOE RAEDLE/GETTY IMAGES

A Flock camera monitors passing traffic in Miami this month.

TODAY'S WEATHER

8 a.m.	Noon	4 p.m.	8 p.m.
63°	75°	80°	72°

High today at approx. 4 p.m.: **80°**
Precip: **0%** Wind: **ESE 6-12 mph**

For weather news, go to **B20**

OBITUARY

Lucien Smith, artist who garnered national acclaim in the 2010s, was 37. **B15**

MARYLAND

State issues vaccine guidance in response to federal changes. **B14**

MARYLAND

State issues its first vaccine guidance in response to federal guidance shifts

BY KATHARINE WILSON
Capital Gazette

Officials from the Maryland Department of Health issued a vaccine schedule for children and adults Thursday for the first time. A state law changed on July 1 to permit the department to set its own vaccine recommendations, as federal guidance shifts under the Trump administration.

The Vax Act was signed into state law in April, permitting state officials to make recommendations that can differ from federal advice. The law followed moves from the Trump administration to alter vaccine recommendation policy.

“There is a lot of confusion out there about what the guidelines are, particularly at the federal level right now,” Meg Sullivan, deputy secretary for public health services for the Maryland Department of Health, said during a Thursday media call. “Our goal with these recommendations is [to] try to create one place where there is clear recommendations to try and eliminate the confusion.”

The recommendations from the state do not create mandates or requirements for school attendance. The Vax Act, legislation requested by Gov. Wes Moore’s administration, requires insurance plans to cover these state-recommended vaccines.

The state vaccine schedule and Vax Act were made, state Health Secretary Meena Seshamani said, to “safeguard vaccine access amid this endless shifting” in federal vaccine recommendations. The schedule was made, she said, using advice from medical organizations like the American Academy of Pediatrics and the American Academy of Family Physicians.

Under HHS Secretary Robert F. Kennedy Jr., federal vaccination policy has undergone changes, some of which are held up in court. The Health and Human Services Department did not respond to a request for comment.

President Donald Trump signed an executive order alert-



KIM HAIRSTON/BALTIMORE SUN/ABACA/REUTERS

Front, from left: Maryland Senate President Bill Ferguson, Gov. Wes Moore and House Speaker Joseline A. Peña-Melnik during the signing of the Vax Act.

ing childhood vaccine recommendations in August, including separating the measles, mumps and rubella vaccines into separate shots instead of the combined MMR vaccine. The order also calls on Kennedy to assess a new timing and sequence of core childhood vaccines and separate other core combined vaccines.

The Maryland recommendations continue to “stress the importance of the MMR vaccine, given as a single vaccine,” Sullivan said. The schedule, she added, also continues to recommend the hepatitis B vaccine complet-

“Our goal with these recommendations is [to] try to create one place where there is clear recommendations to try and eliminate the confusion.”

Meg Sullivan,
deputy secretary for public health services
for the Maryland Department of Health

ed series, starting at birth, and respiratory virus vaccines.

In December, the Centers for Disease Control and Prevention-

Instead, the federal advice from the CDC advisory committee on immunization practices is for birthing parents who test negative for the virus to ask their doctor whether the baby should have the shot on the first day, or if the vaccine should be postponed at least by two months.

The CDC panel has been under scrutiny after Kennedy fired the entire panel of experts last summer, replacing them with members who are more skeptical of vaccines.

Several Maryland Republicans expressed concern over

having separate standards from the federal government when the Vax Act was signed into law earlier this year.

“For decades, vaccine recommendations have followed a coordinated federal process grounded in broad medical consensus,” Senate Minority Leader Steve Hershey said in April. “Creating a separate Maryland track is unnecessary and sets a troubling precedent.”

The legislation passed the General Assembly 105-32 in the House of Delegates and 32-12 in the state Senate.

National blowback against Flock license-plate readers also hits D.C. region

FLOCK FROM B13

ship has so far declined to investigate. The department has since restricted access to the system, according to the union.

Pemberton called for the D.C. Council to regulate how the tech is used in the nation’s capital.

“Once you start to understand the capabilities of this system, even the proponents of it say there needs to be more public discussion and probably more legislation on it,” he said.

The union’s grievance thrust it into an improbable alliance of groups — which ranges from conservative politicians to leftist activists and civil rights advocacy organizations — raising questions about the technology that can track vehicles across vast geographical areas in real time.

The chorus of skepticism grew especially heated this summer in light of reporting, including an investigation by The Washington Post, that found scores of law enforcement officers have been charged with or accused of misusing the technology, including for spying on wives, girlfriends and exes. Other critics have raised concerned about the data being shared with other law enforcement agencies, including federal immigration authorities.

“People who often are not on the same page on issues, who have all come together around being deeply angry about Flock” and surveillance technology, said Tess McEnery, a local organizer and human rights policy expert in Alexandria.

Use of — and resistance to — readers grows

Many law enforcement agencies across the D.C. region use various forms of license-plate readers. Police in Fairfax County

said Flock cameras helped identify suspects connected to a fire this summer at a storage facility that caused upward of \$1.3 million worth of damage.

In Maryland, the network of Flock cameras has been expanding, though some of the state’s largest law enforcement agencies — including Baltimore and Montgomery County — don’t contract with the company and use other vendors.

The police department in Alexandria operates 61 fixed Flock cameras along busy public roads, with more used by private businesses and schools, including Northern Virginia Community College’s Alexandria campus, Police Chief Tarrick McGuire told city leaders at a meeting last week. The city also uses automatic license plate readers to enforce parking, speed and red-light violations.

The department has drawn scrutiny in recent weeks after reports of potential improper use of the technology, but the chief said an auditing unit found zero instances of “malicious misuse.” He also said the department may soon get additional oversight help from an outside criminologist.

As McGuire spoke to lawmakers, at least 10 people held signs protesting the readers. The chief told the mayor and city council that he has heard the community’s concerns.

“I am of the opinion [that] as leaders our responsibility is not to choose between public safety and civil liberties,” he said at the meeting last Tuesday. “The constitution does not ask us to sacrifice one for another. It requires us to govern in a way that safeguards the rights of individuals while protecting all persons in our communities.”

An Alexandria police spokesperson said in a statement that Flock cameras have helped the department find missing people and have supported 35 criminal investigations, including two armed robberies. “These investigations involve real victims and real harm, from violent crime and its lasting trauma to the broader impact crime has on families and the community,” the statement said.

But some city officials signaled at last Tuesday’s meeting that they want the technology gone.

“While I do think there’s a role for technology, and I do think we have seen the role that that has played and the benefit it has, I do not think there is a role for Flock in this community,” said Mayor Aliya Gaskins.

“Once you start to understand the capabilities of this system, even the proponents of it say there needs to be more public discussion and probably more legislation on it.”

Gregg Pemberton,
president of the D.C. police union

The police chief said the department is in talks with other companies with “stronger safeguards” to address community and policing needs. The department’s contract was signed with

Flock in 2023 and can be terminated at any time, McGuire said, adding the cameras were paid for by grant and city funding.

Gaskins and some council members said they worried that, even with a different vendor, the same potential problems could arise.

“Eliminating Flock isn’t enough for me,” said councilwoman Sandy Marks. “Eliminating and moving to a new and similar technology isn’t enough for me without an extended conversation.”

They said they were concerned data collected by the cameras could be used by federal authorities to track immigrants, or even women traveling to Virginia seeking an abortion.

McGuire said the Alexandria department does not share what is recorded on the 61 cameras it operates with law enforcement agencies outside the state or in the federal government. The data is only stored for 21 days, unless needed for an investigation, in accordance to state law, McGuire said.

The department does share data collected by the cameras with more than 150 Virginia law enforcement agencies, 11 of which have 287(g) agreements that allow officers to participate in federal immigration enforcement operations, such as executing administrative warrants for deportation.

At least nine Virginia law enforcement agencies that use automatic license plate readers grant continuous access of their systems with federal agencies, according to a Virginia State Crime Commission Report published earlier this year.

As Alexandria officials pledged to continue public discussions about license-plate

readers, other localities across the state have ended their relationship with Flock following public backlash, including Staunton, Charlottesville, and Harrisonburg, according to media reports.

In Hampton Roads, research shows, the presence of the technology is more apparent in communities with higher rates of poverty and Black residents, exacerbating concerns about the potential for racial discrimination through technology.

“I just think that this is opening the door to all kinds of potential issues when it comes to disproportionate treatment or disparate treatment,” said Steven Keener, director of the Center for Crime, Equity and Justice at Christopher Newport University, which produced the study.

‘A ripe issue for the council’

Back in the nation’s capital, the D.C. police department reported data to the council earlier this year that showed its use of license-plate reader technology was expanding.

As of January, the department said it had 98 “fixed” license plate readers mounted on poles throughout the city, in addition to 68 mobile readers mounted on vehicles or trailers.

At the time, Flock owned and operated 67 of the fixed readers, four of the mobile ones and nine closed circuit television cameras.

The police department said it deployed 111 new cameras in the fiscal year 2025 and in the first quarter of the current fiscal year, during which it anticipated purchasing a total of 51 license plate readers.

The AI-powered cameras produce feeds that are funneled into the department’s “real time crime center,” which draws on

more than 1,500 public and privately owned video cameras, gunshot detection technology, facial recognition and other monitoring tools, the department said in response to questions from D.C. Council members.

The department also said it obtained approval earlier this year to “deploy an MPD data platform that leverages Axon Fusus,” an AI-powered technology that would fuse various data streams together for crime analysts to monitor in real time.

Andrew Ferguson, a law professor at George Washington University who specializes in police surveillance, said the unregulated, unaudited nature of tracking systems such as Flock raise real privacy concerns, “no matter how useful the technology may be for investigating crime.”

“This is a failure not just of the police leadership, or a particular tech company, but the D.C. Council that has not regulated the surveillance systems used by MPD,” Ferguson wrote in an emailed statement.

Council member Charles Allen (D-Ward 6) said Friday he thinks the city should hold a hearing on the issue. “It’s a ripe issue for the council and for the judiciary committee ... to set appropriate guardrails and that privacy interests are protected,” Allen said on The Politics Hour.

Ferguson said the positioning of the D.C. police union, one of a handful in the country so far to come out against the way the technology is being used, had a larger symbolism.

“When police unions are demanding guardrails for surveillance technologies,” he said, “you know you have hit a tipping point in the debate.”

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4.4 percent, and inflation remain above the Federal Reserve's target 3 p

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THE POST

AI

Additionally, there are concerns about affordability, with the end of remod

OBITUARIES



Lucien Smith, a multidisciplinary artist, in Miami in 2021. He had his first solo exhibit, “Good Vibrations,” at a New York gallery in 2012.

LUCIEN SMITH, 37

Artist who earned national acclaim in the 2010s

BY EMILY ST. MARTIN
Los Angeles Times

Lucien Smith, a multidisciplinary artist who garnered national acclaim in the 2010s, has died at 37.

ARTnews first reported news of the artist's death. His friend, gallerist Bill Powers, confirmed Mr. Smith's death, telling the outlet, “Lucien lives in a wordless place inside us now.”

A cause and place of death have not yet been disclosed.

Lucien Smith was born on April 15, 1989, in Los Angeles, the son of artist Terrence Sanders-Smith and fashion designer Vivien Ramsay. Growing up, he bounced around with his family from place to place, and Smith attended more than a dozen schools before ultimately graduating from Santa Monica High in 2007. He attended college at New York's Cooper Union and graduated with a bachelor's degree in fine arts in 2011.

His thesis project, “Imagined Nostalgia,” a reflection on false memories and our nostalgia for eras that we never experienced, caught the eye of New York dealer Jeanne Greenberg Rohatyn, who started showing Smith's work at her gallery, Salon 94.

“When we met Lucien right after he graduated, in 2011, he was the hub and heart of a burgeoning downtown culture,” Rohatyn told ARTnews. “Bright,

tender, filled with ideas and experimentation — a rare artist with charisma, talent, and the ability to build community. His Rain paintings — made with a fire extinguisher standing in for a rain machine, Lucien himself directing the spray — are now iconic. He made a batch in my backyard. As well, his Pie paintings, his Seeds, his Ark paintings and Scrap Metal. His most recent masterpiece was FOOD — together we worked with Max Lamb to build his banquets. We are deeply saddened, and will miss him terribly.”

“When we met Lucien right after he graduated, in 2011, he was the hub and heart of a burgeoning downtown culture.”

Jeanne Greenberg Rohatyn,
a New York dealer who showed Mr. Smith's work at her gallery, told ARTnews

After he graduated, Mr. Smith moved into a big red barn on a compound in Upstate New York, which he rented from film director James Ivory. The space doubled as a studio, and there he

began his “Rain Paintings,” which would make him an overnight art sensation. So much so, the New York Times dubbed him an art market “wunderkind.”

In 2012, he had his first solo exhibit, “Good Vibrations,” at Powers's Half Gallery in New York. “It was all appropriated guitar bodies which Lucien had then turned into wall sculpture by either painting or adorning them with bottle caps, glitter, tin foil, etc,” Powers wrote in Office Magazine. “Think John Armleder meets junkyard Duchamp.”

In the early 2010s, Mr. Smith's meteoric rise in the art world made him millions — his graduate painting based on Winnie the Pooh, titled “Hobbes, The Rain Man, and My Friend Barney / Under the Sycamore Tree” sold for a reported \$389,000 at auction — but the success ultimately left him unmoored.

In 2014, he told Vanity Fair: “I took the thing [I] loved to do and I made it into what I do for a living. And that's a really tricky thing. It's perverse, and it becomes conflicting, because the thing that you used to use to escape reality is now just your reality.”

The same year, during a Tedx Talk at Columbia College, he described an extraordinary career that happened too fast, too young and led him astray spiritually. After a few years of glossy magazine profiles and raking in the big bucks, he was searching

for meaning and unhappy with the “tragic artist” he met in the mirror.

Mr. Smith described an awakening after a bad trip with angel dust in which he woke up and started painting and realized that all his pain had vanished. “I realized then that this is why I do that. It's for this feeling. This is my therapy. This is my drug,” he said. “All that other stuff ... [I]t's just baggage that other people attached to my dream. It was so easy to take on those things and to think that is what I wanted. But in this moment, I realized that it wasn't about showing stuff on walls. It wasn't about selling things. It wasn't about magazine articles. ... It was just about making things, making things with my hands. That's the idea. That's the dream. That's what I committed to.”

In 2016, Mr. Smith launched Serving the People, a nonprofit organization with a mission to “nourish emerging talent in art, music and film.” And in 2017, he repurposed his mostly unused Los Angeles painting studio and launched a residency program for artists called Appointment Only, where he also hosted a series of art shows.

In 2025, he opened FOOD, a restaurant that paid homage to the 1970s restaurant opened by artists Gordon Matta-Clark, his then-partner Carol Goodden, and Tina Girouard; both restaurants catered to local artists.

DEATH NOTICE

KEESE

WILLIAM EARL KEESE III “Bill” (Age 68)
It is with regret that we notify the members of Steamfitters Local 602 of the death of Retired Brother William “Bill” Earl Keesse. Visitation will be held on Friday, September 18, 2026, 6:00 pm to 8:00 pm with prayers at 7:00 pm at the Brinsfield Funeral Home, 30195 Three Notch Road, Charlotte Hall, MD 20622. Funeral Services will be held on Saturday, September 19, 2026 at 2:00 pm at the Trinity Episcopal Church, 9560 Trinity Church Road, Charlotte Hall, MD 20622. Notice # 2093.
Sidney Bonilla F.S.T.

IN MEMORIAM

GREEN



ROSA MARIE GREEN (Age 98)
Rosie, God blessed our family with you. We will always love and miss you.
The Harris Family

When the need arises, let families find you in the Funeral Services Directory.

To be seen in the Funeral Services Directory, please call paid Death Notices at 202-334-4122.

The Washington Post

DEATH NOTICE

FLEISHER

FRANCINE L. FLEISHER (Age 90)
Francine L. Fleisher, 90, of Lebanon, passed away Thursday, September 10, 2026 at Cornwall Manor. She was the wife of the late Samuel W. Fleisher with whom she moved to PA after 50 years in Maryland, including living at Leisure World where they had many friends.

Born in Philadelphia, Pennsylvania on February 23, 1936, Francine was the daughter of the late Morris and Martha (Soffe) Oltman.

She is survived by a daughter, Mindy Beth Bickel, wife of Mark, and a son, Thomas James Barrett.

A graveside service will be held on Wednesday, September 16, 2026, at 1:00 pm at Congregation Beth Israel Cemetery, 370 E. Maple St., Lebanon, Pennsylvania 17046. In lieu of flowers, memorial contributions in memory of Francine Fleisher may be mailed to Cornwall Manor P.O. Box 125 Attn: Advancement Office Cornwall, PA 17016. Thompson Funeral Home, Inc. is entrusted with the arrangements. The family welcomes your memories and messages in our online guest book at thompsonfuneralhomelebanon.com

DEATH NOTICE

SMITH



DR. CARL W. SMITH (Age 86)
Dr. Carl W. Smith - esteemed educator and leading figure in the administration of Maryland public schools - passed away on September 10, 2026, at the age of 86.

Over the course of 48 years in public school administration, Dr. Smith inspired and enriched the lives of generations of students and educators alike, serving in a variety of positions, including High School Principal, Associate Superintendent of Montgomery County Public Schools, Superintendent of Brandywine Public Schools, and the Executive Director of the Maryland Association of Boards of Education. He is survived by his beloved wife of sixty years, Claire Horan Smith; his children Christina, Andrew, and Elizabeth; his grandchildren Sebastian, Samantha, Nathaniel, Connor, Emmeline, Audrey, and Colleen; and his brother David Smith. A visitation will be held on Thursday, September 17, 2026, at Harry H. Witzke Family Funeral Home, 4112 Old Columbia Pike, Ellicott City from 5 – 8pm. A funeral mass will be held on Friday, September 18, 2026, at St. John the Evangelist Catholic Church, 10431 Twin Rivers Road, Columbia, at 12 noon with a reception to follow. For more information, visit: harrywitzkefuneralhome.com

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by, in law of equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Additional terms may be announced at the time of sale.

FOR INFORMATION CONTACT:
COHN GLD INC. DEUTSCH 410-296-2550 or www.cgh-law.com
re: CGD # 465702. Cohn GLD Inc. (CGLD) is a debt collector; any information obtained will be used for that purpose.

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B18 CLASSIFIED • NOTICES • Trustee Sales—VA

872 Fairfax County
Trustee's Sale
 6033 Bingley
 Alexandria, VA 22315
 (Parcel ID: 0912 15120032)

Default having been made in the terms of a certain Deed of Trust dated September 29, 2005, in the original principal amount of \$297,500.00 and recorded in the Clerk's Office of the Circuit Court of the County of Fairfax, Virginia, on October 4, 2005, in Deed Book 17828, at page 2154, the undersigned Substitute trustee will sell at public auction on **October 20, 2026 at 12:45 PM**, in front of the building housing the County of Fairfax Circuit Court, 4110 Chain Bridge Road, Fairfax, VA 22030, the property designated as LOT THIRTY-TWO (32), MANCHESTER LAKES, NEIGHBORHOOD 12, AS THE SAME APPEARS DULY DEDICATED, PLATTED AND RECORDED IN DEED BOOK 7707 AT PAGE 47, AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF FAIRFAX COUNTY, VIRGINIA. Sale is subject to all prior liens, easements, restrictions, covenants, and conditions, if any, of record, or other matters which would be disclosed by an accurate survey or inspection of the premises.

TERMS: CASH. A deposit of \$40,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required of the successful bidder at time of sale and in full at the sale. Interested bidders will be required to register with and must present a bid deposit which may be held during the sale by the trustee. The bid deposit must be certified funds and/or cash, but no more than \$9,900.00 of cash will be accepted. The successful bidder will be responsible for obtaining possession of the property and for all costs and fees related to recording the grantors tax. The undersigned bidder will be required to execute a Memorandum of Sale and Settlement. A Trustee's Deed will be prepared by Trustee's attorney at high bidder's expense.

This is a communication from a debt collector, Tromberg, Miller, Morris & Partners, PLLC on behalf of Southeast Equity Trustees, LLC and/or NPMOS-VA LLC, Substitute Trustees, 5310 Market Road, Suite 201, Richmond, VA 23230, File No. 26-000135-VA, Tel: 804-525-1570.

Sep 15,22, 2026 001252954

Trustee's Sale
 7313 Mizzzen Place,
 Burke, VA 22015
 (Parcel ID: 088-3-10990)

Default having been made in the terms of a certain Deed of Trust dated June 25, 2022, in the original principal amount of \$708,180.00 and recorded in the Clerk's Office of the Circuit Court of the County of Fairfax, Virginia, on June 29, 2022, in Deed Book 27696, at page 0009, the undersigned Substitute trustee will sell at public auction on **October 20, 2026 at 12:45 PM**, in front of the building housing the County of Fairfax Circuit Court, 4110 Chain Bridge Road, Fairfax, VA 22030, the property designated as All of Lot 90, Section 3, Longwood KENNESAW, the same appears duly dedicated, platted and recorded in Deed Book 4x13 at Page 1, among the Land Records of Fairfax County, Virginia. Sale is subject to all prior liens, easements, restrictions, covenants, and conditions, if any, of record, or other matters which would be disclosed by an accurate survey or inspection of the premises.

TERMS: CASH. A deposit of \$71,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required of the successful bidder at time of sale. Prior to the sale, interested bidders will be required to register with and must present a bid deposit which may be held during the sale by the trustee. The bid deposit must be certified funds and/or cash, but no more than \$9,900.00 of cash will be accepted. The successful bidder's deposit will be retained at the sale and applied to the sale price. If held by the trustee, all other bid deposits will be returned to the unsuccessful bidders. Settlement is to be made within 15 days. The successful bidder will be responsible for obtaining possession of the property and for all costs and fees related to recording the trustee's Deed, including the grantors tax. The successful bidder will be required to execute a Memorandum of Trustee's Sale, available for review upon request before the sale, outlining additional terms of sale and settlement. A Trustee's Deed will be prepared by Trustee's attorney at high bidder's expense.

This is a communication from a debt collector, Tromberg, Miller, Morris & Partners, PLLC on behalf of Southeast Equity Trustees, LLC, Substitute Trustees, 5310 Market Road, Suite 201, Richmond, VA 23230, File No. 26-000115, Tel: 804-525-1570.

Sep 15,22, 2026 001252957

Prince William County
TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
 11580 Overleigh Dr
 Woodbridge, VA 22192

In execution of a Deed of Trust in the original principal amount of \$410,150.00 dated December 19, 2023 recorded among the land records of the Circuit Court for Prince William County on December 19, 2023 as Instrument Number: 202312190064607, the undersigned appointed Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction, at the Main entrance of the courthouse for the Circuit Court of Prince William County, 9511 Lee Avenue, Manassas, VA 20110 on **October 28, 2026 at 11:00 AM**, the property described in said deed of trust, located at the above address and briefly described as Lot Seventy-Four (74), Section Twelve (12), LAND RIDGE, (12), LAKE RIDGE, as the same appears duly dedicated, platted and recorded in Deed Book 1194 at Page 545 among the Land Records of Prince William County, Virginia. Tax ID: 8294-40-2261.

TERMS OF SALE: A bidder's deposit of \$13,000.00 or 10% of the sale price, whichever is lower, will be required in the form of a certified or cashier's check. Cash will not be accepted as a deposit. Settlement within fifteen (15) days of sale, otherwise Trustee may forfeit deposit. FINCEN reporting will be required. All successful purchasers, absent a lawful exemption. Additional terms to be announced at sale. This is a communication from a debt collector. This notice is an attempt to collect on a debt and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. (Trustee # 26-008391)

Substitute Trustee: ALG Trustee, LLC, C/O Orleans Law Group PLLC PO Box 2548, Leesburg, VA 20177 (703) 777-7101 website: www.algtr.com

Sep 15,22,29, 2026 001252957

Montgomery County
Aldridge Pite LLP
 6001 Executive Blvd., Suite 200
 Rockville, MD 20852
 301-961-6555

Montgomery County
COMMISSIONER'S SALE - NOTICE OF DEFAULT AND FORECLOSURE SALE
 4319 Westbrook Lane, Kensington, Maryland 20895

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

18253 SMOKE HOUSE COURT GERMANTOWN, MD 20874

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated April 8, 2015, recorded in Liber 50243, Folio 121 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$237,500.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

SEPTEMBER 18, 2026 AT 3:55 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Montgomery County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$20,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recording taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 372050-5)

Andrew J. Brenner, et al, Substitute Trustees

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Sep 1,8,15, 2026 0012525128

McMichael Taylor Gray LLC
 6 N. East Street, Suite 202
 Frederick, MD 21701
 404-474-7179

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF REAL PROPERTY AND ANY IMPROVEMENTS THEREON

19013 OLNEY MILL ROAD OLNEY, MD 20832

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust dated April 24, 2025, recorded in Liber 69115, Folio 370 among the Land Records of Montgomery County, MD, with an original principal balance of \$111,360.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Sub. Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Ave., Rockville, MD 20850, on

SEPTEMBER 18, 2026 AT 3:40 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with any buildings or improvements thereon located in Montgomery County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. Tax ID #08-00746224.

The property, and any improvements thereon, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind. The property will be sold subject to a prior mortgage, the amount to be announced at the time of sale.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$12,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price, together with interest on the unpaid purchase money at the current rate contained in the Deed of Trust Note, or any modifications thereto, from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Sub. Trustees, payable in cash within ten days of final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court. There will be no abatement of interest due to the purchaser in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public and/or private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recording taxes shall be paid by Purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property, and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. The sale is subject to post-sale audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into any repayment agreement, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. If purchaser fails to settle within ten days of ratification, subject to order of court, purchaser agrees that property will be resold and entire deposit retained by Sub. Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser. Sub. Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is return of the deposit without interest. (Matter No. 26-001454-02)

Diana Theologou, et al., Substitute Trustees

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The Washington Post

Montgomery County
COMMISSIONER'S SALE - NOTICE OF DEFAULT AND FORECLOSURE SALE
 4319 Westbrook Lane, Kensington, Maryland 20895

NOTICE OF DEFAULT AND FORECLOSURE SALE, made this Twenty-Fourth day of August, 2026, by Richard A. Lash, Foreclosure Commissioner.

WHEREAS, on September 18, 2009, a certain Deed of Trust was executed by Harold Barnes, who died September 30, 2017, as trustor in favor of MetLife Home Loans, a Division of MetLife Bank, N.A. as beneficiary and FNC Title, LLC as trustee, and was recorded on October 19, 2009, in Libre/Book 38203, Folio/Page 177 in the office of the Land Records of Montgomery County, Maryland; and

WHEREAS, the Deed of Trust was insured by the United States Secretary of Housing and Urban Development (the "Secretary" or "HUD") pursuant to the National Housing Act for the purpose of providing single family housing; and

WHEREAS, the beneficial interest in the Deed of Trust is now owned by the Secretary, pursuant to an assignment dated February 8, 2012, and recorded on June 8, 2012, in Libre 44148, folio 348, in the office of the Land Records of Montgomery County, Maryland; and

WHEREAS, a default has been made in the covenants and conditions of the Deed of Trust due to violation of 9(a)(i): A borrower dies and the property is not the principal residence of at least one surviving borrower; and

WHEREAS, the entire amount delinquent as of July 28, 2026 is \$1,456,891.69; and

WHEREAS, by virtue of this default, the Secretary has declared the entire amount of the indebtedness secured by the Deed of Trust to be immediately due and payable;

NOW THEREFORE, pursuant to powers vested in me by the Single Family Mortgage Foreclosure Act of 1994, 12 U.S.C. 3751 et seq., by 24 CFR part 27, subpart B, and by the Secretary's designation of Buonassissi, Henning & Lash, P.C. as Foreclosure Commissioner, notice is hereby given that on **September 18, 2026 at 4:00 PM** local time, all real and personal property at or used in connection with the following described premises ("Property") will be sold at public auction to the highest bidder:

Commonly known as:

All that property situate in Montgomery County, State of Maryland, described as:

Lot numbered Three (3) in Block lettered "C", in the subdivision known as "H. M. Martin's Addition to Chevy Chase View", in Montgomery County, Maryland, as per plat thereof recorded in Plat Book 44 at Plat 3267, one of the Land Records for said Montgomery County, Maryland.

The improvements thereon being known as 4319 Westbrook Lane, Kensington, Maryland 20895.

Tax ID No: 13-00997694

BEING the same property conveyed to Harold Barnes by Deed from Harold Barnes, Inc dated February 19, 1994, recorded February 22, 1994, among the Land Records of Montgomery County, Maryland, in Liber 12344, folio 453.

WHEREAS the said Harold Barnes departed this life on or about September 30, 2017.

The sale will be held at the Circuit Court for Montgomery County, at the Court House Door, 50 Maryland Avenue, Rockville, Maryland 20850.

The Secretary of Housing and Urban Development will bid \$1,463,989.40.

There will be no proration of taxes, rents or other income or liabilities, except that the purchaser will pay, at or before closing, his prorata share of any real estate taxes that have been paid by the Secretary to the date of the foreclosure sale.

When making their bids, all bidders except the Secretary must submit a deposit 10% of the successful bid in the form of a certified check or cashier's check made out to the United States Secretary of Housing and Urban Development. A deposit need not accompany each oral bid. If the successful bid is oral, a deposit of 10% of the successful bid must be presented before the bidding is closed. The deposit is nonrefundable. The remainder of the purchase price must be delivered within 30 days of the sale or at such other time as the Secretary may determine for good cause shown, time being of the essence. This amount, like the bid deposits, must be delivered in the form of a certified or cashier's check. If the Secretary is the highest bidder, he need not pay the bid amount in cash. The successful bidder will pay all conveying fees, all real estate and other taxes that are due on or after the delivery date of the remainder of the payment and all other costs associated with the transfer of title. At the conclusion of the sale, the deposits of the unsuccessful bidders will be returned to them.

The Secretary may grant an extension of time within which to deliver the remainder of the payment. All extensions will be for 15-day increments for a fee of \$500.00, paid in advance. The extension fee shall be in the form of a certified or cashier's check made payable to the Secretary of HUD. If the high bidder closes the sale prior to the expiration of any extension period, the unused portion of the extension fee shall be applied toward the amount due.

If the high bidder is unable to close the sale within the required period, or within any extensions of time granted by the Secretary, the high bidder may be required to forfeit the cash deposit or, at the election of the foreclosure commissioner after consultation with the HUD representative, will be liable to HUD for any costs incurred as a result of such failure. The Commissioner may, at the direction of the HUD representative, offer the property to the second highest bidder for an amount equal to the highest price offered by that bidder.

There is no right of redemption, or right of possession based upon a right of redemption, in the mortgagor or others subsequent to a foreclosure completed pursuant to this Act. Therefore, the Foreclosure Commissioner will issue a Deed to the purchaser(s) upon receipt of the entire purchase price in accordance with the terms of the sale as provided herein. HUD does not guarantee that the property will be vacant.

The scheduled foreclosure sale shall be cancelled or adjourned if it is established, by documented written application of the mortgagor to the Foreclosure Commissioner not less than 3 days before the date of sale, or otherwise, that the default or defaults upon which the foreclosure is based did not exist at the time of service of this notice of default and foreclosure sale, or all amounts due under the mortgage agreement are tendered to the Foreclosure Commissioner, in the form of a certified or cashier's check payable to the Secretary of HUD, before public auction of the property is completed.

The amount that must be paid if the mortgage is to be reinstated prior to the scheduled sale is \$1,456,891.69 as of July 28, 2026, plus all other amounts that would be due under the mortgage agreement if payments under the mortgage had not been accelerated, advertising costs and postage expenses incurred in giving notice, mileage by the most reasonable road distance for posting notices and for the Foreclosure Commissioner's attendance at the sale, reasonable and customary costs incurred for title and lien record searches, the necessary out-of-pocket costs incurred by the Foreclosure Commissioner for recording documents, a commission for the Foreclosure Commissioner, and all other costs incurred in connection with the foreclosure prior to reinstatement.

Tender of payment by certified or cashier's check or application for cancellation of the foreclosure sale shall be submitted to the address of the Foreclosure Commissioner provided below.

Date: August 24, 2026

BUONASSISSI, HENNING & LASH, P.C.
 Foreclosure Commissioner

By: Richard A. Lash, Esq.
 12355 Sunrise Valley Drive, Suite 650
 Reston, VA 20191
 TEL: 703-796-1341 Ext.144
 FAX: 1 (888) 252-7739

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Prince Georges County
Samuel I. White, P.C.
 448 VIKING DRIVE, SUITE 350
 VIRGINIA BEACH, VA 23452

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
 KNOWN AS
7952 Ashford Boulevard
Laurel, MD 20707

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to HEATHER LOVIER, Trustee(s), dated December 27, 2021, and recorded among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 47574, folio 547, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustee, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772 ON,

OCTOBER 1, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and described as follows:

LAND SITUATED IN THE COUNTY OF PRINCE GEORGES COUNTY IN THE STATE OF MD BEING KNOWN AND DESIGNATED AS LOT NUMBERED TWO HUNDRED TWENTY-EIGHT (228) IN THE SUBDIVISION KNOWN AS SECTION 1, PLAT 5, "LAUREL LAKES", AS PER PLAT RECORDED IN PLAT BOOK NLP 125, PLAT NO. 91, AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY by certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 2.875% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest for any reason. Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. There will be no abatement of taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments for any reason. If applicable, condominium and/or homeowner association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance, and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited, and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser and the purchaser agrees to pay reasonable attorneys' fees for the Substitute trustees, plus all cost incurred, if the Substitute Trustee's have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. The purchasers waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with such a motion and expressly agrees to the Memorandum of Sale. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accordance with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule (RRE) issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The sale is subject to post-sale confirmation and audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into a repayment agreement, reinstated, or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Trustee's File No. (91078)

Robert A. Jones, et al SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES

HARVEY WEINSTEIN
 AUCTIONEERS, LLC
 900 E. JONES RD, Suite 1103
 HANSPRINGER PLAZA, Suite 1103
 HANSPRINGER PLAZA, Suite 1103
 410-768-9797

Sep 15,22,29, 2026 0012524262

Spotsylvania County
TRUSTEE'S SALE OF
 5825 JOHN EAGLES DR,
 FREDERICKSBURG, VA 22407

In execution of a certain Deed of Trust dated November 26, 2021, in the original principal amount of \$436,939.00 recorded in the Clerk's Office of the Circuit Court of Spotsylvania County, Virginia, as Instrument No. 210035150. The undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction in the front of the Circuit Court building for the City of Fredericksburg, 701 Princess Anne St., Fredericksburg, Virginia, or any such temporary alternative Circuit Court location designated by the Judges of the Circuit Court, on **November 4, 2026, at 9:00 AM**, the property described in said Deed of Trust, located at the above address, and more particularly described as follows:

LOT ONE HUNDRED THIRTY FOUR (134), SECTION SEVEN (7), ASH-LEIGH PARK SUBDIVISION, AS THE SAME IS DEDICATED, PLATTED AND RECORDED IN DEED BOOK 17, PAGES 593-594, AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF THE CIRCUIT COURT OF SPOTSYLVANIA COUNTY, VIRGINIA.

TERMS OF SALE: ALL CASH. A bidder's deposit of ten percent (10%) of the sale price or ten percent (10%) of the original principal balance of the subject Deed of Trust, whichever is lower, in the form of cash or certified funds payable to the Mortgage Trustee must be present at the time of sale. The balance of the purchase price will be due within fifteen (15) days of sale, otherwise Purchaser's deposit may be forfeited to Trustee. Time is of the essence. If the sale is set aside for any reason, the Purchaser at the sale shall be entitled to a return of the deposit, paid. The Purchaser may, if provided by the terms of the Trustee's Memorandum of Foreclosure Sale, be entitled to a \$50 cancellation fee from the Substitute Trustee, but shall have no further recourse against the Mortgage Trustee. A form copy of the Trustee's memorandum of foreclosure sale and contract to purchase real property is available for viewing at www.alldridgepte.com. Additional terms, if any, to be announced at the sale and the Purchaser may be given the option to execute the contract of sale electronically.

This is a communication from a debt collector and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. The sale is subject to seller confirmation. Substitute Trustee: Equity Trustees, LLC, 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. If you have any questions or concerns, please contact the Virginia Pre-Sale Department of counsel for Equity Trustees, LLC at 301-961-6555, website: www.alldridgepte.com, File No. 26-003984-1.

Sep 15,22,Oct 1, 2026 001252972

Frederick County
Robertson, Anschutz, Schneid & Crane, LLC
 11350 McCormick Road, EP 1, Suite 302
 Hunt Valley, MD 21031
 470-321-7112

TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY
 KNOWN AS
8709 SHRYOCK MILL RD THURMONT, MD 21788

Under a power of sale contained in that Deed of Trust dated October 29, 1999, and recorded in Liber 2660, folio 376, of the land records of FREDERICK COUNTY, with an original principal balance of \$212,500.00, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the appointed Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 at 1:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND together with any buildings or improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD, located at the above address and more fully described in the aforementioned Deed of Trust.

TAX ID# - 04-156803

The property and improvements will be sold in an "AS IS" physical condition

TUESDAY, SEPTEMBER 15, 2026

EZ

851 Prince Georges County	851 Prince Georges County
Samuel I. White, P.C. 448 VIKING DRIVE, SUITE 350 VIRGINIA BEACH, VA 23452	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY KNOWN AS 15715 Chadsey Ln Brandywine, MD 20613	

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to HERITAGE TITLE LTD., Trustees(s), dated December 30, 2020, and recorded among the Land Records of PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 44709, folio 69, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT FRONT OF THE DUVAL WING OF THE COURTHOUSE COMPLEX 14735 MAIN ST, UPPER MARLBORO, MD 20772 ON,

OCTOBER 1, 2026 at 2:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY, MD and described as follows:

LOT 30 IN BLOCK C, IN A SUBDIVISION KNOWN AS "CHADDSFORD" AS SHOWN ON THE PLAT ENTITLED "PLAT TWO, LOTS 15 AND 16 BLOCK A LOTS 1 THRU 11 AND PARCEL C BLOCK B AND LOTS 16 THRU 34 BLOCK C (RESUBDIVISION OF OUT LOT 4, BRANDYWINE VILLAGE P.B. VJ 186 P. NUMBER 64) CHADDSFORD, SECTION 1", RECORDED AMONG THE LAND RECORDS OF PRINCE GEORGE'S COUNTY PLAT BOOK 2111 AT PLAT NUMBER 1. SUBJECT TO DECLARATION OF DEFERRED WATER AND SEWER FACILITIES CHARGES RECORDED IN LIBER 25950 FOLIO 364 AND 25950/364.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 PAYABLE ONLY BY certified funds, shall be required at the time of sale. CASH WILL NOT BE AN ACCEPTABLE FORM OF DEPOSIT. The balance of the purchase price with interest at 3.125% per annum from the date of sale to the date of payment will be paid within TEN DAYS after the final ratification of the sale. There will be no abatement of interest for any reason. Adjustments on all taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments will be made as of the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. There will be no abatement of taxes, public charges and special or regular assessments for any reason. If applicable, condominium and/or homeowner association dues and assessments that may become due after the time of sale will be the responsibility of the purchaser. Title examination, conveyancing, state revenue stamps, transfer taxes, title insurance and all other costs incident to settlement are to be paid by the purchaser. Time is of the essence for the purchaser, otherwise the deposit will be forfeited, and the property may be resold at risk and costs of the defaulting purchaser and the purchaser agrees to pay reasonable attorneys' fees for the Substitute trustees, plus all cost incurred, if the Substitute Trustee's have filed the appropriate motion with the Court to resell the property. The purchasers waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with such a motion and expressly agrees to The purchaser agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. If the sale is not ratified or if the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey marketable title in accord with these terms of sale, the purchaser's only remedy is return of the deposit.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule (RRE) issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained and provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing.

The sale is subject to post-sale confirmation and audit of the status of the loan with the loan servicer including, but not limited to, determination of whether the borrower entered into a repayment agreement, reinstated, or paid off the loan prior to sale. In any such event, this sale shall be null and void, and the Purchaser's sole remedy, in law or equity, shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Trustee's File No. (84678)

Robert A. Jones, et al SUBSTITUE TRUSTEES

	300 E. Joppa Road Hanover Plaza, Suite 1103 Baltimore, MD 21286 410-769-9797
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Sep 15,22,29, 2026 0012524087

879 Culpeper County	
TRUSTEE'S SALE OF 16416 TONYS CT, AMISVILLE, VA 20106	

In execution of a certain Deed of Trust dated August 24, 2017, in the original principal amount of \$203,500.00 recorded in the Clerk's office, Circuit Court for Culpeper County, Virginia as Instrument No. 1700066, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction in the front of the Circuit Court building for Culpeper County, at the corner of West Davis Street and North West Street in the Town of Culpeper, or any such temporary alternative location designated by the Judges of the Circuit Court on **November 19, 2026, at 5:00 PM**, the property described in said deed of trust, located at the above address, and more particularly described as follows:

ALL THAT CERTAIN TRACT OR PARCEL OF LAND SITUATE IN JEFFERSON MAGISTRAL DISTRICT, CULPEPER COUNTY, VIRGINIA, AND MORE PARTICULARLY DESCRIBED AS LOT THREE B (3B), CONTAINING 1.087 ACRES, MORE OR LESS, FRONTING ON ROUTE 621, AS SHOWN ON PLAT OF SURVY ENTITLED "SUBDIVISION OF LOT 3A, SECTION ONE, WEST JEFFERSON, VIRGINIA", RECORDED IN THE CLERK'S OFFICE OF THE CIRCUIT COURT OF CULPEPER COUNTY, VIRGINIA IN PLAT BOOK 343 AT PAGE 327.

TERMS OF SALE: ALL CASH. A bidder's deposit of ten percent (10%) of the sale price, plus an additional ten percent (10%) of the original principal balance of the subject Deed of Trust, whichever is lower, in the form of cash or certified funds payable to the Substitute Trustee must be present at the time of the sale. The balance of the purchase price will be due within fifteen (15) days of sale, otherwise Purchaser's deposit may be forfeited to Trustee. Time is of the essence. If the sale is set aside for any reason, the Purchaser at the sale shall be entitled to a return of the deposit paid. The Purchaser may, if provided by the terms of the Trustee's Memorandum of Foreclosure Sale, be entitled to a \$50 cancellation fee from the Substitute Trustee, but shall have no further recourse against the Substitute Trustee, the Mortgagee, or the Mortgagee's attorney. A form copy of the Trustee's memorandum of foreclosure sale and contract to purchase real property is available for viewing at www.auctors.com. Additional terms, if any, to be announced at the sale and the Purchaser may be given the option to execute the contract of sale electronically.

This is a communication from a debt collector and any information obtained will be used for that purpose. The sale is subject to seller confirmation. Substitute Trustee: Equity Trustees, LLC, 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. If you have any questions or concerns, please contact the Virginia Real Estate Department of counsel for Equity Trustees, LLC at 8100 Three Chopt Road, Suite 240, Richmond, VA 23229. Website: www.auctors.com. 865-555-5555, website: www.auctors.com. 865-555-5555.

SEP 15,22,09,21, 2026 0012524087

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852 Anne Arundel County	852 Anne Arundel County
GREENSPOON MARDER, LLP 201 International Circle, Suite 230 Hunt Valley, MD 21030	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY KNOWN AS 2539 MISSION HILLS CT Annapolis, MD 21401	

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from CORNELIUS J. BARRETT, dated October 5, 2021 and recorded in book 37725, page 153 among the Land Records of ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-02-CV-26-001037; Tax ID No. 02-892-90049567) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY courthouse located at 8 CHURCH CIR, ANNAPOLIS, MD 21401.

SEPTEMBER 17, 2026 at 4:00 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 39,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for ANNE ARUNDEL COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five percent (5%) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 24-000943-01)

NICOLE LIPINSKI, GABRIELLE GIOVINAZZO, ERIN KENNEDY, Substitute Trustee (s)

	300 E. Joppa Road Hanover Plaza, Suite 1103 Baltimore, MD 21286 410-769-9797
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Sep 1,8,15, 2026 0012524408

855 Charles County	855 Charles County
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GREENSPOON MARDER, LLP
201 International Circle, Suite 230
Hunt Valley, MD 21030

SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE'S SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY KNOWN AS 3250 Ryon Ct Waldorf, MD 20601

By virtue of a power of sale contained in a Deed of Trust from TANISHA NICOLE WILCOX, dated September 11, 2019 and recorded in book 10880, page 6 among the Land Records of CHARLES COUNTY, Maryland, default having occurred thereunder (Foreclosure Case docketed as Case No. C-08-CV-25-000875; Tax ID No. 06-112323) the Substitute Trustee will sell at public auction CHARLES COUNTY courthouse located at 200 CHARLES STREET (IN THE BREZEWAY BETWEEN CIRCUIT AND DISTRICT COURTS) LA PLATA, MD 20646.

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in CHARLES COUNTY, MD and more fully described in above referenced Deed of Trust.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$ 17,000.00 will be required at the time of sale, such deposit to be in CERTIFIED CHECK OR BY CASHIER'S CHECK, CASH WILL NOT BE ACCEPTED. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for CHARLES COUNTY. Time is of the essence as to the purchaser. If the purchaser defaults, the deposit shall be forfeited and the property shall be resold at the purchaser's risk and expense. The purchaser waives personal service and accepts service by first class mail and certified mail addressed to the address provided by said Purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale for any Motion or Show Cause Order incident to this sale including a Motion to Default Purchaser and for Resale of the Property. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive any benefit from the resale, including, but not limited to, additional proceeds or surplus which may arise therefrom. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at five percent (5%) from the date of sale to the date funds are received by the Substitute Trustee. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered at the time of sale or any time prior to settlement or if the settlement is delayed for any reason. In the event that the Secured Party executes a forbearance agreement with the borrower(s) described in the above-mentioned Deed of Trust, or allows the borrower(s) to execute their right to reinstate or payoff the subject loan, prior to the sale, with or without the Substitute Trustee's prior knowledge, this Contract shall be null and void and of no effect, and the Purchaser's sole remedy shall be the return of the deposit without interest. Purchaser shall pay for documentary stamps, transfer taxes and settlement expenses. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, condominium fees and/or homeowner association dues, all public charges/assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, if applicable, shall be adjusted to the date of sale and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. If the Substitute Trustee is unable to convey insurable title for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to a refund of the aforementioned deposit without interest. In the event the sale is not ratified for any reason, the Purchaser's sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of the deposit without interest. (File # 25-001229-01)

NICOLE LIPINSKI, GABRIELLE GIOVINAZZO, ERIN KENNEDY, Substitute Trustee (s)

	300 E. Joppa Road Hanover Plaza, Suite 1103 Baltimore, MD 21286 410-769-9797
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Sep 15,22,29, 2026 0012524895

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856 Frederick County	856 Frederick County
Rosenberg & Associates, LLC 4340 East West Highway, Suite 600 Bethesda, MD 20814 (301) 907-8000 www.rosenberg-assoc.com	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY 7301 BLUE MOUNTAIN ROAD THURMONT, MD 21788	

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from Helen Ruth Click, William Click and Haydee Click dated April 27, 2006 and recorded in Liber 6000, folio 513 among the Land Records of Frederick County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof, the Trustees will sell at public auction at the Circuit Court for Frederick County, at the Court House Door, 100 W. Patrick St., Frederick, MD 21701, on

SEPTEMBER 25, 2026 AT 10:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND, together with the buildings and improvements thereon situated in Frederick County, MD and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. Tax ID #15-335378.

The property, which is improved by a dwelling, will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions and agreements of record affecting the same, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit of \$20,000 in the form of certified check, cashier's check or money order will be required of the purchaser at time and place of sale. Balance of the purchase price to be paid in cash within ten days of final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court for Frederick County. Interest to be paid on the unpaid purchase money at the rate pursuant to the Deed of Trust Note from the date of sale to the date funds are received in the office of the Trustees. There will be no abatement of interest in the event additional funds are tendered before settlement or if settlement is delayed for any reason. The noteholder shall not be obligated to pay interest if it is the purchaser. TIME IS OF THE ESSENCE FOR THE PURCHASER. There will be no reduction of interest due to overpayment of deposit. Adjustment of all real property taxes (excluding recapture of previously reduced or exempt taxes) and any other public charges or assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer charges, and ground rent to be adjusted to date of sale and paid at execution of the deed, except where the secured party is the purchaser, and thereafter assumed by the purchaser. All due and/or unpaid private utility, water and sewer facilities charges, condo/HOA assessments and Columbia Assoc. assessments, to the extent such amount survive foreclosure sale, are payable by the purchaser without adjustment. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes, recaptured taxes (including but not limited to agricultural taxes), and settlement expenses shall be borne by the purchaser. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. Purchaser assumes the risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale forward. Additional terms to be announced at the time of sale. THIS TRANSACTION MAY BE SUBJECT TO THE FINCEN RESIDENTIAL REAL ESTATE REPORTING RULE ("RRE RULE"). INFORMATION NECESSARY TO COMPLY WITH THE RRE RULE MUST BE PROVIDED TO THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES PRIOR TO CLOSING. FAILURE TO PROVIDE REQUIRED DOCUMENTATION FOR FINCEN REPORTING WILL BE CONSIDERED A DEFAULT. ADDITIONALLY, FAILURE TO PROVIDE THE REQUIRED INFORMATION UNDER SPECIFIC CIRCUMSTANCES COULD RESULT IN THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEE NOT EXECUTING THE SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES DEED. INTEREST WILL CONTINUE TO ACCRUE AND REMAIN THE SUCCESSFUL BIDDER'S RESPONSIBILITY UNTIL THE INFORMATION IS PROVIDED.

If the Trustees are unable to convey good and marketable title, the purchaser's sole remedy in law and equity shall be limited to a refund of the deposit without interest. If the purchaser fails to go to settlement, subject to order of the court, the entire deposit (including any amount received over the advertised deposit amount) shall be forfeited to the Trustees as liquidated damages for all losses occasioned by the purchaser's default and purchaser shall have no further liability. In the event of a resale, the defaulting purchaser shall not be entitled to receive the surplus, if any, even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulting purchaser and the defaulting purchaser shall be liable to the Trustees and secured party for reasonable attorney's fees and expenses incurred in connection with all litigation involving the Property or the proceeds of the sale. Defaulting purchaser waives personal service of any document filed in connection with such a motion on him/herself and/or any principal or corporate designee, and expressly agrees to accept service of any such document by regular mail directed to the address provided by said purchaser at the time of the foreclosure auction. Trustees' file number 22-001709-MD-F-1.

Diane S. Rosenberg, Mark D. Meyer, et al., Trustees

	908 York Road • Towson, MD 21204 • 410.828.4838 www.alexcooper.com
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Sep 8,15,22, 2026 0012525614

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The Washington Post

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856 Frederick County	856 Frederick County
Brock and Scott, PLLC 5431 Oleander Drive Wilmington NC, 28403	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF VALUABLE FEE SIMPLE PROPERTY KNOWN AS 5403 Viceroy Court Frederick, MD 21703	

Under and by virtue of the power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust to DIANA R. HARRISON, Trustee(s), dated October 28, 2005, and recorded among the Land Records of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND in Liber 6221 FOLIO 216, MODIFIED ON JULY 9, 2015 IN LIBER 10732 FOLIO 237, the holder of the indebtedness secured by this Deed of Trust having appointed the undersigned Substitute Trustees, by instrument duly recorded among the aforesaid Land Records, default having occurred under the terms thereof, and at the request of the party secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustee will offer for sale at public auction at THE FREDERICK COUNTY COURTHOUSE LOCATED AT 100 W. PATRICK ST, FREDERICK, MD 21701 ON,

SEPTEMBER 23, 2026 at 9:30 AM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND and improvements thereon situated in FREDERICK COUNTY, MD and more fully described in the above-referenced Deed of Trust Tax ID# -28-580819.

The property will be sold in an "AS IS WHERE IS" condition without either express or implied warranty or representation, including but not limited to the description, fitness for a particular purpose or use, structural integrity, physical condition, construction, extent of construction, workmanship, materials, liability, zoning, subdivision, environmental condition, merchantability, compliance with building or housing codes or other laws, ordinances or regulations, or other similar matters, and subject to easements, agreements and restrictions of record which affect the same, if any. The property will be sold subject to all conditions, liens, restrictions and agreements of record affecting same including any condominium and of HOA assessments pursuant to Md Real Property Article 11-110.

TERMS OF SALE: A deposit of \$20,000.00 payable in certified check or by a cashier's check will be required from purchaser at time of sale, balance in immediately available funds upon final ratification of sale by the Circuit Court of FREDERICK COUNTY, MARYLAND interest to be paid at the rate of 3% on unpaid purchase money from date of sale to date of settlement. The secured party herein, if a bidder, shall not be required to post a deposit. Third party purchaser (excluding the secured party) will be required to complete full settlement of the purchase of the property within TEN (10) CALENDAR DAYS of the ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court otherwise the purchaser's deposit shall be forfeited and the property will be resold at the risk and expense of the defaulting purchaser. The purchaser waives personal service of any papers filed in connection with its failure to settle within ten days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail at the address provided by the purchaser as identified on the Memorandum of Sale. The defaulted purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus proceeds resulting from said resale even if such surplus results from improvements to the property by said defaulted purchaser.

Adjustment of all real property taxes, including agricultural taxes, if applicable, and any and all public/private charges or assessments, to the extent such amounts survive foreclosure sale, including water/sewer, ground rent, and front foot benefit charges, to be adjusted to the date of sale and thereafter assumed by purchaser. Purchaser is responsible for any recapture of homestead tax credit. All transfer taxes and recordation taxes hall be paid by purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale.

Purchaser is responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property and assumes risk of loss or damage to the property from the date of sale. If the sale is rescinded or not ratified for any reason, including post sale lender audit, or a resale is to take place for any reason, the purchaser(s) sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the aforementioned deposit. The Substitute Trustees will convey either marketable or insurable title. If they cannot deliver one or the other, or if the ratification of the sale is denied by the Circuit Court for any reason, the purchasers sole remedy, at law or equity, is the return of their deposit, without interest.

The purchaser waives all rights and claims against the Substitute Trustees whether known or unknown. These provisions shall survive settlement Upon refund of the deposit, this sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. The sale is subject to post-sale review of the status of the loan and that if any agreement to cancel the sale was entered into by the lender and borrower prior to the sale then the sale is void and the purchaser's deposit shall be refunded without interest. Additional terms and conditions, if applicable, may be announced at the time and date of sale.

If this transaction is subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule must be obtained provided to the Reporting Person, as defined in RRE Rule, prior to closing. File No. (22-06140)

BRENNAN FERGUSON, JOHN C. HANRAHAN, JEREMY B. WILKINS, AMANDA DRISCOLE, ROBERT OLIVERI, AND PAUL HEINMULLER, Substitute Trustees

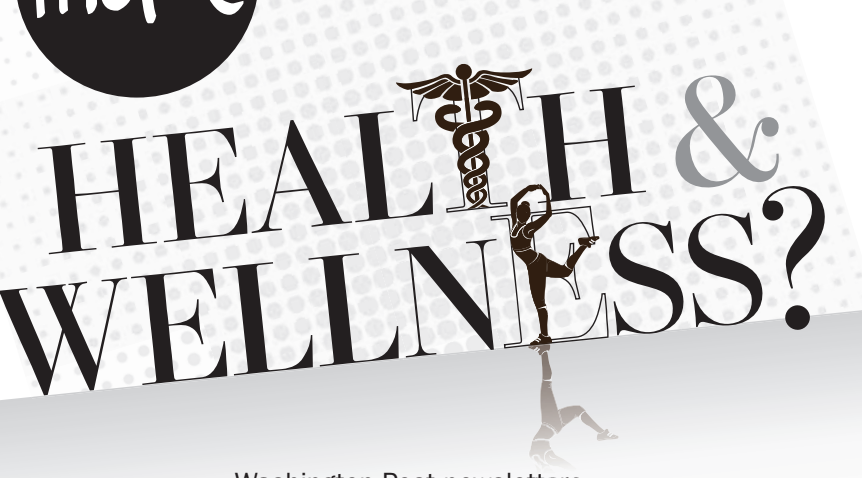
	300 E. Joppa Road Hanover Plaza, Suite 1103 Baltimore, MD 21286 410-769-9797
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856 Frederick County	856 Frederick County
McCabe, Weisberg & Conway, LLC 312 Marshall Avenue, Suite 800 Laurel, MD 20707 www.mwc-law.com	
SUBSTITUTE TRUSTEES' SALE OF IMPROVED REAL PROPERTY 7 WALDEN WAY MOUNT AIRY, MD 21771	

Under a power of sale contained in a certain Deed of Trust from David Brian Hamilton and Laura D. Hamilton, dated March 23, 2006 and recorded in Liber 6010, folio 452 among the Land Records of Frederick County, MD, default having occurred under the terms thereof and at the request of the parties secured thereby, the undersigned Substitute Trustees will offer for sale at public auction at the Circuit Court for Frederick County at the Court House Door, 100 W. Patrick St., Frederick, MD 21701, on

SEPTEMBER 18, 2026 AT 12:40 PM

ALL THAT FEE SIMPLE LOT OF GROUND AND THE IMPROVEMENTS THEREON situated in Frederick County, Maryland and more fully described in the aforesaid Deed of Trust. The property is improved by a dwelling.

The property will be sold in an "as is" condition and subject to conditions, restrictions, easements, encumbrances and agreements of record affecting the subject property, if any, and with no warranty of any kind.

Terms of Sale: A deposit in the form of cashier's or certified check, or in such other form as the Substitute Trustees may determine, at their sole discretion, for \$30,000 at the time of sale. If the noteholder and/or servicer is the successful bidder, the deposit requirement is waived. Balance of the purchase price is to be paid within ten (10) days of the final ratification of the sale by the Circuit Court for Frederick County, Maryland. Interest is to be paid on the unpaid purchase price at the rate of 5% per annum from date of sale to the date the funds are received in the office of the Substitute Trustees, if the property is purchased by an entity other than the noteholder and/or servicer. If payment of the balance does not occur within ten (10) days of ratification, the deposit will be forfeited as liquidated damages. The purchaser agrees that the property may be resold pursuant to an order of court, waives personal service upon themselves and/or any principal or corporate assignee of any papers filed regarding their sale to pay the purchase price within ten (10) days of ratification and expressly agrees to accept service by first class mail of said documents at the address provided by the purchaser in the Memorandum of Sale. This transaction may be subject to the FinCEN Residential Real Estate Reporting Rule ("RRE Rule") issued pursuant to the Bank Secrecy Act, effective March 1, 2026. Purchaser will be responsible for obtaining the information necessary to comply with the RRE Rule and for providing the necessary information to the Reporting Person, as defined in the RRE Rule within (10) ten days following Ratification of the Sale. The purchaser's deposit will be forfeited and property resold. The purchaser shall not be entitled to any surplus or profits arising from the resale even if they are the result of improvements made by the purchaser. There will be no abatement of interest due from the purchaser in the event settlement is delayed for any reason. Taxes, ground rent, water rent, and all other public charges and assessments payable on an annual basis, including sanitary and/or metropolitan district charges, and front foot benefit charges, if applicable, to be adjusted to the current year to the date of sale, and assumed thereafter by the purchaser. Condominium fees and/or homeowners association dues, if any, shall be assumed by the purchaser from the date of sale. The purchaser shall be responsible for the payment of the ground rent escrow, if required. Cost of all documentary stamps, transfer taxes (including agricultural transfer taxes, if applicable), and all settlement charges shall be borne by the purchaser. The sale is subject to a post sale audit of the loan, including but not limited to an analysis of whether the borrower entered into a loan modification agreement, filed bankruptcy, reinstated or paid off the loan prior to the sale. The Substitute Trustees will convey either insurable or marketable title. If the Substitute Trustees are unable to convey insurable or marketable title or, the post sale audit concludes that the sale should not have occurred, or the sale is not ratified by the court for any reason, the purchaser's sole remedy in law or equity shall be limited to the refund of the deposit without interest even if the purchaser has made improvements to the property. Upon refund of the deposit, the sale shall be void and of no effect, and the purchaser shall have no further claim against the Substitute Trustees. Purchaser shall be responsible for obtaining physical possession of the property. The purchaser at the foreclosure sale shall assume the risk of loss for the property immediately after the sale. (Matter #14-605965).

Laura H. G. O'Sullivan, et al., Substitute Trustees

THE WEATHER

WASHINGTONPOST.COM/WEATHER

Partly sunny, high around 80

We'll have partly sunny skies today and a high temperature around 80 degrees. Some winds can be expected. In the evening, it will be mostly clear and low temperatures will be in the 60s.

AccuWeather FORECAST

Today
Partly sunny



80° **62°**

REALFEEL®: **82°**

CHANCE PRECIP: **0%**

WIND: **ESE 6-12 mph**

HUMIDITY: **Moderate**

Wednesday
Mostly sunny



84° **65°**

REALFEEL®: **86°**

CHANCE PRECIP: **0%**

WIND: **S 6-12 mph**

HUMIDITY: **High**

Thursday
Partly sunny



87° **71°**

REALFEEL®: **88°**

CHANCE PRECIP: **15%**

WIND: **S 6-12 mph**

HUMIDITY: **High**

Friday
T-storm possible



87° **70°**

REALFEEL®: **91°**

CHANCE PRECIP: **55%**

WIND: **N 6-12 mph**

HUMIDITY: **High**

Saturday
Shower possible



83° **72°**

REALFEEL®: **86°**

CHANCE PRECIP: **30%**

WIND: **ESE 6-12 mph**

HUMIDITY: **High**

Sunday
T-storm possible



89° **70°**

REALFEEL®: **93°**

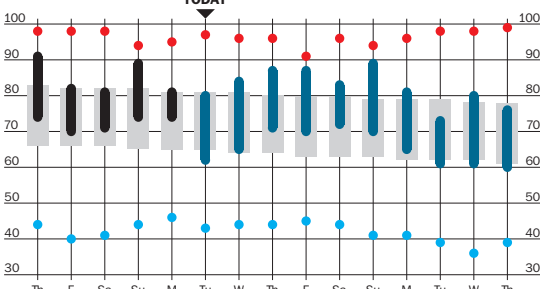
CHANCE PRECIP: **55%**

WIND: **SSW 6-12 mph**

HUMIDITY: **Very High**

OFFICIAL RECORD

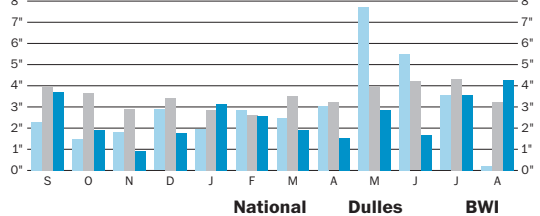
Temperatures HISTORICAL AVERAGE RECORD ACTUAL FORECAST



Statistics through 5 p.m. Monday			
National		Dulles	BWI
High	81° 3:06 p.m.	79° 2:51 p.m.	81° 1:00 p.m.
Low	74° 6:00 a.m.	71° 3:00 a.m.	72° 7:00 a.m.
Historical Average		81°/65°	81°/60°
Record high		95° 2016	94° 1931
Record low		46° 1911	42° 1975

Difference from 30-yr. avg. (National): this month: **+4.0°** yr. to date: **+0.5°**

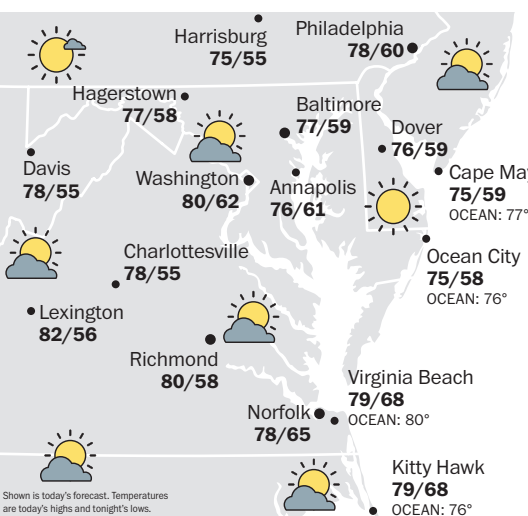
Precipitation PREVIOUS YEAR HISTORICAL AVERAGE LATEST



National			
Past 24 hours	0.00"	Trace	0.00"
Total this month	2.28"	1.42"	0.54"
Historical Average (month)	1.81"	1.75"	1.98"
Total this year	23.84"	30.82"	26.64"
Historical Average (year)	29.72"	30.97"	31.76"

Moon Phases		Solar system	
Sep 18	Sep 26	Oct 3	Oct 10
First Quarter	Full	Last Quarter	New
Sun		Rise	Set
Moon		6:49 a.m.	7:16 p.m.
Venus		10:22 a.m.	8:29 p.m.
Mars		1:47 a.m.	4:28 p.m.
Jupiter		3:49 a.m.	5:45 p.m.
Saturn		8:11 p.m.	8:33 a.m.

REGION TODAY



Pollen: High
Observed ratings on 9/14
Grass Moderate
Trees Moderate
Weeds High
Mold Moderate

Air Quality: Good
Main pollutant: Ozone

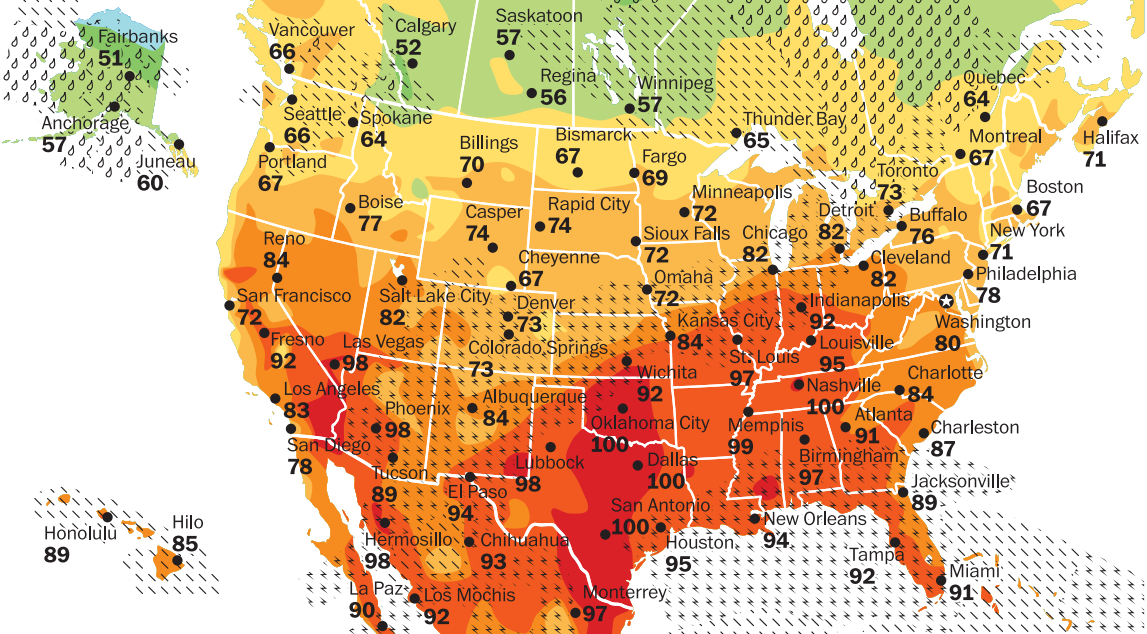
UV: High
6 out of 11+

Blue Ridge: Shenandoah National Park: Today, brilliant sunshine, low humidity. High 76. Winds south-southwest 3–6 mph. • *Great Smoky Mtns.*
National Park: Today, partly sunny, less humid. High 74. Winds west-southwest 4–8 mph. Tonight, clear. Low 62. Winds south 4–8 mph.
Atlantic beaches: Ocean City, MD: Today, partly sunny, low humidity. High 75. Winds east-northeast 7–14 mph. Tonight, clear to partly cloudy. Low 58. Winds east 4–8 mph. • *Virginia Beach:* Today, partly sunny, low humidity. High 79. Winds northeast 8–16 mph. Tonight, mainly clear. Low 68. Winds east-northeast 6–12 mph.

Waterways: *Upper Potomac River:* Today, partly sunny. Wind east-southeast 4–8 knots. Waves less than a foot. Visibility clear. • *Lower Potomac and Chesapeake Bay:* Today, mostly sunny. Wind east 4–8 knots. Waves 1–2 feet on the Lower Potomac; 2–4 feet on the Chesapeake Bay. • *River Stages:* The stage at Little Falls will be around 2.70 feet today, with no change of 2.70 Wednesday. Flood stage at Little Falls is 10 feet.

Today's tides (Shown are High tides in Bold and low tides.)			
Washington	6:32 a.m.	11:46 a.m.	6:25 p.m. none
Annapolis	2:59 a.m.	8:19 a.m.	2:40 p.m. 9:31 p.m.
Ocean City	4:42 a.m.	11:01 a.m.	5:28 p.m. 11:18 p.m.
Norfolk	12:39 a.m.	6:38 a.m.	1:08 p.m. 7:34 p.m.
Point Lookout	4:30 a.m.	10:36 a.m.	5:20 p.m. none

NATION TODAY



Yesterday's National
High: Gila Bend, AZ **105°**
Low: Bridgeport, CA **27°**
For the 48 contiguous states

NATIONAL		Today	Tomorrow
Albany, NY	70/56/pc	75/62/c	
Albuquerque	84/65/t	83/65/t	
Anchorage	57/49/r	62/47/pc	
Atlanta	91/71/r	89/68/s	
Austin	101/77/pc	99/75/t	
Baltimore	77/59/pc	82/64/s	
Billings, MT	70/45/s	70/46/pc	
Birmingham	97/73/pc	93/69/s	
Bismarck, ND	67/46/s	69/45/sh	
Boise	77/49/pc	81/56/s	
Boston	67/56/pc	77/64/s	
Buffalo	76/65/pc	75/64/c	
Burlington, VT	70/59/pc	76/59/c	
Charleston, SC	87/66/sh	87/66/s	
Charlotte, NC	89/64/s	89/67/pc	
Charlotte	84/64/pc	88/62/s	
Cheyenne, WY	67/49/pc	80/56/t	
Chicago	82/66/t	72/68/t	
Cincinnati	91/71/s	91/71/pc	
Cleveland	82/68/pc	78/69/r	
Dallas	100/81/s	98/78/s	
Denver	73/54/t	83/61/t	
Des Moines	73/60/t	72/66/t	
Detroit	82/67/t	74/62/pc	
El Paso	94/71/t	92/69/r	
Fairbanks, AK	51/45/r	49/44/r	
Fargo, ND	69/44/pc	65/49/sh	
Hartford, CT	71/53/pc	79/61/s	
Honolulu	89/78/sh	89/78/sh	
Houston	95/76/t	93/76/t	
Indianapolis	92/72/t	89/72/t	
Jackson, MS	98/74/t	95/70/s	
Jacksonville, FL	89/73/t	88/72/pc	
Kansas City, MO	84/67/t	85/72/t	
Las Vegas	98/78/s	97/73/s	
Little Rock	99/76/s	99/76/t	
Los Angeles	83/66/pc	81/68/pc	
Louisville	95/74/s	94/75/pc	
Memphis	99/77/s	99/77/s	
Miami	91/79/sh	89/77/t	
Milwaukee	77/60/t	68/65/t	
Minneapolis	72/53/c	72/60/sh	
Nashville	100/76/s	97/73/s	
New Orleans	94/79/t	88/79/t	
New York City	71/60/s	79/67/s	
Norfolk	78/65/pc	80/67/s	
Oklahoma City	100/74/s	98/74/s	
Omaha	72/61/t	73/65/t	
Orlando	90/77/t	89/74/pc	
Philadelphia	78/60/pc	83/66/s	
Phoenix	98/79/t	94/80/t	
Pittsburgh	81/63/s	85/67/t	
Portland, ME	67/52/pc	74/59/pc	
Portland, OR	67/53/pc	82/55/s	
Providence, RI	70/53/s	77/63/s	
Raleigh, NC	83/59/s	86/61/s	
Reno, NV	84/49/s	81/49/s	
Richmond	80/58/pc	84/60/s	
Sacramento	89/57/s	81/56/s	
St. Louis	97/75/t	96/77/t	
St. Thomas, VI	91/82/t	91/82/t	
Salt Lake City	82/65/s	86/68/pc	
San Diego	78/69/pc	78/68/pc	
San Francisco	72/60/pc	70/61/pc	
San Juan, PR	89/79/sh	90/79/sh	
Seattle	66/51/pc	75/52/s	
Spokane, WA	64/46/pc	73/49/s	
Syracuse	75/61/pc	76/64/c	
Tampa	92/77/t	91/75/pc	
Wichita	92/69/t	93/71/pc	

Yesterday's World
High: Mina, Saudi Arabia **115°**
Low: Rea Point, Canada **7°**
Excludes Antarctica

WORLD		Today	Tomorrow
Addis Ababa	72/55/r	71/54/sh	
Amsterdam	76/57/c	65/55/sh	
Athens	80/69/pc	80/68/s	
Auckland	63/49/pc	62/49/sh	
Baghdad	110/79/s	109/78/s	
Bangkok	90/78/r	92/80/r	
Beijing	85/59/s	89/62/s	
Berlin	76/62/pc	68/52/t	
Bogota	69/50/sh	69/48/r	
Brussels	82/56/pc	66/53/s	
Buenos Aires	65/45/pc	57/52/s	
Cairo	97/75/pc	98/79/pc	
Caracas	78/68/r	79/68/t	
Copenhagen	67/58/c	66/52/t	
Dakar	89/81/t	91/82/c	
Dublin	63/51/sh	62/51/c	
Edinburgh	64/48/sh	62/51/c	
Frankfurt	82/61/c	72/49/pc	
Geneva	84/59/s	73/50/sh	
Ham., Bermuda	86/78/sh	86/78/t	
Helsinki	61/51/c	62/53/sh	
Ho Chi Minh City	94/77/r	94/78/r	
Hong Kong	91/80/r	91/80/pc	

D.C. jail guards did nothing as inmate started a series of fires, lawsuit says

LAWSUIT FROM B13

added.

The D.C. jail, officially known as the Central Detention Facility, has long been plagued by violent and unsafe conditions and chronic understaffing, inspections and auditors' reports have found.

In 2021, the U.S. Marshals Service transferred hundreds of federal detainees from the jail after a surprise inspection found "systemic failures" at the facility, including "grotesquely poor sanitation and the punitive withholding of food and water." And last year, a report by the D.C. Auditor found that people in the custody of the city's Department of Corrections died at more than three times the national average at jails between 2023 and 2024, with overdoses the most common cause of death.

The lawsuit comes after a nearly two-year legal fight to obtain records related to the 2023 fire. In November 2023, the Washington Lawyers' Committee for Civil Rights and Urban Affairs filed a Freedom of Information Act request for the records, which was denied. The group filed a lawsuit demanding the release of the records and a D.C. judge ruled in their favor last year.

"Part of this is also just shedding light on the fact that there was never really an investigation into this incident: how it was possible for a person in a mental health crisis, over a 12 hour period, to lead to this level of damage," said Leslie Faith Jones, a lawyer for the Washington Lawyers' Committee, who is also representing the plaintiffs.

Jones said her clients "want people to know what happened to them to prevent this from

happening again."

The plaintiffs, all of whom have diagnosed mental health disorders, were incarcerated in the jail's mental health step-down unit, a "therapeutic unit" meant for residents discharged from intensive mental health care but not yet considered ready to return the jail's general population, according to the complaint.

On the night of Sept. 14, 2023, a resident in the unit — identified in the complaint as "John Doe" — began yelling that he "wanted to kill himself and requesting to speak with a staff supervisor or a doctor," according to the complaint. The man's cries, which were audible throughout the unit, continued through the night and into the next morning, the lawsuit alleges.

When staff conducted rounds, other residents in the unit, including some plaintiffs, asked the officers to address the man's repeated threats of suicide, fearing that he posed a danger to himself and others. At one point, the complaint says, one of the plaintiffs left his cell for a work detail and spoke directly with Doe, who asked him to tell an officer that Doe "needed help as soon as possible." The plaintiff told an officer on duty, but no one came to check on Doe, the suit alleges.

About 8 a.m. the next morning, after hours of unanswered pleas for help, Doe began lighting fires, first in his cell and then in the unit hallway, according to the lawsuit. More than two hours later, other residents in the unit looked on as Doe pushed pieces of burning paper and fabric through an opening in his cell door. One of the plaintiffs, whose cell was directly across from



MORIAH RATNER/FOR THE WASHINGTON POST

The D.C. jail, officially known as the Central Detention Facility.

A D.C. Department of Corrections spokesperson said in a statement that the department "has not received the complaint referenced and therefore cannot comment on its specific allegations."

Doe's, asked him to stop but Doe "responded that he wanted to die and continued his efforts," the complaint alleges.

As the unit filled with smoke, residents tried to get the attention of jail staff, banging on their cell doors and yelling that there was a fire, according to the complaint. One resident tried to use a jail-issued tablet to call for

help but could not see the screen because of the smoke, according to the lawsuit. Another used his tablet to contact a local legal organization to report the fire and ask for help. Some resorted to using towels and linens to block gaps in their doors and create makeshift masks to protect themselves from the smoke, according to the suit.

According to the complaint, Doe eventually pulled an electrical box fan from the hallway into his cell and used it to start a large electrical fire at 10:52 a.m. It is unclear when exactly Doe pulled the fan into his cell, because of the complaint's redactions.

"Jail staff ignored the resident's pleas and left him unattended during the three hours it took him to set up and light a series of small fires before the larger electrical fire," the complaint said.

At 10:53 a.m., a jail staffer entered the unit and put out the fire with an extinguisher, according to the lawsuit. Three minutes later, the cell doors in the unit opened electronically and the

residents immediately ran toward the stairwell, causing a confused scramble in the smoke-filled hallway, the lawsuit alleges. One plaintiff reported that the smoke in his cell was so thick that he was unable to see or breathe and was completely disoriented.

Doe survived the fire, according to the plaintiffs' lawyers.

Some key details of the incident are in dispute. In response to earlier official complaints filed by plaintiffs, jail officials stated that the fire alarm had worked, leading to a quick response, according to the complaint. But the lawsuit alleges that the unit's fire alarm did not activate before staff responded.

Problems continued after the fire was put out, the complaint alleges. One plaintiff's request for an inhaler was denied, despite a heart condition and a history of childhood asthma, according to the complaint, with staff allegedly telling him "no inhaler was available and he would have to wait to receive one."

The plaintiffs also allege they were made to clean up debris from the fire but were not given face masks as they cleared out ash and the chemical residue left over by the fire extinguisher. With the exception of one plaintiff, the other plaintiffs did not receive new clothes and had to use smoky clothing and bedding for days after the fire, according to the lawsuit.

The plaintiffs also allege that senior jail officials did not fully investigate the circumstances surrounding the fire or hold any staff accountable for their actions.

The lawsuit seeks a jury trial and damages for the plaintiffs in an unspecified amount.



The Guide to Offers
The Washington Post

Enter for the chance to win a pair of tickets to the Little Shop of Horrors 40th Anniversary Screening, September 25

Celebrate the 40th anniversary of Little Shop of Horrors with a special screening hosted by Ellen Greene, the original Audrey. In this rare appearance, Greene who originated the role in the stage musical before starring in the beloved 1986 film adaptation will help commemorate the cult classic. Directed by Frank Oz, the science-fiction musical comedy follows Seymour Krelborn, a shy florist who discovers a bloodthirsty, man-eating plant named Audrey II.

See details at [washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388](https://www.washingtonpost.com/entertainment/events/lists/388)

